

TOPICAL SCRIPTURE
DATABASE & STUDY GUIDE
NASB 2020 ANCHORS + WEB FULL-TEXT EDITION

A detailed biblical reference for doctrine, prophecy, spiritual life, relationships, suffering, ethics, and Christian hope - with NASB 2020 anchors and full World English Bible readings

“Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light to my path.”

- Psalm 119:105 (NASB 2020)

Scripture format: brief NASB 2020 topic anchors are retained, while every complete core reading is quoted from the public-domain World English Bible (WEB). The NIV and ESV remain recommended comparison translations in licensed print or digital editions.

How to Use This Guide

This volume is designed as a topical database and study guide. Each chapter begins with a theological overview, retains a brief NASB 2020 anchor, quotes several foundational passages in full from the WEB, offers a concise synthesis, and ends with a broader reference list for deeper study.

Brief anchor quotations are from the New American Standard Bible 2020 and remain unchanged from the prior edition. Full core passages are quoted from the World English Bible, a public-domain modern English translation. NIV and ESV references are retained only as recommendations for comparison; their extended text is not reproduced.

Interpretive notes distinguish direct biblical claims from theological synthesis. On debated subjects - especially Daniel 9, the millennium, spiritual gifts, the relation of law and grace, and the Angel of the LORD - the guide identifies major readings rather than presenting one tradition as though no alternative exists.

Reading Principles

- Context: read before and after the selected verses.
- Genre: poetry, proverb, narrative, law, prophecy, gospel, epistle, and apocalypse communicate differently.
- Covenant and fulfillment: ask where the passage stands in the unfolding biblical story.
- Canonical comparison: clearer and repeated teaching should guide the interpretation of difficult texts.
- Christ-centered reading: follow the New Testament's own patterns rather than inventing arbitrary symbols.
- Humility: distinguish essentials of Christian confession from secondary systems and chronological reconstructions.

Scope note. *No topical guide can be exhaustive. The goal is a substantial map of key texts and themes that can be expanded through personal study, teaching notes, or a searchable digital database.*

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1. Scripture and the Word of God

The Bible presents God's word as revelation, covenant instruction, prophetic speech, apostolic testimony, and the written witness that makes the saving work of God known. Scripture is not treated merely as information: it searches the heart, gives wisdom, nourishes faith, equips ministry, and summons obedience. Christians differ on some questions of canon, inspiration, inerrancy, and interpretive method, but historic Christianity consistently receives the biblical writings as uniquely authoritative for doctrine and life.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Psalm 119:105 (NASB 2020)

"Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light to my path."

Primary core reading: Psalm 19:7-11 (WEB)

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⁷ Yahweh's law is perfect, restoring the soul. Yahweh's testimony is sure, making wise the simple. ⁸ Yahweh's precepts are right, rejoicing the heart. Yahweh's commandment is pure, enlightening the eyes.

⁹ The fear of Yahweh is clean, enduring forever. Yahweh's ordinances are true, and righteous altogether. ¹⁰ More to be desired are they than gold, yes, than much fine gold; sweeter also than honey and the extract of the honeycomb.

¹¹ Moreover by them is your servant warned. In keeping them there is great reward.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Psalm 119:105-112 (WEB)

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¹⁰⁵ Your word is a lamp to my feet, and a light for my path. ¹⁰⁶ I have sworn, and have confirmed it, that I will obey your righteous ordinances.

¹⁰⁷ I am afflicted very much. Revive me, Yahweh, according to your word. ¹⁰⁸ Accept, I beg you, the willing offerings of my mouth. Yahweh, teach me your ordinances.

¹⁰⁹ My soul is continually in my hand, yet I won't forget your law. ¹¹⁰ The wicked have laid a snare for me, yet I haven't gone astray from your precepts.

¹¹¹ I have taken your testimonies as a heritage forever, for they are the joy of my heart. ¹¹² I have set my heart to perform your statutes forever, even to the end. SAMEKH

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 2 Timothy 3:14-17 (WEB)

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¹⁴ But you remain in the things which you have learned and have been assured of, knowing from whom you have learned them. ¹⁵ From infancy, you have known the holy Scriptures which are able to make you wise for salvation through faith, which is in Christ Jesus. ¹⁶ Every Scripture is God-breathed and profitable for teaching, for reproof, for correction, and for instruction in righteousness, ¹⁷ that the man of God may be complete, thoroughly equipped for every good work.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Hebrews 4:12-13 (WEB)

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¹² For the word of God is living, and active, and sharper than any two-edged sword, and piercing even to the dividing of soul and spirit, of both joints and marrow, and is able to discern the thoughts and intentions of the heart. ¹³ There is no creature that is hidden from his sight, but all things are naked and laid open before the eyes of him with whom we have to do.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- God speaks through law, prophets, wisdom, gospel, and apostolic witness.
- Scripture is described as true, life-giving, corrective, and sufficient to equip the servant of God.
- Reading is meant to lead to trust, worship, repentance, and practiced obedience.
- Jesus is the climactic self-revelation of God, and the written word bears witness to him.

Further references: Deuteronomy 6:4-9; Joshua 1:8; Isaiah 55:10-11; Matthew 4:4; John 5:39-40; John 17:17; Romans 10:17; 2 Peter 1:19-21.

2. The Nature and Attributes of God

Scripture portrays God as the one living Creator, eternal and self-existent, holy and just, merciful and gracious, faithful and wise. His attributes are not competing pieces: the God who judges evil is the same God who abounds in steadfast mercy, and the God who is transcendent also draws near to the contrite. Biblical theology therefore resists reducing God either to raw power or to undemanding benevolence.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Exodus 34:6 (NASB 2020)

“The LORD, the LORD God, compassionate and merciful, slow to anger, and abounding in faithfulness and truth.”

Primary core reading: Exodus 34:5-8 (WEB)

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⁵ Yahweh descended in the cloud, and stood with him there, and proclaimed the name of Yahweh. ⁶ Yahweh passed by before him, and proclaimed, “Yahweh! Yahweh, a merciful and gracious God, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness and truth, ⁷ keeping loving kindness for thousands, forgiving iniquity and disobedience and sin; and that will by no means clear the guilty, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children, and on the children’s children, on the third and on the fourth generation.” ⁸ Moses hurried and bowed his head toward the earth, and worshiped.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Isaiah 40:25-31 (WEB)

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²⁵ “To whom then will you liken me? Who is my equal?” says the Holy One. ²⁶ Lift up your eyes on high, and see who has created these, who brings out their army by number. He calls them all by name. by the greatness of his might, and because he is strong in power, Not one is lacking.

²⁷ Why do you say, Jacob, and speak, Israel, “My way is hidden from Yahweh, and the justice due me is disregarded by my God?” ²⁸ Haven’t you known? Haven’t you heard? The everlasting God, Yahweh, The Creator of the ends of the earth, doesn’t faint. He isn’t weary. His understanding is unsearchable.

²⁹ He gives power to the weak. He increases the strength of him who has no might. ³⁰ Even the youths faint and get weary, and the young men utterly fall;

³¹ But those who wait for Yahweh will renew their strength. They will mount up with wings like eagles. They will run, and not be weary. They will walk, and not faint.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Psalm 103:8-14 (WEB)

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⁸ Yahweh is merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness. ⁹ He will not always accuse; neither will he stay angry forever.

¹⁰ He has not dealt with us according to our sins, nor repaid us for our iniquities. ¹¹ For as the heavens are high above the earth, so great is his loving kindness toward those who fear him.

¹² As far as the east is from the west, so far has he removed our transgressions from us. ¹³ Like a father has compassion on his children, so Yahweh has compassion on those who fear him.

¹⁴ For he knows how we are made. He remembers that we are dust.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 John 4:7-10 (WEB)

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⁷ Beloved, let us love one another, for love is of God; and everyone who loves is born of God, and knows God. ⁸ He who doesn't love doesn't know God, for God is love. ⁹ By this God's love was revealed in us, that God has sent his one and only Son into the world that we might live through him. ¹⁰ In this is love, not that we loved God, but that he loved us, and sent his Son as the atoning sacrifice for our sins.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- God is Creator rather than part of creation.
- His holiness exposes sin; his mercy provides forgiveness and restoration.
- His knowledge, presence, power, justice, and love ground trust.
- The cross is the central Christian disclosure of divine justice and love together.

Further references: Genesis 1:1; Deuteronomy 6:4; Psalm 90:1-2; Psalm 139:1-12; Isaiah 6:1-5; Malachi 3:6; Romans 11:33-36; James 1:17.

3. The Trinity

The word Trinity does not appear in Scripture, but the doctrine summarizes a pattern found across the canon: there is one God; the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit are personally distinguished; and each is spoken of and acts in ways that belong to God. The doctrine was formulated to preserve all three affirmations without collapsing the persons into modes or dividing the divine being into three gods.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Matthew 28:19 (NASB 2020)

“Make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit.”

Primary core reading: Deuteronomy 6:4-5 (WEB)

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⁴ Hear, Israel: Yahweh is our God; Yahweh is one: ⁵ and you shall love Yahweh your God with all your heart, and with all your soul, and with all your might.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Matthew 3:13-17 (WEB)

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¹³ Then Jesus came from Galilee to the Jordan to John, to be baptized by him. ¹⁴ But John would have hindered him, saying, “I need to be baptized by you, and you come to me?” ¹⁵ But Jesus, answering, said to him, “Allow it now, for this is the fitting way for us to fulfill all righteousness.” Then he allowed him. ¹⁶ Jesus, when he was baptized, went up directly from the water: and behold, the heavens were opened to him. He saw the Spirit of God descending as a dove, and coming on him.

¹⁷ Behold, a voice out of the heavens said, “This is my beloved Son, with whom I am well pleased.”

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Matthew 28:18-20 (WEB)

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¹⁸ Jesus came to them and spoke to them, saying, “All authority has been given to me in heaven and on earth. ¹⁹ Go, and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, ²⁰ teaching them to observe all things that I commanded you. Behold, I am with you always, even to the end of the age.” Amen.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 2 Corinthians 13:14 (WEB)

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¹⁴ The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, the love of God, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit, be with you all. Amen.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: John 1:1-3 (WEB)

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¹ In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ² The same was in the beginning with God. ³ All things were made through him. Without him was not anything made that has been made.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Biblical monotheism is foundational: God is one.
- Father, Son, and Spirit appear together and relate to one another personally.
- The Son and Spirit perform divine works and receive divine descriptions.
- Trinitarian doctrine is a synthesis of the whole biblical witness, not a claim based on one proof text.

Further references: Genesis 1:1-3; Isaiah 48:16; John 14:16-17; John 14:26; John 15:26; Acts 5:3-4; Ephesians 4:4-6; 1 Peter 1:2.

4. Jesus Christ: Person and Work

The New Testament confesses Jesus as the promised Messiah, true man, Son of God, Lord, and the one through whom creation and redemption are accomplished. He announces God's kingdom, lives in obedience, dies for sins, rises bodily, ascends, intercedes, reigns, and will return. Christian traditions use different models to explain the atonement, but all place Christ's death and resurrection at the center of salvation.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - John 1:1 (NASB 2020)

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God."

Primary core reading: John 1:1-18 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ² The same was in the beginning with God. ³ All things were made through him. Without him was not anything made that has been made.

⁴ In him was life, and the life was the light of men.

⁵ The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness hasn't overcome it. ⁶ There came a man, sent from God, whose name was John. ⁷ The same came as a witness, that he might testify about the light, that all might believe through him. ⁸ He was not the light, but was sent that he might testify about the light.

⁹ The true light that enlightens everyone was coming into the world. ¹⁰ He was in the world, and the world was made through him, and the world didn't recognize him. ¹¹ He came to his own, and those who were his own didn't receive him. ¹² But as many as received him, to them he gave the right to become God's children, to those who believe in his name:

¹³ who were born not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God. ¹⁴ The Word became flesh, and lived among us. We saw his glory, such glory as of the one and only Son of the Father, full of grace and truth. ¹⁵ John testified about him. He cried out, saying, "This was he of whom I said, 'He who comes after me has surpassed me, for he was before me.'" ¹⁶ From his fullness we all received grace upon grace.

¹⁷ For the law was given through Moses. Grace and truth were realized through Jesus Christ. ¹⁸ No one has seen God at any time. The one and only Son, who is in the bosom of the Father, he has declared him.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Colossians 1:13-20 (WEB)

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¹³ who delivered us out of the power of darkness, and translated us into the Kingdom of the Son of his love; ¹⁴ in whom we have our redemption, the forgiveness of our sins; ¹⁵ who is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of all creation. ¹⁶ For by him all things were created, in the heavens and on the earth, things visible and things invisible, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or powers; all things have been created through him, and for him.

¹⁷ He is before all things, and in him all things are held together. ¹⁸ He is the head of the body, the assembly, who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead; that in all things he might have the preeminence. ¹⁹ For all the fullness was pleased to dwell in him; ²⁰ and through him to reconcile all things to himself, by him, whether things on the earth, or things in the heavens, having made peace through the blood of his cross.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Philippians 2:5-11 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁵ Have this in your mind, which was also in Christ Jesus, ⁶ who, existing in the form of God, didn't consider equality with God a thing to be grasped, ⁷ but emptied himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in the likeness of men. ⁸ And being found in human form, he humbled himself, becoming obedient to death, yes, the death of the cross.

⁹ Therefore God also highly exalted him, and gave to him the name which is above every name; ¹⁰ that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of those in heaven, those on earth, and those under the earth, ¹¹ and that every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 15:1-8 (WEB)

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¹ Now I declare to you, brothers, the Good News which I preached to you, which also you received, in which you also stand, ² by which also you are saved, if you hold firmly the word which I preached to you—unless you believed in vain. ³ For I delivered to you first of all that which I also received: that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, ⁴ that he was buried, that he was raised on the third day according to the Scriptures,

⁵ and that he appeared to Cephas, then to the twelve. ⁶ Then he appeared to over five hundred brothers at once, most of whom remain until now, but some have also fallen asleep. ⁷ Then he appeared to James, then to all the apostles, ⁸ and last of all, as to the child born at the wrong time, he appeared to me also.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Jesus is fully involved in the identity and works of God while truly sharing human life.
- His ministry fulfills Israel's hopes and announces the kingdom.
- His death is presented as sacrifice, ransom, victory, reconciliation, and covenant-making.
- His bodily resurrection is both historical proclamation and firstfruits of the coming resurrection.

Further references: Isaiah 9:6-7; Matthew 16:13-17; Mark 10:45; Luke 24:25-27; John 8:58; Romans 3:23-26; Hebrews 1:1-4; Revelation 5:9-14.

5. The Holy Spirit: Presence, Power, and Fruit

The Spirit is active from creation onward, empowering prophets, craftsmen, judges, kings, and the promised Servant. In the new covenant the Spirit gives new birth, indwells believers, unites the church, distributes gifts, produces holy character, guides mission, and assures believers of adoption. Debates about particular gifts should not obscure the Spirit's central work of glorifying Christ and forming a holy people.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Galatians 5:22-23 (NASB 2020)

"The fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control."

Primary core reading: Ezekiel 36:25-27 (WEB)

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²⁵ I will sprinkle clean water on you, and you shall be clean: from all your filthiness, and from all your idols, will I cleanse you. ²⁶ I will also give you a new heart, and I will put a new spirit within you; and I will take away the stony heart out of your flesh, and I will give you a heart of flesh. ²⁷ I will put my Spirit within you, and cause you to walk in my statutes, and you shall keep my ordinances, and do them.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: John 14:15-17 (WEB)

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¹⁵ If you love me, keep my commandments. ¹⁶ I will pray to the Father, and he will give you another Counselor, that he may be with you forever,— ¹⁷ the Spirit of truth, whom the world can't receive; for it doesn't see him, neither knows him. You know him, for he lives with you, and will be in you.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: John 16:7-15 (WEB)

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⁷ Nevertheless I tell you the truth: It is to your advantage that I go away, for if I don't go away, the Counselor won't come to you. But if I go, I will send him to you. ⁸ When he has come, he will convict the world about sin, about righteousness, and about judgment; ⁹ about sin, because they don't believe in me; ¹⁰ about righteousness, because I am going to my Father, and you won't see me any more;

¹¹ about judgment, because the prince of this world has been judged. ¹² "I have yet many things to tell you, but you can't bear them now. ¹³ However when he, the Spirit of truth, has come, he will guide you into all truth, for he will not speak from himself; but whatever he hears, he will speak. He will declare to you things that are coming. ¹⁴ He will glorify me, for he will take from what is mine, and will declare it to you.

¹⁵ All things whatever the Father has are mine; therefore I said that he takes of mine, and will declare it to you.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Acts 1:4-8 (WEB)

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⁴ Being assembled together with them, he commanded them, “Don’t depart from Jerusalem, but wait for the promise of the Father, which you heard from me. ⁵ For John indeed baptized in water, but you will be baptized in the Holy Spirit not many days from now.” ⁶ Therefore, when they had come together, they asked him, “Lord, are you now restoring the kingdom to Israel?” ⁷ He said to them, “It isn’t for you to know times or seasons which the Father has set within his own authority.

⁸ But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you. You will be witnesses to me in Jerusalem, in all Judea and Samaria, and to the uttermost parts of the earth.”

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Galatians 5:16-25 (WEB)

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¹⁶ But I say, walk by the Spirit, and you won’t fulfill the lust of the flesh. ¹⁷ For the flesh lusts against the Spirit, and the Spirit against the flesh; and these are contrary to one another, that you may not do the things that you desire. ¹⁸ But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law. ¹⁹ Now the works of the flesh are obvious, which are: adultery, sexual immorality, uncleanness, lustfulness,

²⁰ idolatry, sorcery, hatred, strife, jealousies, outbursts of anger, rivalries, divisions, heresies, ²¹ envyings, murders, drunkenness, orgies, and things like these; of which I forewarn you, even as I also forewarned you, that those who practice such things will not inherit the Kingdom of God. ²² But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faith, ²³ gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law.

²⁴ Those who belong to Christ have crucified the flesh with its passions and lusts. ²⁵ If we live by the Spirit, let’s also walk by the Spirit.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- The Spirit is personal, not an impersonal force.
- New birth and sanctification are works of the Spirit.
- Power for witness is joined to transformed character.
- Gifts vary, but every gift is given for service and the common good.

Further references: Genesis 1:2; Numbers 11:25-29; Joel 2:28-32; John 3:5-8; Acts 2:1-21; Romans 8:9-17; 1 Corinthians 12:4-13; Ephesians 1:13-14.

6. Humanity, Sin, and the Need for Redemption

Human beings are created in God's image and therefore possess dignity, vocation, and responsibility. Sin is more than isolated mistakes: Scripture describes rebellion, guilt, corruption, idolatry, enslavement, and death. The human problem is universal and cannot be solved by moral effort alone, yet the image of God is not erased and God's redemptive purpose aims at renewed humanity.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Romans 3:23 (NASB 2020)

"All have sinned and fall short of the glory of God."

Primary core reading: Genesis 1:26-28 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²⁶ God said, "Let us make man in our image, after our likeness: and let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the birds of the sky, and over the livestock, and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creeps on the earth." ²⁷ God created man in his own image. In God's image he created him; male and female he created them. ²⁸ God blessed them. God said to them, "Be fruitful, multiply, fill the earth, and subdue it. Have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the sky, and over every living thing that moves on the earth."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Genesis 3:1-19 (WEB)

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¹ Now the serpent was more subtle than any animal of the field which Yahweh God had made. He said to the woman, "Has God really said, 'You shall not eat of any tree of the garden?'" ² The woman said to the serpent, "Of the fruit of the trees of the garden we may eat, ³ but of the fruit of the tree which is in the middle of the garden, God has said, 'You shall not eat of it, neither shall you touch it, lest you die.'" ⁴ The serpent said to the woman, "You won't surely die,

⁵ for God knows that in the day you eat it, your eyes will be opened, and you will be like God, knowing good and evil." ⁶ When the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was a delight to the eyes, and that the tree was to be desired to make one wise, she took of its fruit, and ate; and she gave some to her husband with her, and he ate. ⁷ The eyes of both of them were opened, and they knew that they were naked. They sewed fig leaves together, and made themselves aprons. ⁸ They heard the voice of Yahweh God walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and the man and his wife hid themselves from the presence of Yahweh God among the trees of the garden.

⁹ Yahweh God called to the man, and said to him, "Where are you?" ¹⁰ The man said, "I heard your voice in the garden, and I was afraid, because I was naked; and I hid myself." ¹¹ God said, "Who told you that you were naked? Have you eaten from the tree that I commanded you not to eat from?" ¹² The man said, "The woman whom you gave to be with me, she gave me of the tree, and I ate."

¹³ Yahweh God said to the woman, "What is this you have done?" The woman said, "The serpent deceived me, and I ate." ¹⁴ Yahweh God said to the serpent, "Because you have done this, you are cursed above all livestock, and above every animal of the field. On your belly you shall go, and you shall eat dust all the days of your life. ¹⁵ I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and her offspring. He will bruise your head, and you will bruise his heel." ¹⁶ To the woman he said, "I will greatly multiply your pain in childbirth. In pain you will bear children. Your desire will be for your husband, and he will rule over you."

¹⁷ To Adam he said, "Because you have listened to your wife's voice, and have eaten of the tree, of which I commanded you, saying, 'You shall not eat of it,' cursed is the ground for your sake. In toil you will eat of it all the days of your life. ¹⁸ It will yield thorns and thistles to you; and you will eat the herb of the field. ¹⁹ By the sweat of your face will you eat bread until you return to the ground, for out of it you were taken. For you are dust, and to dust you shall return."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Romans 3:9-26 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁹ What then? Are we better than they? No, in no way. For we previously warned both Jews and Greeks, that they are all under sin. ¹⁰ As it is written, "There is no one righteous; no, not one." ¹¹ There is no one who understands. There is no one who seeks after God. ¹² They have all turned aside. They have together become unprofitable. There is no one who does good, no, not, so much as one."

¹³ "Their throat is an open tomb. With their tongues they have used deceit." "The poison of vipers is under their lips;" ¹⁴ "whose mouth is full of cursing and bitterness." ¹⁵ "Their feet are swift to shed blood. ¹⁶ Destruction and misery are in their ways.

¹⁷ The way of peace, they haven't known." ¹⁸ "There is no fear of God before their eyes." ¹⁹ Now we know that whatever things the law says, it speaks to those who are under the law, that every mouth may be closed, and all the world may be brought under the judgment of God. ²⁰ Because by the works of the law, no flesh will be justified in his sight. For through the law comes the knowledge of sin.

²¹ But now apart from the law, a righteousness of God has been revealed, being testified by the law and the prophets; ²² even the righteousness of God through faith in Jesus Christ to all and on all those who believe. For there is no distinction, ²³ for all have sinned, and fall short of the glory of God; ²⁴ being justified freely by his grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus;

²⁵ whom God set forth to be an atoning sacrifice, through faith in his blood, for a demonstration of his righteousness through the passing over of prior sins, in God's forbearance; ²⁶ to demonstrate his righteousness at this present time; that he might himself be just, and the justifier of him who has faith in Jesus.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Ephesians 2:1-5 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ You were made alive when you were dead in transgressions and sins, ² in which you once walked according to the course of this world, according to the prince of the power of the air, the spirit who now works in the children of disobedience; ³ among whom we also all once lived in the lust of our flesh, doing the desires of the flesh and of the mind, and were by nature children of wrath, even as the rest. ⁴ But God, being rich in mercy, for his great love with which he loved us,

⁵ even when we were dead through our trespasses, made us alive together with Christ (by grace you have been saved),

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Human dignity and human fallenness must both be affirmed.
- Sin disorders worship, desire, relationships, society, and creation.
- All people stand in need of grace.
- Redemption restores communion with God and begins the renewal of human life.

Further references: Psalm 51:1-12; Isaiah 53:6; Jeremiah 17:9-10; Mark 7:20-23; Romans 5:12-21; Romans 6:20-23; James 3:8-10; 1 John 1:8-10.

7. Salvation: The Biblical Story and Order of Grace

Salvation in Scripture is broad: deliverance from guilt, slavery, wrath, death, and the powers of evil; reconciliation with God; incorporation into Christ; adoption; sanctification; perseverance; resurrection; and final glorification. The New Testament can describe salvation as past, present, and future. Different traditions arrange the relation of election, calling, faith, regeneration, justification, sacraments, perseverance, and final judgment differently, but salvation is consistently grounded in God's action in Christ.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Ephesians 2:8 (NASB 2020)

"By grace you have been saved through faith."

Primary core reading: John 3:14-21 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁴ As Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, even so must the Son of Man be lifted up, ¹⁵ that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life. ¹⁶ For God so loved the world, that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life. ¹⁷ For God didn't send his Son into the world to judge the world, but that the world should be saved through him.

¹⁸ He who believes in him is not judged. He who doesn't believe has been judged already, because he has not believed in the name of the one and only Son of God. ¹⁹ This is the judgment, that the light has come into the world, and men loved the darkness rather than the light; for their works were evil. ²⁰ For everyone who does evil hates the light, and doesn't come to the light, lest his works would be exposed. ²¹ But he who does the truth comes to the light, that his works may be revealed, that they have been done in God."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Romans 5:1-11 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Being therefore justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ; ² through whom we also have our access by faith into this grace in which we stand. We rejoice in hope of the glory of God. ³ Not only this, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, knowing that suffering works perseverance; ⁴ and perseverance, proven character; and proven character, hope:

⁵ and hope doesn't disappoint us, because God's love has been poured out into our hearts through the Holy Spirit who was given to us. ⁶ For while we were yet weak, at the right time Christ died for the ungodly. ⁷ For one will hardly die for a righteous man. Yet perhaps for a righteous person someone would even dare to die. ⁸ But God commends his own love toward us, in that while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.

⁹ Much more then, being now justified by his blood, we will be saved from God's wrath through him. ¹⁰ For if, while we were enemies, we were reconciled to God through the death of his Son, much more, being reconciled, we will be saved by his life. ¹¹ Not only so, but we also rejoice in God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have now received the reconciliation.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Ephesians 2:4-10 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴ But God, being rich in mercy, for his great love with which he loved us, ⁵ even when we were dead through our trespasses, made us alive together with Christ (by grace you have been saved), ⁶ and raised us up with him, and made us to sit with him in the heavenly places in Christ Jesus, ⁷ that in the ages to come he might show the exceeding riches of his grace in kindness toward us in Christ Jesus;

⁸ for by grace you have been saved through faith, and that not of yourselves; it is the gift of God, ⁹ not of works, that no one would boast. ¹⁰ For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared before that we would walk in them.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Titus 3:3-7 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

³ For we were also once foolish, disobedient, deceived, serving various lusts and pleasures, living in malice and envy, hateful, and hating one another. ⁴ But when the kindness of God our Savior and his love toward mankind appeared, ⁵ not by works of righteousness, which we did ourselves, but according to his mercy, he saved us, through the washing of regeneration and renewing by the Holy Spirit, ⁶ whom he poured out on us richly, through Jesus Christ our Savior;

⁷ that, being justified by his grace, we might be made heirs according to the hope of eternal life.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Salvation originates in divine mercy, not human merit.
- Christ's death and resurrection are its objective foundation.
- Faith receives Christ and his benefits; genuine faith turns toward obedience.
- Salvation reaches its completion in resurrection and the renewal of creation.

Further references: Acts 2:37-39; Acts 16:30-34; Romans 8:28-39; Romans 10:8-13; 1 Corinthians 6:9-11; 2 Corinthians 5:17-21; Hebrews 7:24-27; 1 Peter 1:3-9.

8. Grace

Grace is God's unearned favor and effective generosity toward the undeserving. It is revealed supremely in Jesus Christ, pardons sin, creates a new people, trains believers in holiness, supplies strength in weakness, and empowers service. Biblical grace opposes boasting and self-salvation, but it does not oppose effort produced by the Spirit.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Titus 2:11 (NASB 2020)

"The grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation to all people."

Primary core reading: Romans 3:21-28 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²¹ But now apart from the law, a righteousness of God has been revealed, being testified by the law and the prophets; ²² even the righteousness of God through faith in Jesus Christ to all and on all those who believe. For there is no distinction, ²³ for all have sinned, and fall short of the glory of God; ²⁴ being justified freely by his grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus;

²⁵ whom God set forth to be an atoning sacrifice, through faith in his blood, for a demonstration of his righteousness through the passing over of prior sins, in God's forbearance; ²⁶ to demonstrate his righteousness at this present time; that he might himself be just, and the justifier of him who has faith in Jesus. ²⁷ Where then is the boasting? It is excluded. By what kind of law? Of works? No, but by a law of faith. ²⁸ We maintain therefore that a man is justified by faith apart from the works of the law.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Romans 5:15-21 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁵ But the free gift isn't like the trespass. For if by the trespass of the one the many died, much more did the grace of God, and the gift by the grace of the one man, Jesus Christ, abound to the many. ¹⁶ The gift is not as through one who sinned: for the judgment came by one to condemnation, but the free gift came of many trespasses to justification. ¹⁷ For if by the trespass of the one, death reigned through the one; so much more will those who receive the abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness reign in life through the one, Jesus Christ. ¹⁸ So then as through one trespass, all men were condemned; even so through one act of righteousness, all men were justified to life.

¹⁹ For as through the one man's disobedience many were made sinners, even so through the obedience of the one, many will be made righteous. ²⁰ The law came in besides, that the trespass might abound; but where sin abounded, grace abounded more exceedingly; ²¹ that as sin reigned in death, even so grace might reign through righteousness to eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Ephesians 2:4-10 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴ But God, being rich in mercy, for his great love with which he loved us, ⁵ even when we were dead through our trespasses, made us alive together with Christ (by grace you have been saved), ⁶ and raised us up with him, and made us to sit with him in the heavenly places in Christ Jesus, ⁷ that in the ages to come he might show the exceeding riches of his grace in kindness toward us in Christ Jesus;

⁸ for by grace you have been saved through faith, and that not of yourselves; it is the gift of God, ⁹ not of works, that no one would boast. ¹⁰ For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared before that we would walk in them.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Titus 2:11-14 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹¹ For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation to all men, ¹² instructing us to the intent that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we would live soberly, righteously, and godly in this present world; ¹³ looking for the blessed hope and appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior, Jesus Christ; ¹⁴ who gave himself for us, that he might redeem us from all iniquity, and purify for himself a people for his own possession, zealous for good works.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Grace is gift, not wage.
- Grace both forgives and transforms.
- The appropriate response is faith, gratitude, worship, and Spirit-enabled obedience.
- Grace destroys boasting while creating generous service.

Further references: Exodus 33:12-19; John 1:14-17; Acts 15:7-11; Romans 11:5-6; 1 Corinthians 15:9-10; 2 Corinthians 12:7-10; Hebrews 4:14-16; 1 Peter 5:10-12.

9. Faith and Repentance

Biblical faith is trust, allegiance, and reliance on God's promise; repentance is a Spirit-enabled turning from sin toward God. They are distinguishable but inseparable in conversion: the gospel calls people to turn and believe. Faith is not mere intellectual assent, while repentance is not self-punishment or an attempt to earn pardon.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Mark 1:15 (NASB 2020)

"Repent and believe in the gospel."

Primary core reading: Mark 1:14-15 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁴ Now after John was taken into custody, Jesus came into Galilee, preaching the Good News of the Kingdom of God, ¹⁵ and saying, "The time is fulfilled, and the Kingdom of God is at hand! Repent, and believe in the Good News."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Luke 18:9-14 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁹ He spoke also this parable to certain people who were convinced of their own righteousness, and who despised all others. ¹⁰ "Two men went up into the temple to pray; one was a Pharisee, and the other was a tax collector. ¹¹ The Pharisee stood and prayed to himself like this: 'God, I thank you, that I am not like the rest of men, extortioners, unrighteous, adulterers, or even like this tax collector. ¹² I fast twice a week. I give tithes of all that I get.'

¹³ But the tax collector, standing far away, wouldn't even lift up his eyes to heaven, but beat his breast, saying, 'God, be merciful to me, a sinner!' ¹⁴ I tell you, this man went down to his house justified rather than the other; for everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, but he who humbles himself will be exalted."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Acts 2:37-41 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

³⁷ Now when they heard this, they were cut to the heart, and said to Peter and the rest of the apostles, "Brothers, what shall we do?" ³⁸ Peter said to them, "Repent, and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of sins, and you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit. ³⁹ For the promise is to you, and to your children, and to all who are far off, even as many as the Lord our God will call to himself." ⁴⁰ With many other words he testified, and exhorted them, saying, "Save yourselves from this crooked generation!"

⁴¹ Then those who gladly received his word were baptized. There were added that day about three thousand souls.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Romans 4:16-25 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁶ For this cause it is of faith, that it may be according to grace, to the end that the promise may be sure to all the seed, not to that only which is of the law, but to that also which is of the faith of Abraham, who is the father of us all. ¹⁷ As it is written, "I have made you a father of many nations." This is in the presence of him whom he believed: God, who gives life to the dead, and calls the things that are not, as though they were. ¹⁸ Who in hope believed against hope, to the end that he might become a father of many nations, according to that which had been spoken, "So will your seed be." ¹⁹ Without being weakened in faith, he didn't consider his own body, already having been worn out, (he being about a hundred years old), and the deadness of Sarah's womb.

²⁰ Yet, looking to the promise of God, he didn't waver through unbelief, but grew strong through faith, giving glory to God, ²¹ and being fully assured that what he had promised, he was also able to perform. ²² Therefore it also was "reckoned to him for righteousness." ²³ Now it was not written that it was accounted to him for his sake alone, ²⁴ but for our sake also, to whom it will be accounted, who believe in him who raised Jesus, our Lord, from the dead, ²⁵ who was delivered up for our trespasses, and was raised for our justification.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: James 2:14-26 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁴ What good is it, my brothers, if a man says he has faith, but has no works? Can faith save him? ¹⁵ And if a brother or sister is naked and in lack of daily food, ¹⁶ and one of you tells them, "Go in peace, be warmed and filled;" and yet you didn't give them the things the body needs, what good is it? ¹⁷ Even so faith, if it has no works, is dead in itself.

¹⁸ Yes, a man will say, "You have faith, and I have works." Show me your faith without works, and I by my works will show you my faith. ¹⁹ You believe that God is one. You do well. The demons also believe, and shudder. ²⁰ But do you want to know, vain man, that faith apart from works is dead? ²¹ Wasn't Abraham our father justified by works, in that he offered up Isaac his son on the altar?

²² You see that faith worked with his works, and by works faith was perfected; ²³ and the Scripture was fulfilled which says, "Abraham believed God, and it was accounted to him as righteousness;" and he was called the friend of God. ²⁴ You see then that by works, a man is justified, and not only by faith. ²⁵ In the same way, wasn't Rahab the prostitute also justified by works, in that she received the messengers, and sent them out another way?

²⁶ For as the body apart from the spirit is dead, even so faith apart from works is dead.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Faith rests on the character and promise of God.
- Repentance includes confession, changed direction, and fruits consistent with turning.
- Works do not purchase justification, but living faith is fruitful.
- Doubt and weakness are met by returning to Christ, not by pretending confidence.

Further references: Genesis 15:1-6; Psalm 32:1-5; Isaiah 55:6-7; Habakkuk 2:4; Luke 15:11-24; Acts 17:30-31; Romans 10:9-13; 2 Corinthians 7:9-11.

10. Justification, Adoption, and Assurance

Justification describes God's gracious declaration that sinners are righteous in relation to him because of Christ; adoption describes their reception into God's family; assurance concerns confidence in God's promise and the Spirit's witness. Christian traditions differ on the precise relation between imputed righteousness, infused righteousness, sacramental life, perseverance, and final judgment, but all insist that confidence must rest in God's mercy rather than self-congratulation.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Romans 5:1 (NASB 2020)

"Having been justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ."

Primary core reading: Romans 3:23-28 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²³ for all have sinned, and fall short of the glory of God; ²⁴ being justified freely by his grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus; ²⁵ whom God set forth to be an atoning sacrifice, through faith in his blood, for a demonstration of his righteousness through the passing over of prior sins, in God's forbearance; ²⁶ to demonstrate his righteousness at this present time; that he might himself be just, and the justifier of him who has faith in Jesus.

²⁷ Where then is the boasting? It is excluded. By what kind of law? Of works? No, but by a law of faith. ²⁸ We maintain therefore that a man is justified by faith apart from the works of the law.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Romans 8:1-17 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Christ Jesus, who don't walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit. ² For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus made me free from the law of sin and of death. ³ For what the law couldn't do, in that it was weak through the flesh, God did, sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh and for sin, he condemned sin in the flesh; ⁴ that the ordinance of the law might be fulfilled in us, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.

⁵ For those who live according to the flesh set their minds on the things of the flesh, but those who live according to the Spirit, the things of the Spirit. ⁶ For the mind of the flesh is death, but the mind of the Spirit is life and peace; ⁷ because the mind of the flesh is hostile towards God; for it is not subject to God's law, neither indeed can it be. ⁸ Those who are in the flesh can't please God.

⁹ But you are not in the flesh but in the Spirit, if it is so that the Spirit of God dwells in you. But if any man doesn't have the Spirit of Christ, he is not his. ¹⁰ If Christ is in you, the body is dead because of sin, but the spirit is alive because of righteousness. ¹¹ But if the Spirit of him who raised up Jesus from the dead dwells in you, he who raised up Christ Jesus from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through his Spirit who dwells in you. ¹² So then, brothers, we are debtors, not to the flesh, to live after the flesh.

¹³ For if you live after the flesh, you must die; but if by the Spirit you put to death the deeds of the body, you will live. ¹⁴ For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, these are children of God. ¹⁵ For you didn't receive the spirit of bondage again to fear, but you received the Spirit of adoption, by whom we cry, "Abba! Father!" ¹⁶ The Spirit himself testifies with our spirit that we are children of God;

¹⁷ and if children, then heirs; heirs of God, and joint heirs with Christ; if indeed we suffer with him, that we may also be glorified with him.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Galatians 4:4-7 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴ But when the fullness of the time came, God sent out his Son, born to a woman, born under the law, ⁵ that he might redeem those who were under the law, that we might receive the adoption of children. ⁶ And because you are children, God sent out the Spirit of his Son into your hearts, crying, "Abba, Father!" ⁷ So you are no longer a bondservant, but a son; and if a son, then an heir of God through Christ.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 John 5:9-13 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁹ If we receive the witness of men, the witness of God is greater; for this is God's testimony which he has testified concerning his Son. ¹⁰ He who believes in the Son of God has the testimony in himself. He who doesn't believe God has made him a liar, because he has not believed in the testimony that God has given concerning his Son. ¹¹ The testimony is this, that God gave to us eternal life, and this life is in his Son. ¹² He who has the Son has the life. He who doesn't have God's Son doesn't have the life.

¹³ These things I have written to you who believe in the name of the Son of God, that you may know that you have eternal life, and that you may continue to believe in the name of the Son of God.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Justification answers guilt and condemnation.
- Adoption gives a new identity, inheritance, and access to God as Father.
- Assurance is grounded in Christ's finished work, God's promises, and the Spirit's testimony.
- Self-examination has a place, but assurance is not the same as sinless perfection.

Further references: Psalm 130:1-8; Luke 18:13-14; Romans 5:1-2; Romans 8:31-39; 2 Corinthians 5:21; Galatians 2:15-21; Hebrews 10:19-23; 2 Peter 1:5-11.

11. Sanctification and Holiness

Sanctification is both a status granted in Christ and an ongoing work by which the Spirit conforms believers to Christ. Scripture calls Christians already holy and simultaneously commands them to pursue holiness. Growth involves renewed minds, disciplined bodies, mortification of sin, practiced virtue, worship, community, suffering, and dependence on grace.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - 1 Thessalonians 4:3 (NASB 2020)

“This is the will of God, your sanctification.”

Primary core reading: Romans 6:1-14 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ What shall we say then? Shall we continue in sin, that grace may abound? ² May it never be! We who died to sin, how could we live in it any longer? ³ Or don't you know that all we who were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death? ⁴ We were buried therefore with him through baptism to death, that just like Christ was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, so we also might walk in newness of life.

⁵ For if we have become united with him in the likeness of his death, we will also be part of his resurrection; ⁶ knowing this, that our old man was crucified with him, that the body of sin might be done away with, so that we would no longer be in bondage to sin. ⁷ For he who has died has been freed from sin. ⁸ But if we died with Christ, we believe that we will also live with him;

⁹ knowing that Christ, being raised from the dead, dies no more. Death no more has dominion over him! ¹⁰ For the death that he died, he died to sin one time; but the life that he lives, he lives to God. ¹¹ Thus consider yourselves also to be dead to sin, but alive to God in Christ Jesus our Lord. ¹² Therefore don't let sin reign in your mortal body, that you should obey it in its lusts.

¹³ Neither present your members to sin as instruments of unrighteousness, but present yourselves to God, as alive from the dead, and your members as instruments of righteousness to God. ¹⁴ For sin will not have dominion over you. For you are not under law, but under grace.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Romans 12:1-2 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Therefore I urge you, brothers, by the mercies of God, to present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, which is your spiritual service. ² Don't be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, so that you may prove what is the good, well-pleasing, and perfect will of God.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Thessalonians 4:1-8 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Finally then, brothers, we beg and exhort you in the Lord Jesus, that as you received from us how you ought to walk and to please God, that you abound more and more. ² For you know what instructions we gave you through the Lord Jesus. ³ For this is the will of God: your sanctification, that you abstain from sexual immorality, ⁴ that each one of you know how to possess himself of his own vessel in sanctification and honor,

⁵ not in the passion of lust, even as the Gentiles who don't know God; ⁶ that no one should take advantage of and wrong a brother or sister in this matter; because the Lord is an avenger in all these things, as also we forewarned you and testified. ⁷ For God called us not for uncleanness, but in sanctification. ⁸ Therefore he who rejects this doesn't reject man, but God, who has also given his Holy Spirit to you.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Hebrews 12:10-15 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁰ For they indeed, for a few days, punished us as seemed good to them; but he for our profit, that we may be partakers of his holiness. ¹¹ All chastening seems for the present to be not joyous but grievous; yet afterward it yields the peaceful fruit of righteousness to those who have been exercised thereby. ¹² Therefore, lift up the hands that hang down and the feeble knees, ¹³ and make straight paths for your feet, so that which is lame may not be dislocated, but rather be healed.

¹⁴ Follow after peace with all men, and the sanctification without which no man will see the Lord, ¹⁵ looking carefully lest there be any man who falls short of the grace of God; lest any root of bitterness springing up trouble you, and many be defiled by it;

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Union with Christ changes the believer's relationship to sin.
- Holiness is not isolation from people but consecration to God in every sphere.
- Transformation is progressive and communal, not merely private.
- Final sanctification will be completed when believers see Christ.

Further references: Leviticus 19:1-2; Psalm 51:10-12; John 17:15-19; 2 Corinthians 3:17-18; Galatians 5:16-25; Philippians 2:12-13; 1 Peter 1:13-16; 1 John 3:1-3.

12. Good Works, Obedience, and Reward

The Bible denies that works can place God in our debt, yet it repeatedly commands obedience and speaks of judgment according to deeds. Works are the fruit and evidence of living faith, the vocation for which believers are recreated, and the means by which neighbors are served and God is glorified. Texts on reward should be read alongside texts on grace so that reward does not become self-salvation.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Ephesians 2:10 (NASB 2020)

"We are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works."

Primary core reading: Matthew 5:13-16 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹³ "You are the salt of the earth, but if the salt has lost its flavor, with what will it be salted? It is then good for nothing, but to be cast out and trodden under the feet of men. ¹⁴ You are the light of the world. A city located on a hill can't be hidden. ¹⁵ Neither do you light a lamp, and put it under a measuring basket, but on a stand; and it shines to all who are in the house. ¹⁶ Even so, let your light shine before men; that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father who is in heaven.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Ephesians 2:8-10 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁸ for by grace you have been saved through faith, and that not of yourselves; it is the gift of God, ⁹ not of works, that no one would boast. ¹⁰ For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared before that we would walk in them.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: James 2:14-26 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁴ What good is it, my brothers, if a man says he has faith, but has no works? Can faith save him? ¹⁵ And if a brother or sister is naked and in lack of daily food, ¹⁶ and one of you tells them, "Go in peace, be warmed and filled;" and yet you didn't give them the things the body needs, what good is it? ¹⁷ Even so faith, if it has no works, is dead in itself.

¹⁸ Yes, a man will say, "You have faith, and I have works." Show me your faith without works, and I by my works will show you my faith. ¹⁹ You believe that God is one. You do well. The demons also believe, and shudder. ²⁰ But do you want to know, vain man, that faith apart from works is dead? ²¹ Wasn't Abraham our father justified by works, in that he offered up Isaac his son on the altar?

²² You see that faith worked with his works, and by works faith was perfected; ²³ and the Scripture was fulfilled which says, "Abraham believed God, and it was accounted to him as righteousness;" and he was called the friend of God. ²⁴ You see then that by works, a man is justified, and not only by faith. ²⁵ In the same way, wasn't Rahab the prostitute also justified by works, in that she received the messengers, and sent them out another way?

²⁶ For as the body apart from the spirit is dead, even so faith apart from works is dead.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Revelation 22:10-14 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁰ He said to me, "Don't seal up the words of the prophecy of this book, for the time is at hand. ¹¹ He who acts unjustly, let him act unjustly still. He who is filthy, let him be filthy still. He who is righteous, let him do righteousness still. He who is holy, let him be holy still." ¹² "Behold, I come quickly. My reward is with me, to repay to each man according to his work. ¹³ I am the Alpha and the Omega, the First and the Last, the Beginning and the End.

¹⁴ Blessed are those who do his commandments, that they may have the right to the tree of life, and may enter in by the gates into the city.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Works are not the foundation of salvation but belong to its purpose.
- Obedience reveals what one trusts and loves.
- God promises reward without becoming indebted to human merit.
- Hidden acts of mercy, integrity, and faithfulness matter before God.

Further references: Micah 6:6-8; Matthew 6:1-4; Matthew 7:15-27; John 14:15; Romans 2:5-11; 1 Corinthians 3:10-15; Titus 3:8; 1 Peter 2:11-12.

13. The Law

The biblical word law can refer to the Torah as a whole, particular commandments, the covenant given through Moses, or a principle at work. The law reveals God's character, orders Israel's life, exposes sin, and points beyond itself. Christians agree that moral instruction remains significant, but differ over how Mosaic commands apply under the new covenant and how to classify moral, civil, and ceremonial dimensions.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Matthew 5:17 (NASB 2020)

"I did not come to abolish, but to fulfill."

Primary core reading: Exodus 20:1-17 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ God spoke all these words, saying, ² "I am Yahweh your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. ³ "You shall have no other gods before me. ⁴ "You shall not make for yourselves an idol, nor any image of anything that is in the heavens above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth:

⁵ you shall not bow yourself down to them, nor serve them, for I, Yahweh your God, am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children, on the third and on the fourth generation of those who hate me, ⁶ and showing loving kindness to thousands of those who love me and keep my commandments. ⁷ "You shall not take the name of Yahweh your God in vain, for Yahweh will not hold him guiltless who takes his name in vain. ⁸ "Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy.

⁹ You shall labor six days, and do all your work, ¹⁰ but the seventh day is a Sabbath to Yahweh your God. You shall not do any work in it, you, nor your son, nor your daughter, your male servant, nor your female servant, nor your livestock, nor your stranger who is within your gates; ¹¹ for in six days Yahweh made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that is in them, and rested the seventh day; therefore Yahweh blessed the Sabbath day, and made it holy. ¹² "Honor your father and your mother, that your days may be long in the land which Yahweh your God gives you.

¹³ "You shall not murder. ¹⁴ "You shall not commit adultery. ¹⁵ "You shall not steal. ¹⁶ "You shall not give false testimony against your neighbor.

¹⁷ "You shall not covet your neighbor's house. You shall not covet your neighbor's wife, nor his male servant, nor his female servant, nor his ox, nor his donkey, nor anything that is your neighbor's."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Psalm 19:7-11 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁷ Yahweh's law is perfect, restoring the soul. Yahweh's testimony is sure, making wise the simple. ⁸ Yahweh's precepts are right, rejoicing the heart. Yahweh's commandment is pure, enlightening the eyes.

⁹ The fear of Yahweh is clean, enduring forever. Yahweh's ordinances are true, and righteous altogether. ¹⁰ More to be desired are they than gold, yes, than much fine gold; sweeter also than honey and the extract of the honeycomb.

¹¹ Moreover by them is your servant warned. In keeping them there is great reward.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Matthew 5:17-20 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁷ “Don’t think that I came to destroy the law or the prophets. I didn’t come to destroy, but to fulfill. ¹⁸ For most certainly, I tell you, until heaven and earth pass away, not even one smallest letter or one tiny pen stroke shall in any way pass away from the law, until all things are accomplished. ¹⁹ Whoever, therefore, shall break one of these least commandments, and teach others to do so, shall be called least in the Kingdom of Heaven; but whoever shall do and teach them shall be called great in the Kingdom of Heaven. ²⁰ For I tell you that unless your righteousness exceeds that of the scribes and Pharisees, there is no way you will enter into the Kingdom of Heaven.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Romans 7:7-13 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁷ What shall we say then? Is the law sin? May it never be! However, I wouldn’t have known sin, except through the law. For I wouldn’t have known coveting, unless the law had said, “You shall not covet.” ⁸ But sin, finding occasion through the commandment, produced in me all kinds of coveting. For apart from the law, sin is dead. ⁹ I was alive apart from the law once, but when the commandment came, sin revived, and I died. ¹⁰ The commandment, which was for life, this I found to be for death;

¹¹ for sin, finding occasion through the commandment, deceived me, and through it killed me. ¹² Therefore the law indeed is holy, and the commandment holy, and righteous, and good. ¹³ Did then that which is good become death to me? May it never be! But sin, that it might be shown to be sin, by working death to me through that which is good; that through the commandment sin might become exceeding sinful.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Galatians 3:19-29 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁹ What then is the law? It was added because of transgressions, until the seed should come to whom the promise has been made. It was ordained through angels by the hand of a mediator. ²⁰ Now a mediator is not between one, but God is one. ²¹ Is the law then against the promises of God? Certainly not! For if there had been a law given which could make alive, most certainly righteousness would have been of the law. ²² But the Scriptures imprisoned all things under sin, that the promise by faith in Jesus Christ might be given to those who believe.

²³ But before faith came, we were kept in custody under the law, confined for the faith which should afterwards be revealed. ²⁴ So that the law has become our tutor to bring us to Christ, that we might be justified by faith. ²⁵ But now that faith has come, we are no longer under a tutor. ²⁶ For you are all children of God, through faith in Christ Jesus.

²⁷ For as many of you as were baptized into Christ have put on Christ. ²⁸ There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free man, there is neither male nor female; for you are all one in Christ Jesus. ²⁹ If you are Christ’s, then you are Abraham’s seed and heirs according to promise.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- The law is good, but human sin turns commandment into an occasion for condemnation.
- Jesus fulfills the law and deepens its demand to the heart.
- The law cannot impart life; the Spirit writes God's will on renewed hearts.
- Application requires attention to covenant, genre, fulfillment, and the love of God and neighbor.

Further references: Deuteronomy 6:4-9; Jeremiah 31:31-34; Matthew 22:34-40; Romans 3:19-20; Romans 8:1-4; Romans 13:8-10; Colossians 2:13-17; Hebrews 8:6-13.

14. Covenant and the Kingdom of God

Covenant is a major biblical framework for God's committed relationship with creation, Noah, Abraham, Israel, David, and the new-covenant people. The kingdom is God's saving reign breaking into history and moving toward universal renewal. The covenants are related in different ways by covenant theology, dispensational theology, and other traditions, but all seek to explain the unity and development of God's promises.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Jeremiah 31:33 (NASB 2020)

"I will put My law within them and write it on their heart."

Primary core reading: Genesis 12:1-3 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Now Yahweh said to Abram, "Get out of your country, and from your relatives, and from your father's house, to the land that I will show you. ² I will make of you a great nation. I will bless you and make your name great. You will be a blessing. ³ I will bless those who bless you, and I will curse him who curses you. All of the families of the earth will be blessed in you."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: 2 Samuel 7:8-16 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁸ Now therefore you shall tell my servant David this, "Thus says Yahweh of Armies, "I took you from the sheep pen, from following the sheep, that you should be prince over my people, over Israel. ⁹ I have been with you wherever you went, and have cut off all your enemies from before you. I will make you a great name, like the name of the great ones who are in the earth. ¹⁰ I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, that they may dwell in their own place, and be moved no more; neither shall the children of wickedness afflict them any more, as at the first, ¹¹ and as from the day that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel. I will cause you to rest from all your enemies. Moreover Yahweh tells you that Yahweh will make you a house.

¹² When your days are fulfilled, and you shall sleep with your fathers, I will set up your seed after you, who shall proceed out of your bowels, and I will establish his kingdom. ¹³ He shall build a house for my name, and I will establish the throne of his kingdom forever. ¹⁴ I will be his father, and he shall be my son. If he commits iniquity, I will chasten him with the rod of men, and with the stripes of the children of men; ¹⁵ but my loving kindness shall not depart from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I put away before you.

¹⁶ Your house and your kingdom shall be made sure forever before you. Your throne shall be established forever.'"

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Jeremiah 31:31-34 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

³¹ Behold, the days come, says Yahweh, that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Judah: ³² not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day that I took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt; which my covenant they broke, although I was a husband to them, says Yahweh.

³³ But this is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel after those days, says Yahweh: I will put my law in their inward parts, and in their heart will I write it; and I will be their God, and they shall be my people: ³⁴ and they shall teach no more every man his neighbor, and every man his brother, saying, Know Yahweh; for they shall all know me, from their least to their greatest, says Yahweh: for I will forgive their iniquity, and their sin will I remember no more.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Mark 1:14-15 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁴ Now after John was taken into custody, Jesus came into Galilee, preaching the Good News of the Kingdom of God,
¹⁵ and saying, "The time is fulfilled, and the Kingdom of God is at hand! Repent, and believe in the Good News."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Luke 22:14-20 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁴ When the hour had come, he sat down with the twelve apostles. ¹⁵ He said to them, "I have earnestly desired to eat this Passover with you before I suffer, ¹⁶ for I tell you, I will no longer by any means eat of it until it is fulfilled in the Kingdom of God." ¹⁷ He received a cup, and when he had given thanks, he said, "Take this, and share it among yourselves,

¹⁸ for I tell you, I will not drink at all again from the fruit of the vine, until the Kingdom of God comes." ¹⁹ He took bread, and when he had given thanks, he broke it, and gave to them, saying, "This is my body which is given for you. Do this in memory of me." ²⁰ Likewise, he took the cup after supper, saying, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- God binds himself by promise and calls for covenant faithfulness.
- The Abrahamic promise includes blessing for all nations.
- The Davidic promise shapes messianic hope.
- Jesus announces and embodies the kingdom and inaugurates the new covenant.

Further references: Genesis 9:8-17; Genesis 15:1-18; Exodus 19:3-6; Isaiah 9:6-7; Daniel 7:13-14; Matthew 6:9-10; 1 Corinthians 11:23-26; Revelation 11:15.

15. The Church

The church is the assembly called by God through the gospel: Christ's body, God's household, a holy temple, a royal priesthood, and a witnessing people. It is both local and universal, visible in concrete communities and known perfectly only to God. The church gathers for teaching, fellowship, prayer, sacrament, discipline, worship, mercy, and mission.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Acts 2:42 (NASB 2020)

"They were continually devoting themselves to the apostles' teaching and to fellowship."

Primary core reading: Matthew 16:13-19 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹³ Now when Jesus came into the parts of Caesarea Philippi, he asked his disciples, saying, "Who do men say that I, the Son of Man, am?" ¹⁴ They said, "Some say John the Baptizer, some, Elijah, and others, Jeremiah, or one of the prophets." ¹⁵ He said to them, "But who do you say that I am?" ¹⁶ Simon Peter answered, "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God."

¹⁷ Jesus answered him, "Blessed are you, Simon Bar Jonah, for flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but my Father who is in heaven. ¹⁸ I also tell you that you are Peter, and on this rock I will build my assembly, and the gates of Hades will not prevail against it. ¹⁹ I will give to you the keys of the Kingdom of Heaven, and whatever you bind on earth will have been bound in heaven; and whatever you release on earth will have been released in heaven."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Acts 2:41-47 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴¹ Then those who gladly received his word were baptized. There were added that day about three thousand souls.

⁴² They continued steadfastly in the apostles' teaching and fellowship, in the breaking of bread, and prayer. ⁴³ Fear came on every soul, and many wonders and signs were done through the apostles. ⁴⁴ All who believed were together, and had all things in common.

⁴⁵ They sold their possessions and goods, and distributed them to all, according as anyone had need. ⁴⁶ Day by day, continuing steadfastly with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread at home, they took their food with gladness and singleness of heart, ⁴⁷ praising God, and having favor with all the people. The Lord added to the assembly day by day those who were being saved.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 12:12-27 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹² For as the body is one, and has many members, and all the members of the body, being many, are one body; so also is Christ. ¹³ For in one Spirit we were all baptized into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, whether bond or free; and were all given to drink into one Spirit. ¹⁴ For the body is not one member, but many. ¹⁵ If the foot would say, "Because I'm not the hand, I'm not part of the body," it is not therefore not part of the body.

¹⁶ If the ear would say, "Because I'm not the eye, I'm not part of the body," it's not therefore not part of the body. ¹⁷ If the whole body were an eye, where would the hearing be? If the whole were hearing, where would the smelling be? ¹⁸ But now God has set the members, each one of them, in the body, just as he desired. ¹⁹ If they were all one member, where would the body be?

²⁰ But now they are many members, but one body. ²¹ The eye can't tell the hand, "I have no need for you," or again the head to the feet, "I have no need for you." ²² No, much rather, those members of the body which seem to be weaker are necessary. ²³ Those parts of the body which we think to be less honorable, on those we bestow more abundant honor; and our unpresentable parts have more abundant propriety;

²⁴ whereas our presentable parts have no such need. But God composed the body together, giving more abundant honor to the inferior part, ²⁵ that there should be no division in the body, but that the members should have the same care for one another. ²⁶ When one member suffers, all the members suffer with it. Or when one member is honored, all the members rejoice with it. ²⁷ Now you are the body of Christ, and members individually.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Ephesians 2:11-22 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹¹ Therefore remember that once you, the Gentiles in the flesh, who are called "uncircumcision" by that which is called "circumcision," (in the flesh, made by hands); ¹² that you were at that time separate from Christ, alienated from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers from the covenants of the promise, having no hope and without God in the world. ¹³ But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far off are made near in the blood of Christ. ¹⁴ For he is our peace, who made both one, and broke down the middle wall of partition,

¹⁵ having abolished in the flesh the hostility, the law of commandments contained in ordinances, that he might create in himself one new man of the two, making peace; ¹⁶ and might reconcile them both in one body to God through the cross, having killed the hostility thereby. ¹⁷ He came and preached peace to you who were far off and to those who were near. ¹⁸ For through him we both have our access in one Spirit to the Father.

¹⁹ So then you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but you are fellow citizens with the saints, and of the household of God, ²⁰ being built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Christ Jesus himself being the chief cornerstone; ²¹ in whom the whole building, fitted together, grows into a holy temple in the Lord; ²² in whom you also are built together for a habitation of God in the Spirit.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Peter 2:4-10 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴ coming to him, a living stone, rejected indeed by men, but chosen by God, precious. ⁵ You also, as living stones, are built up as a spiritual house, to be a holy priesthood, to offer up spiritual sacrifices, acceptable to God through Jesus Christ. ⁶ Because it is contained in Scripture, "Behold, I lay in Zion a chief cornerstone, chosen, and precious: He who believes in him will not be disappointed." ⁷ For you who believe therefore is the honor, but for those who are disobedient, "The stone which the builders rejected, has become the chief cornerstone,"

⁸ and, "a stone of stumbling, and a rock of offense." For they stumble at the word, being disobedient, to which also they were appointed. ⁹ But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God's own possession, that you may proclaim the excellence of him who called you out of darkness into his marvelous light: ¹⁰ who in time past were no people, but now are God's people, who had not obtained mercy, but now have obtained mercy.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Christ is the church's foundation and head.
- Unity does not erase diversity of gifts, cultures, or callings.
- The church is called to holiness, discipline, reconciliation, and care for the vulnerable.
- Mission and worship belong together.

Further references: Matthew 18:15-20; Acts 20:28-32; Romans 12:3-8; 1 Corinthians 11:17-34; Ephesians 4:1-16; 1 Timothy 3:14-15; Hebrews 10:19-25; Revelation 2:1-7.

16. Prayer and Worship

Prayer is communion with God through praise, lament, confession, thanksgiving, intercession, and petition. Worship includes gathered liturgy and the whole-life offering of obedience. Scripture welcomes bold requests while training desire around God's name, kingdom, will, provision, forgiveness, and deliverance.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Matthew 6:9 (NASB 2020)

"Our Father who is in heaven, hallowed be Your name."

Primary core reading: Psalm 63:1-8 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ A Psalm by David, when he was in the desert of Judah. God, you are my God. I will earnestly seek you. My soul thirsts for you. My flesh longs for you, in a dry and weary land, where there is no water. ² So I have seen you in the sanctuary, watching your power and your glory.

³ Because your loving kindness is better than life, my lips shall praise you. ⁴ So I will bless you while I live. I will lift up my hands in your name.

⁵ My soul shall be satisfied as with the richest food. My mouth shall praise you with joyful lips, ⁶ when I remember you on my bed, and think about you in the night watches.

⁷ For you have been my help. I will rejoice in the shadow of your wings. ⁸ My soul stays close to you. Your right hand holds me up.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Matthew 6:5-15 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁵ "When you pray, you shall not be as the hypocrites, for they love to stand and pray in the synagogues and in the corners of the streets, that they may be seen by men. Most certainly, I tell you, they have received their reward. ⁶ But you, when you pray, enter into your inner room, and having shut your door, pray to your Father who is in secret, and your Father who sees in secret will reward you openly. ⁷ In praying, don't use vain repetitions, as the Gentiles do; for they think that they will be heard for their much speaking. ⁸ Therefore don't be like them, for your Father knows what things you need, before you ask him.

⁹ Pray like this: 'Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy. ¹⁰ Let your Kingdom come. Let your will be done, as in heaven, so on earth. ¹¹ Give us today our daily bread. ¹² Forgive us our debts, as we also forgive our debtors.

¹³ Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one. For yours is the Kingdom, the power, and the glory forever. Amen.' ¹⁴ "For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. ¹⁵ But if you don't forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Luke 18:1-8 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up, ² saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn’t fear God, and didn’t respect man. ³ A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’ ⁴ He wouldn’t for a while, but afterward he said to himself, ‘Though I neither fear God, nor respect man,

⁵ yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.’” ⁶ The Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷ Won’t God avenge his chosen ones, who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸ I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?”

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Philippians 4:4-7 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴ Rejoice in the Lord always! Again I will say, “Rejoice!” ⁵ Let your gentleness be known to all men. The Lord is at hand. ⁶ In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. ⁷ And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your thoughts in Christ Jesus.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Revelation 4:8-11 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁸ The four living creatures, each one of them having six wings, are full of eyes around and within. They have no rest day and night, saying, “Holy, holy, holy is the Lord God, the Almighty, who was and who is and who is to come!” ⁹ When the living creatures give glory, honor, and thanks to him who sits on the throne, to him who lives forever and ever, ¹⁰ the twenty-four elders fall down before him who sits on the throne, and worship him who lives forever and ever, and throw their crowns before the throne, saying, ¹¹ “Worthy are you, our Lord and God, the Holy One, to receive the glory, the honor, and the power, for you created all things, and because of your desire they existed, and were created!”

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Prayer is relational dependence, not a technique for controlling outcomes.
- Lament gives faithful words for grief and protest.
- Jesus teaches persistence, forgiveness, and God-centered priorities.
- Worship joins truth, affection, body, community, and obedience.

Further references: 1 Samuel 1:9-18; Psalm 13:1-6; Psalm 95:1-7; Daniel 6:10; John 4:21-24; Acts 4:23-31; Romans 12:1-2; 1 Thessalonians 5:16-18.

17. Spiritual Gifts and Ministry

The Spirit gives varied abilities for building up the church and serving the world. The New Testament lists overlap but are not identical, suggesting representative rather than exhaustive catalogs.

Continuationists and cessationists differ over whether all first-century manifestations continue in the same way, but both should affirm that gifts are accountable to Scripture, love, order, and edification.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - 1 Corinthians 12:7 (NASB 2020)

"To each one is given the manifestation of the Spirit for the common good."

Primary core reading: Romans 12:3-8 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

³ For I say, through the grace that was given me, to every man who is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think; but to think reasonably, as God has apportioned to each person a measure of faith. ⁴ For even as we have many members in one body, and all the members don't have the same function, ⁵ so we, who are many, are one body in Christ, and individually members one of another. ⁶ Having gifts differing according to the grace that was given to us, if prophecy, let us prophesy according to the proportion of our faith;

⁷ or service, let us give ourselves to service; or he who teaches, to his teaching; ⁸ or he who exhorts, to his exhorting; he who gives, let him do it with liberality; he who rules, with diligence; he who shows mercy, with cheerfulness.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 12:4-13 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴ Now there are various kinds of gifts, but the same Spirit. ⁵ There are various kinds of service, and the same Lord.

⁶ There are various kinds of workings, but the same God, who works all things in all. ⁷ But to each one is given the manifestation of the Spirit for the profit of all.

⁸ For to one is given through the Spirit the word of wisdom, and to another the word of knowledge, according to the same Spirit; ⁹ to another faith, by the same Spirit; and to another gifts of healings, by the same Spirit; ¹⁰ and to another workings of miracles; and to another prophecy; and to another discerning of spirits; to another different kinds of languages; and to another the interpretation of languages. ¹¹ But the one and the same Spirit works all of these, distributing to each one separately as he desires.

¹² For as the body is one, and has many members, and all the members of the body, being many, are one body; so also is Christ. ¹³ For in one Spirit we were all baptized into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, whether bond or free; and were all given to drink into one Spirit.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 13:1-13 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ If I speak with the languages of men and of angels, but don't have love, I have become sounding brass, or a clanging cymbal. ² If I have the gift of prophecy, and know all mysteries and all knowledge; and if I have all faith, so as to remove mountains, but don't have love, I am nothing. ³ If I dole out all my goods to feed the poor, and if I give my body to be burned, but don't have love, it profits me nothing. ⁴ Love is patient and is kind; love doesn't envy. Love doesn't brag, is not proud,

⁵ doesn't behave itself inappropriately, doesn't seek its own way, is not provoked, takes no account of evil; ⁶ doesn't rejoice in unrighteousness, but rejoices with the truth; ⁷ bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things. ⁸ Love never fails. But where there are prophecies, they will be done away with. Where there are various languages, they will cease. Where there is knowledge, it will be done away with.

⁹ For we know in part, and we prophesy in part; ¹⁰ but when that which is complete has come, then that which is partial will be done away with. ¹¹ When I was a child, I spoke as a child, I felt as a child, I thought as a child. Now that I have become a man, I have put away childish things. ¹² For now we see in a mirror, dimly, but then face to face. Now I know in part, but then I will know fully, even as I was also fully known.

¹³ But now faith, hope, and love remain—these three. The greatest of these is love.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Peter 4:8-11 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁸ And above all things be earnest in your love among yourselves, for love covers a multitude of sins. ⁹ Be hospitable to one another without grumbling. ¹⁰ As each has received a gift, employ it in serving one another, as good managers of the grace of God in its various forms. ¹¹ If anyone speaks, let it be as it were the very words of God. If anyone serves, let it be as of the strength which God supplies, that in all things God may be glorified through Jesus Christ, to whom belong the glory and the dominion forever and ever. Amen.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Every believer belongs to the body and has a place in service.
- No gift makes a person self-sufficient or superior.
- Love is the indispensable measure of giftedness.
- Public ministry must be tested, orderly, and directed toward edification.

Further references: Exodus 31:1-6; Acts 6:1-7; 1 Corinthians 14:1-12; 1 Corinthians 14:26-33; Ephesians 4:7-16; 1 Timothy 4:12-16; 2 Timothy 1:6-7; Hebrews 2:3-4.

18. Angels

Angels are created spiritual servants and messengers of God. Scripture portrays them worshiping, announcing, protecting, executing judgment, and ministering within God's purposes. It gives names to only a few and discourages speculative fascination or worship. Their presence magnifies God's rule rather than creating a second center of devotion.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Hebrews 1:14 (NASB 2020)

"Are they not all ministering spirits, sent out to provide service for the sake of those who will inherit salvation?"

Primary core reading: Psalm 103:19-22 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁹ Yahweh has established his throne in the heavens. His kingdom rules over all. ²⁰ Praise Yahweh, you angels of his, who are mighty in strength, who fulfill his word, obeying the voice of his word.

²¹ Praise Yahweh, all you armies of his, you servants of his, who do his pleasure. ²² Praise Yahweh, all you works of his, in all places of his dominion. Praise Yahweh, my soul!

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Daniel 10:10-14 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁰ Behold, a hand touched me, which set me on my knees and on the palms of my hands. ¹¹ He said to me, Daniel, you man greatly beloved, understand the words that I speak to you, and stand upright; for am I now sent to you. When he had spoken this word to me, I stood trembling. ¹² Then he said to me, Don't be afraid, Daniel; for from the first day that you set your heart to understand, and to humble yourself before your God, your words were heard: and I have come for your words' sake. ¹³ But the prince of the kingdom of Persia withstood me twenty-one days; but, behold, Michael, one of the chief princes, came to help me: and I remained there with the kings of Persia.

¹⁴ Now I have come to make you understand what shall happen to your people in the latter days; for the vision is yet for many days:

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Luke 1:26-38 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²⁶ Now in the sixth month, the angel Gabriel was sent from God to a city of Galilee, named Nazareth, ²⁷ to a virgin pledged to be married to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David. The virgin's name was Mary. ²⁸ Having come in, the angel said to her, "Rejoice, you highly favored one! The Lord is with you. Blessed are you among women!" ²⁹ But when she saw him, she was greatly troubled at the saying, and considered what kind of salutation this might be.

³⁰ The angel said to her, "Don't be afraid, Mary, for you have found favor with God. ³¹ Behold, you will conceive in your womb, and bring forth a son, and will call his name 'Jesus.' ³² He will be great, and will be called the Son of the Most High. The Lord God will give him the throne of his father, David, ³³ and he will reign over the house of Jacob forever. There will be no end to his Kingdom."

³⁴ Mary said to the angel, "How can this be, seeing I am a virgin?" ³⁵ The angel answered her, "The Holy Spirit will come on you, and the power of the Most High will overshadow you. Therefore also the holy one who is born from you will be called the Son of God. ³⁶ Behold, Elizabeth, your relative, also has conceived a son in her old age; and this is the sixth month with her who was called barren. ³⁷ For everything spoken by God is possible."

³⁸ Mary said, "Behold, the handmaid of the Lord; be it to me according to your word." The angel departed from her.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Hebrews 1:5-14 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁵ For to which of the angels did he say at any time, "You are my Son. Today have I become your father?" and again, "I will be to him a Father, and he will be to me a Son?" ⁶ Again, when he brings in the firstborn into the world he says, "Let all the angels of God worship him." ⁷ Of the angels he says, "Who makes his angels winds, and his servants a flame of fire." ⁸ But of the Son he says, "Your throne, O God, is forever and ever. The scepter of uprightness is the scepter of your Kingdom."

⁹ You have loved righteousness, and hated iniquity; therefore God, your God, has anointed you with the oil of gladness above your fellows." ¹⁰ And, "You, Lord, in the beginning, laid the foundation of the earth. The heavens are the works of your hands. ¹¹ They will perish, but you continue. They all will grow old like a garment does. ¹² As a mantle, you will roll them up, and they will be changed; but you are the same. Your years will not fail."

¹³ But which of the angels has he told at any time, "Sit at my right hand, until I make your enemies the footstool of your feet?" ¹⁴ Aren't they all serving spirits, sent out to do service for the sake of those who will inherit salvation?

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Revelation 22:8-9 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁸ Now I, John, am the one who heard and saw these things. When I heard and saw, I fell down to worship before the feet of the angel who had shown me these things. ⁹ He said to me, "See you don't do it! I am a fellow bondservant with you and with your brothers, the prophets, and with those who keep the words of this book. Worship God."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Angels are creatures, not lesser gods.
- Their authority is delegated and their message is judged by fidelity to God.
- Angelic ministry often accompanies turning points in redemption.
- Believers are warned not to worship angels or build doctrine from speculation.

Further references: Genesis 19:1-17; 2 Kings 6:15-17; Psalm 91:9-12; Matthew 18:10; Luke 2:8-14; Acts 12:5-11; Colossians 2:18-19; Jude 1:9.

19. Demons and Unclean Spirits

The Gospels portray demons as personal evil spirits that oppress, deceive, and resist God's kingdom. Jesus' authority over them is immediate and decisive, and exorcisms function as signs that the stronger king has arrived. Scripture neither denies spiritual evil nor attributes every illness or hardship to demonic activity.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Mark 1:27 (NASB 2020)

"He commands even the unclean spirits, and they obey Him."

Primary core reading: Mark 1:21-28 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²¹ They went into Capernaum, and immediately on the Sabbath day he entered into the synagogue and taught. ²² They were astonished at his teaching, for he taught them as having authority, and not as the scribes. ²³ Immediately there was in their synagogue a man with an unclean spirit, and he cried out, ²⁴ saying, "Ha! What do we have to do with you, Jesus, you Nazarene? Have you come to destroy us? I know you who you are: the Holy One of God!"

²⁵ Jesus rebuked him, saying, "Be quiet, and come out of him!" ²⁶ The unclean spirit, convulsing him and crying with a loud voice, came out of him. ²⁷ They were all amazed, so that they questioned among themselves, saying, "What is this? A new teaching? For with authority he commands even the unclean spirits, and they obey him!" ²⁸ The report of him went out immediately everywhere into all the region of Galilee and its surrounding area.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Mark 5:1-20 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ They came to the other side of the sea, into the country of the Gadarenes. ² When he had come out of the boat, immediately a man with an unclean spirit met him out of the tombs. ³ He lived in the tombs. Nobody could bind him any more, not even with chains, ⁴ because he had been often bound with fetters and chains, and the chains had been torn apart by him, and the fetters broken in pieces. Nobody had the strength to tame him.

⁵ Always, night and day, in the tombs and in the mountains, he was crying out, and cutting himself with stones. ⁶ When he saw Jesus from afar, he ran and bowed down to him, ⁷ and crying out with a loud voice, he said, "What have I to do with you, Jesus, you Son of the Most High God? I adjure you by God, don't torment me." ⁸ For he said to him, "Come out of the man, you unclean spirit!"

⁹ He asked him, "What is your name?" He said to him, "My name is Legion, for we are many." ¹⁰ He begged him much that he would not send them away out of the country. ¹¹ Now on the mountainside there was a great herd of pigs feeding. ¹² All the demons begged him, saying, "Send us into the pigs, that we may enter into them."

¹³ At once Jesus gave them permission. The unclean spirits came out and entered into the pigs. The herd of about two thousand rushed down the steep bank into the sea, and they were drowned in the sea. ¹⁴ Those who fed them fled, and told it in the city and in the country. The people came to see what it was that had happened. ¹⁵ They came to Jesus, and saw him who had been possessed by demons sitting, clothed, and in his right mind, even him who had the legion; and they were afraid. ¹⁶ Those who saw it declared to them how it happened to him who was possessed by demons, and about the pigs.

¹⁷ They began to beg him to depart from their region. ¹⁸ As he was entering into the boat, he who had been possessed by demons begged him that he might be with him. ¹⁹ He didn't allow him, but said to him, "Go to your house, to your friends, and tell them what great things the Lord has done for you, and how he had mercy on you."

²⁰ He went his way, and began to proclaim in Decapolis how Jesus had done great things for him, and everyone marveled.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Luke 11:14-23 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁴ He was casting out a demon, and it was mute. It happened, when the demon had gone out, the mute man spoke; and the multitudes marveled. ¹⁵ But some of them said, "He casts out demons by Beelzebul, the prince of the demons." ¹⁶ Others, testing him, sought from him a sign from heaven. ¹⁷ But he, knowing their thoughts, said to them, "Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation. A house divided against itself falls.

¹⁸ If Satan also is divided against himself, how will his kingdom stand? For you say that I cast out demons by Beelzebul. ¹⁹ But if I cast out demons by Beelzebul, by whom do your children cast them out? Therefore will they be your judges. ²⁰ But if I by the finger of God cast out demons, then the Kingdom of God has come to you. ²¹ "When the strong man, fully armed, guards his own dwelling, his goods are safe.

²² But when someone stronger attacks him and overcomes him, he takes from him his whole armor in which he trusted, and divides his spoils. ²³ "He that is not with me is against me. He who doesn't gather with me scatters.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Acts 16:16-18 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁶ It happened, as we were going to prayer, that a certain girl having a spirit of divination met us, who brought her masters much gain by fortune telling. ¹⁷ Following Paul and us, she cried out, "These men are servants of the Most High God, who proclaim to us a way of salvation!" ¹⁸ She was doing this for many days. But Paul, becoming greatly annoyed, turned and said to the spirit, "I command you in the name of Jesus Christ to come out of her!" It came out that very hour.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: James 2:19 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁹ You believe that God is one. You do well. The demons also believe, and shudder.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Jesus rules over hostile spirits.
- Demonic activity is associated with deception, idolatry, bondage, and destruction.
- Discernment must avoid both materialistic denial and fearful obsession.
- Christian resistance centers on Christ, truth, prayer, holiness, and the community of faith.

Further references: Deuteronomy 32:16-17; Psalm 106:34-39; Matthew 12:43-45; Luke 8:1-3; 1 Corinthians 10:19-22; 2 Corinthians 11:13-15; 1 Timothy 4:1; Revelation 16:13-14.

20. Satan: Accuser, Tempter, and Defeated Enemy

Satan appears as adversary, accuser, tempter, deceiver, and ruler of a rebellious order. Scripture treats him as real but not equal to God. The cross and resurrection announce his decisive defeat, while believers still face his schemes until final judgment.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - 1 Peter 5:8 (NASB 2020)

"Your adversary, the devil, prowls around like a roaring lion, seeking someone to devour."

Primary core reading: Genesis 3:1-15 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Now the serpent was more subtle than any animal of the field which Yahweh God had made. He said to the woman, "Has God really said, 'You shall not eat of any tree of the garden?'" ² The woman said to the serpent, "Of the fruit of the trees of the garden we may eat, ³ but of the fruit of the tree which is in the middle of the garden, God has said, 'You shall not eat of it, neither shall you touch it, lest you die.'" ⁴ The serpent said to the woman, "You won't surely die,

⁵ for God knows that in the day you eat it, your eyes will be opened, and you will be like God, knowing good and evil." ⁶ When the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was a delight to the eyes, and that the tree was to be desired to make one wise, she took of its fruit, and ate; and she gave some to her husband with her, and he ate. ⁷ The eyes of both of them were opened, and they knew that they were naked. They sewed fig leaves together, and made themselves aprons. ⁸ They heard the voice of Yahweh God walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and the man and his wife hid themselves from the presence of Yahweh God among the trees of the garden.

⁹ Yahweh God called to the man, and said to him, "Where are you?" ¹⁰ The man said, "I heard your voice in the garden, and I was afraid, because I was naked; and I hid myself." ¹¹ God said, "Who told you that you were naked? Have you eaten from the tree that I commanded you not to eat from?" ¹² The man said, "The woman whom you gave to be with me, she gave me of the tree, and I ate."

¹³ Yahweh God said to the woman, "What is this you have done?" The woman said, "The serpent deceived me, and I ate." ¹⁴ Yahweh God said to the serpent, "Because you have done this, you are cursed above all livestock, and above every animal of the field. On your belly you shall go, and you shall eat dust all the days of your life. ¹⁵ I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and her offspring. He will bruise your head, and you will bruise his heel."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Job 1:6-12 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁶ Now it happened on the day when God's sons came to present themselves before Yahweh, that Satan also came among them. ⁷ Yahweh said to Satan, "Where have you come from?" Then Satan answered Yahweh, and said, "From going back and forth in the earth, and from walking up and down in it."

⁸ Yahweh said to Satan, "Have you considered my servant, Job? For there is none like him in the earth, a blameless and an upright man, one who fears God, and turns away from evil." ⁹ Then Satan answered Yahweh, and said, "Does Job fear God for nothing?"

¹⁰ Haven't you made a hedge around him, and around his house, and around all that he has, on every side? You have blessed the work of his hands, and his substance is increased in the land. ¹¹ But put forth your hand now, and touch all that he has, and he will renounce you to your face."

¹² Yahweh said to Satan, "Behold, all that he has is in your power. Only on himself don't put forth your hand." So Satan went forth from the presence of Yahweh.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Matthew 4:1-11 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Then Jesus was led up by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil. ² When he had fasted forty days and forty nights, he was hungry afterward. ³ The tempter came and said to him, "If you are the Son of God, command that these stones become bread." ⁴ But he answered, "It is written, 'Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceeds out of the mouth of God.'"

⁵ Then the devil took him into the holy city. He set him on the pinnacle of the temple, ⁶ and said to him, "If you are the Son of God, throw yourself down, for it is written, 'He will put his angels in charge of you.' and, 'On their hands they will bear you up, so that you don't dash your foot against a stone.'" ⁷ Jesus said to him, "Again, it is written, 'You shall not test the Lord, your God.'" ⁸ Again, the devil took him to an exceedingly high mountain, and showed him all the kingdoms of the world, and their glory.

⁹ He said to him, "I will give you all of these things, if you will fall down and worship me." ¹⁰ Then Jesus said to him, "Get behind me, Satan! For it is written, 'You shall worship the Lord your God, and you shall serve him only.'" ¹¹ Then the devil left him, and behold, angels came and served him.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: John 12:27-33 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²⁷ "Now my soul is troubled. What shall I say? 'Father, save me from this time?' But for this cause I came to this time. ²⁸ Father, glorify your name!" Then there came a voice out of the sky, saying, "I have both glorified it, and will glorify it again." ²⁹ The multitude therefore, who stood by and heard it, said that it had thundered. Others said, "An angel has spoken to him." ³⁰ Jesus answered, "This voice hasn't come for my sake, but for your sakes.

³¹ Now is the judgment of this world. Now the prince of this world will be cast out. ³² And I, if I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all people to myself." ³³ But he said this, signifying by what kind of death he should die.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Revelation 12:7-12 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁷ There was war in the sky. Michael and his angels made war on the dragon. The dragon and his angels made war. ⁸ They didn't prevail, neither was a place found for him any more in heaven. ⁹ The great dragon was thrown down, the old serpent, he who is called the devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world. He was thrown down to the earth, and his angels were thrown down with him. ¹⁰ I heard a loud voice in heaven, saying, "Now the salvation, the power, and the Kingdom of our God, and the authority of his Christ has come; for the accuser of our brothers has been thrown down, who accuses them before our God day and night.

¹¹ They overcame him because of the Lamb's blood, and because of the word of their testimony. They didn't love their life, even to death. ¹² Therefore rejoice, heavens, and you who dwell in them. Woe to the earth and to the sea, because the devil has gone down to you, having great wrath, knowing that he has but a short time."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Satan's characteristic weapons are lies, accusation, temptation, and fear.
- His activity remains under God's sovereignty.
- Christ's victory is decisive though the conflict is not yet finally concluded.
- Believers overcome by Christ's blood, faithful testimony, truth, and steadfastness.

Further references: Zechariah 3:1-5; Luke 10:17-20; Luke 22:31-32; John 8:44; 2 Corinthians 4:3-4; 1 Thessalonians 3:5; 1 Peter 5:8-9; Revelation 20:7-10.

21. Spiritual Warfare

Spiritual warfare is the church's struggle against sin, deception, hostile powers, and systems shaped by rebellion. The New Testament emphasizes truth, righteousness, faith, the gospel, Scripture, prayer, endurance, and communal vigilance rather than magical formulas. Warfare language should not be used to demonize human opponents, for the struggle is not against flesh and blood.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Ephesians 6:11 (NASB 2020)

"Put on the full armor of God, so that you will be able to stand firm against the schemes of the devil."

Primary core reading: 2 Corinthians 10:3-6 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

³ For though we walk in the flesh, we don't wage war according to the flesh; ⁴ for the weapons of our warfare are not of the flesh, but mighty before God to the throwing down of strongholds, ⁵ throwing down imaginations and every high thing that is exalted against the knowledge of God, and bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ; ⁶ and being in readiness to avenge all disobedience, when your obedience will be made full.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Ephesians 6:10-20 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁰ Finally, be strong in the Lord, and in the strength of his might. ¹¹ Put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil. ¹² For our wrestling is not against flesh and blood, but against the principalities, against the powers, against the world's rulers of the darkness of this age, and against the spiritual forces of wickedness in the heavenly places. ¹³ Therefore, put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to withstand in the evil day, and, having done all, to stand.

¹⁴ Stand therefore, having the utility belt of truth buckled around your waist, and having put on the breastplate of righteousness, ¹⁵ and having fitted your feet with the preparation of the Good News of peace; ¹⁶ above all, taking up the shield of faith, with which you will be able to quench all the fiery darts of the evil one. ¹⁷ And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God;

¹⁸ with all prayer and requests, praying at all times in the Spirit, and being watchful to this end in all perseverance and requests for all the saints: ¹⁹ on my behalf, that utterance may be given to me in opening my mouth, to make known with boldness the mystery of the Good News, ²⁰ for which I am an ambassador in chains; that in it I may speak boldly, as I ought to speak.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: James 4:6-10 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁶ But he gives more grace. Therefore it says, "God resists the proud, but gives grace to the humble." ⁷ Be subject therefore to God. But resist the devil, and he will flee from you. ⁸ Draw near to God, and he will draw near to you. Cleanse your hands, you sinners; and purify your hearts, you double-minded. ⁹ Lament, mourn, and weep. Let your laughter be turned to mourning, and your joy to gloom.

¹⁰ Humble yourselves in the sight of the Lord, and he will exalt you.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Peter 5:6-10 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁶ Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God, that he may exalt you in due time; ⁷ casting all your worries on him, because he cares for you. ⁸ Be sober and self-controlled. Be watchful. Your adversary, the devil, walks around like a roaring lion, seeking whom he may devour. ⁹ Withstand him steadfast in your faith, knowing that your brothers who are in the world are undergoing the same sufferings.

¹⁰ But may the God of all grace, who called you to his eternal glory by Christ Jesus, after you have suffered a little while, perfect, establish, strengthen, and settle you.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- The battlefield includes belief, desire, conduct, community, and public witness.
- God's armor is largely ethical and gospel-shaped.
- Prayer and watchfulness are essential.
- Victory often looks like faithful endurance, forgiveness, truth-telling, and refusal to retaliate.

Further references: Matthew 26:36-41; Romans 12:17-21; Romans 13:11-14; 1 Corinthians 10:12-14; Colossians 2:13-15; 1 Thessalonians 5:4-11; 1 Timothy 6:11-12; Revelation 12:11.

22. The Angel of the LORD in the Old Testament

Several Old Testament narratives present the messenger of the LORD in unusually exalted terms: the figure speaks as God, bears the divine name or authority, and is sometimes identified by witnesses as God, yet is also distinguished from the LORD. Christian interpreters have often seen a pre-incarnate appearance of the Son; others describe a theophany or appeal to the ancient principle that an authorized messenger can speak fully for the sender. The texts support serious christological reflection, but the identification should be presented as interpretation rather than an explicit verse saying, 'this is Jesus.'

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Exodus 3:2 (NASB 2020)

"The angel of the LORD appeared to him in a blazing fire from the midst of a bush."

Primary core reading: Genesis 16:7-14 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁷ The angel of Yahweh found her by a fountain of water in the wilderness, by the fountain in the way to Shur. ⁸ He said, "Hagar, Sarai's handmaid, where did you come from? Where are you going?" She said, "I am fleeing from the face of my mistress Sarai." ⁹ The angel of Yahweh said to her, "Return to your mistress, and submit yourself under her hands." ¹⁰ The angel of Yahweh said to her, "I will greatly multiply your seed, that they will not be numbered for multitude."

¹¹ The angel of Yahweh said to her, "Behold, you are with child, and will bear a son. You shall call his name Ishmael, because Yahweh has heard your affliction. ¹² He will be like a wild donkey among men. His hand will be against every man, and every man's hand against him. He will live opposite all of his brothers." ¹³ She called the name of Yahweh who spoke to her, "You are a God who sees," for she said, "Have I even stayed alive after seeing him?" ¹⁴ Therefore the well was called Beer Lahai Roi. Behold, it is between Kadesh and Bered.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Genesis 22:9-18 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁹ They came to the place which God had told him of. Abraham built the altar there, and laid the wood in order, bound Isaac his son, and laid him on the altar, on the wood. ¹⁰ Abraham stretched out his hand, and took the knife to kill his son. ¹¹ The angel of Yahweh called to him out of the sky, and said, "Abraham, Abraham!" He said, "Here I am." ¹² He said, "Don't lay your hand on the boy, neither do anything to him. For now I know that you fear God, since you have not withheld your son, your only son, from me."

¹³ Abraham lifted up his eyes, and looked, and saw that behind him was a ram caught in the thicket by his horns. Abraham went and took the ram, and offered him up for a burnt offering instead of his son. ¹⁴ Abraham called the name of that place Yahweh Will Provide. As it is said to this day, "On Yahweh's mountain, it will be provided." ¹⁵ The angel of Yahweh called to Abraham a second time out of the sky, ¹⁶ and said, "I have sworn by myself, says Yahweh, because you have done this thing, and have not withheld your son, your only son,

¹⁷ that I will bless you greatly, and I will multiply your seed greatly like the stars of the heavens, and like the sand which is on the seashore. Your seed will possess the gate of his enemies. ¹⁸ In your seed will all the nations of the earth be blessed, because you have obeyed my voice."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Exodus 3:1-6 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Now Moses was keeping the flock of Jethro, his father-in-law, the priest of Midian, and he led the flock to the back of the wilderness, and came to God's mountain, to Horeb. ² The angel of Yahweh appeared to him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush. He looked, and behold, the bush burned with fire, and the bush was not consumed. ³ Moses said, "I will turn aside now, and see this great sight, why the bush is not burnt." ⁴ When Yahweh saw that he turned aside to see, God called to him out of the midst of the bush, and said, "Moses! Moses!" He said, "Here I am." ⁵ He said, "Don't come close. Take your sandals off of your feet, for the place you are standing on is holy ground." ⁶ Moreover he said, "I am the God of your father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob." Moses hid his face; for he was afraid to look at God.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Judges 6:11-24 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹¹ The angel of Yahweh came, and sat under the oak which was in Ophrah, that pertained to Joash the Abiezrite: and his son Gideon was beating out wheat in the winepress, to hide it from the Midianites. ¹² The angel of Yahweh appeared to him, and said to him, "Yahweh is with you, you mighty man of valor!" ¹³ Gideon said to him, "Oh, my lord, if Yahweh is with us, why then has all this happened to us? Where are all his wondrous works which our fathers told us of, saying, 'Didn't Yahweh bring us up from Egypt?' But now Yahweh has cast us off, and delivered us into the hand of Midian." ¹⁴ Yahweh looked at him, and said, "Go in this your might, and save Israel from the hand of Midian. Haven't I sent you?"

¹⁵ He said to him, "O Lord, how shall I save Israel? Behold, my family is the poorest in Manasseh, and I am the least in my father's house." ¹⁶ Yahweh said to him, "Surely I will be with you, and you shall strike the Midianites as one man." ¹⁷ He said to him, "If now I have found favor in your sight, then show me a sign that it is you who talk with me." ¹⁸ Please don't go away, until I come to you, and bring out my present, and lay it before you." He said, "I will wait until you come back."

¹⁹ Gideon went in, and prepared a young goat, and unleavened cakes of an ephah of meal. He put the meat in a basket and he put the broth in a pot, and brought it out to him under the oak, and presented it. ²⁰ The angel of God said to him, "Take the meat and the unleavened cakes, and lay them on this rock, and pour out the broth." He did so. ²¹ Then the angel of Yahweh stretched out the end of the staff that was in his hand, and touched the meat and the unleavened cakes; and fire went up out of the rock, and consumed the meat and the unleavened cakes; and the angel of Yahweh departed out of his sight. ²² Gideon saw that he was the angel of Yahweh; and Gideon said, "Alas, Lord Yahweh! Because I have seen the angel of Yahweh face to face!"

²³ Yahweh said to him, "Peace be to you! Don't be afraid. You shall not die." ²⁴ Then Gideon built an altar there to Yahweh, and called it "Yahweh is Peace." To this day it is still in Ophrah of the Abiezrites.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Judges 13:15-22 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁵ Manoah said to the angel of Yahweh, "Please, let us detain you, that we may make a young goat ready for you." ¹⁶ The angel of Yahweh said to Manoah, "Though you detain me, I won't eat of your bread; and if you will prepare a burnt offering, you must offer it to Yahweh." For Manoah didn't know that he was the angel of Yahweh. ¹⁷ Manoah said to the angel of Yahweh, "What is your name, that when your words happen, we may honor you?" ¹⁸ The angel of Yahweh said to him, "Why do you ask about my name, since it is wonderful?"

¹⁹ So Manoah took the young goat with the meal offering, and offered it on the rock to Yahweh. Then the angel did a wonderful thing as Manoah and his wife looked on. ²⁰ For it happened, when the flame went up toward the sky from off the altar, that the angel of Yahweh ascended in the flame of the altar: and Manoah and his wife looked on; and they fell on their faces to the ground. ²¹ But the angel of Yahweh didn't appear to Manoah or to his wife any more. Then Manoah knew that he was the angel of Yahweh. ²² Manoah said to his wife, "We shall surely die, because we have seen God."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- The Hebrew word malak means messenger and can describe human or heavenly agents.
- In key scenes the messenger's speech shifts into first-person divine speech.
- The figure can be both identified with and distinguished from God in the narrative.
- Major readings are pre-incarnate Christ, visible manifestation of God, and fully authorized heavenly representative.

Further references: Genesis 31:10-13; Exodus 14:19-24; Numbers 22:22-35; Judges 2:1-5; 1 Chronicles 21:14-18; Zechariah 1:8-13; Zechariah 3:1-7; Malachi 3:1.

***Interpretive citation.** The commissioned-messenger reading is discussed in modern scholarship on the Angel of the LORD, while christological readings remain prominent in Christian biblical theology [A1-A2].*

23. Messianic Prophecies and Patterns Fulfilled in Christ

The New Testament reads Israel's Scriptures in several ways: direct prediction, promise and fulfillment, typology, corporate recapitulation, and patterns that reach their climax in Christ. Some texts are widely recognized as explicit messianic predictions; others become christological through the inspired interpretive practice of the New Testament. Careful study asks both what the Old Testament text meant in its first setting and how the New Testament applies it.

Selected prophecy-and-fulfillment map

Theme	Old Testament	New Testament	Interpretive note
Offspring who defeats the serpent	Genesis 3:15	Romans 16:20; Hebrews 2:14	Foundational promise/pattern; the immediate wording is compressed and later read canonically.
Blessing to all nations through Abraham	Genesis 12:1-3	Galatians 3:8-16	Promise fulfilled through the messianic seed and multinational people of faith.
A prophet like Moses	Deuteronomy 18:15-19	Acts 3:20-23	Explicit apostolic application to Jesus.
Davidic Son and eternal throne	2 Samuel 7:12-16	Luke 1:30-33; Acts 13:22-23	The promise begins with David's dynasty and reaches its climax in Christ.
Ruler from Bethlehem	Micah 5:2-5	Matthew 2:1-6	Direct geographic application in Matthew.
The king comes humble on a donkey	Zechariah 9:9	Matthew 21:1-9; John 12:14-16	Explicitly enacted and cited in the triumphal entry.
Suffering servant bears sins	Isaiah 52:13-53:12	Acts 8:26-35; 1 Peter 2:21-25	Central New Testament pattern for Jesus' suffering and atoning death.
Pierced one and mourning	Zechariah 12:10	John 19:34-37; Revelation 1:7	John applies the pierced-one text to the crucifixion.

Theme	Old Testament	New Testament	Interpretive note
Righteous sufferer mocked and garments divided	Psalms 22:1-18	Matthew 27:35-46; John 19:23-24	Psalms originally voices righteous suffering and is applied typologically to Jesus.
Holy One not abandoned to decay	Psalms 16:8-11	Acts 2:25-32; Acts 13:35-37	Apostolic resurrection interpretation.
Priest forever after Melchizedek	Psalms 110:1-4	Hebrews 5:5-10; Hebrews 7:1-28	Foundation for Hebrews' account of Christ's priesthood.
New covenant and forgiven sin	Jeremiah 31:31-34	Luke 22:20; Hebrews 8:6-13	Jesus identifies his blood with the new covenant; Hebrews develops the connection.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Isaiah 53:5 (NASB 2020)

"He was pierced for our offenses, He was crushed for our wrongdoings."

Primary core reading: Genesis 3:14-15 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁴ Yahweh God said to the serpent, "Because you have done this, you are cursed above all livestock, and above every animal of the field. On your belly you shall go, and you shall eat dust all the days of your life. ¹⁵ I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and her offspring. He will bruise your head, and you will bruise his heel."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Deuteronomy 18:15-19 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁵ Yahweh your God will raise up to you a prophet from the midst of you, of your brothers, like me. You shall listen to him. ¹⁶ This is according to all that you desired of Yahweh your God in Horeb in the day of the assembly, saying, "Let me not hear again the voice of Yahweh my God, neither let me see this great fire any more, that I not die." ¹⁷ Yahweh said to me, "They have well said that which they have spoken. ¹⁸ I will raise them up a prophet from among their brothers, like you; and I will put my words in his mouth, and he shall speak to them all that I shall command him.

¹⁹ It shall happen, that whoever will not listen to my words which he shall speak in my name, I will require it of him.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Isaiah 9:6-7 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁶ For to us a child is born. To us a son is given; and the government will be on his shoulders. His name will be called Wonderful, Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace. ⁷ Of the increase of his government and of peace there shall be no end, on the throne of David, and on his kingdom, to establish it, and to uphold it with justice and with righteousness from that time on, even forever. The zeal of Yahweh of Armies will perform this.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Isaiah 52:13-15 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹³ Behold, my servant shall deal wisely, he shall be exalted and lifted up, and shall be very high. ¹⁴ Like as many were astonished at you (his appearance was marred more than any man, and his form more than the sons of men), ¹⁵ so shall he sprinkle many nations; kings shall shut their mouths at him: for that which had not been told them shall they see; and that which they had not heard shall they understand.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Isaiah 53:1-12 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Who has believed our message? To whom has the arm of Yahweh been revealed? ² For he grew up before him as a tender plant, and as a root out of dry ground. He has no good looks or majesty. When we see him, there is no beauty that we should desire him.

³ He was despised, and rejected by men; a man of suffering, and acquainted with disease. He was despised as one from whom men hide their face; and we didn't respect him. ⁴ Surely he has borne our sickness, and carried our suffering; yet we considered him plagued, struck by God, and afflicted.

⁵ But he was pierced for our transgressions. He was crushed for our iniquities. The punishment that brought our peace was on him; and by his wounds we are healed. ⁶ All we like sheep have gone astray. Everyone has turned to his own way; and Yahweh has laid on him the iniquity of us all.

⁷ He was oppressed, yet when he was afflicted he didn't open his mouth. As a lamb that is led to the slaughter, and as a sheep that before its shearers is mute, so he didn't open his mouth. ⁸ He was taken away by oppression and judgment; and as for his generation, who considered that he was cut off out of the land of the living and stricken for the disobedience of my people?

⁹ They made his grave with the wicked, and with a rich man in his death; although he had done no violence, neither was any deceit in his mouth. ¹⁰ Yet it pleased Yahweh to bruise him. He has caused him to suffer. When you make his soul an offering for sin, he shall see his seed. He shall prolong his days, and the pleasure of Yahweh shall prosper in his hand.

¹¹ After the suffering of his soul, he will see the light and be satisfied. My righteous servant will justify many by the knowledge of himself; and he will bear their iniquities. ¹² Therefore will I divide him a portion with the great, and he shall divide the spoil with the strong; because he poured out his soul to death, and was numbered with the transgressors; yet he bore the sin of many, and made intercession for the transgressors.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Micah 5:2-5 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

² But you, Bethlehem Ephrathah, being small among the clans of Judah, out of you one will come forth to me that is to be ruler in Israel; whose goings forth are from of old, from everlasting. ³ Therefore he will abandon them until the time that she who is in labor gives birth. Then the rest of his brothers will return to the children of Israel. ⁴ He shall stand, and shall shepherd in the strength of Yahweh, in the majesty of the name of Yahweh his God: and they will live, for then he will be great to the ends of the earth. ⁵ He will be our peace when Assyria invades our land, and when he marches through our fortresses, then we will raise against him seven shepherds, and eight leaders of men.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Zechariah 9:9-10 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁹ Rejoice greatly, daughter of Zion! Shout, daughter of Jerusalem! Behold, your King comes to you! He is righteous, and having salvation; lowly, and riding on a donkey, even on a colt, the foal of a donkey. ¹⁰ I will cut off the chariot from Ephraim, and the horse from Jerusalem; and the battle bow will be cut off; and he will speak peace to the nations: and his dominion will be from sea to sea, and from the River to the ends of the earth.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- The promised offspring, prophet, king, servant, shepherd, and priest converge in Christ.
- Fulfillment may be direct, typological, or climactic rather than a simple one-to-one prediction.
- Jesus and the apostles repeatedly interpret the Scriptures as a unified witness to his suffering and glory.
- Responsible apologetics should acknowledge genuine interpretive questions rather than exaggerating precision.

Further references: Psalm 2:1-12; Psalm 16:8-11; Psalm 22:1-18; Psalm 110:1-4; Isaiah 7:14; Isaiah 11:1-10; Jeremiah 23:5-6; Zechariah 12:10; Matthew 1:18-23; Luke 24:25-27; Acts 2:22-36; 1 Peter 1:10-12.

24. Daniel 9 and the Seventy Weeks

Daniel 9:24-27 is one of Scripture's most debated chronological prophecies. The passage follows Daniel's prayer about Jeremiah's seventy years and announces seventy 'sevens' concerning the people and holy city. Many Christian interpreters understand the units as years and read the anointed one as Christ. A well-known evangelical calculation begins with Artaxerxes' commission associated with Nehemiah in 444 BC, treats 69 sevens as 483 schematic 360-day years, and lands near AD 33. This is a serious historical proposal, not an uncontested mathematical proof: the decree date, calendar, exact terminal event, crucifixion year, punctuation, and relation of the final week are disputed.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Daniel 9:24 (NASB 2020)

"Seventy weeks have been decreed for your people and your holy city."

Primary core reading: Daniel 9:1-3 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ In the first year of Darius the son of Ahasuerus, of the seed of the Medes, who was made king over the realm of the Chaldeans, ² in the first year of his reign I, Daniel, understood by the books the number of the years about which the word of Yahweh came to Jeremiah the prophet, for the accomplishing of the desolations of Jerusalem, even seventy years. ³ I set my face to the Lord God, to seek by prayer and petitions, with fasting and sackcloth and ashes.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Daniel 9:20-27 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²⁰ While I was speaking, and praying, and confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel, and presenting my supplication before Yahweh my God for the holy mountain of my God; ²¹ yes, while I was speaking in prayer, the man Gabriel, whom I had seen in the vision at the beginning, being caused to fly swiftly, touched me about the time of the evening offering. ²² He instructed me, and talked with me, and said, Daniel, I am now come forth to give you wisdom and understanding. ²³ At the beginning of your petitions the commandment went forth, and I have come to tell you; for you are greatly beloved: therefore consider the matter, and understand the vision.

²⁴ Seventy weeks are decreed on your people and on your holy city, to finish disobedience, and to make an end of sins, and to make reconciliation for iniquity, and to bring in everlasting righteousness, and to seal up vision and prophecy, and to anoint the most holy. ²⁵ Know therefore and discern, that from the going forth of the commandment to restore and to build Jerusalem to the Anointed One, the prince, shall be seven weeks, and sixty-two weeks: it shall be built again, with street and moat, even in troubled times. ²⁶ After the sixty-two weeks the Anointed One shall be cut off, and shall have nothing: and the people of the prince who shall come shall destroy the city and the sanctuary; and its end shall be with a flood, and even to the end shall be war; desolations are determined. ²⁷ He shall make a firm covenant with many for one week: and in the midst of the week he shall cause the sacrifice and the offering to cease; and on the wing of abominations shall come one who makes desolate; and even to the full end, and that determined, shall wrath be poured out on the desolate.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Nehemiah 2:1-8 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ It happened in the month Nisan, in the twentieth year of Artaxerxes the king, when wine was before him, that I took up the wine, and gave it to the king. Now I had not been sad before in his presence. ² The king said to me, "Why is your face sad, since you are not sick? This is nothing else but sorrow of heart." Then I was very much afraid. ³ I said to the king, "Let the king live forever! Why shouldn't my face be sad, when the city, the place of my fathers' tombs, lies waste, and its gates have been consumed with fire?" ⁴ Then the king said to me, "For what do you make request?" So I prayed to the God of heaven.

⁵ I said to the king, "If it pleases the king, and if your servant has found favor in your sight, that you would send me to Judah, to the city of my fathers' tombs, that I may build it." ⁶ The king said to me (the queen was also sitting by him), "For how long shall your journey be? And when will you return?" So it pleased the king to send me; and I set him a time. ⁷ Moreover I said to the king, "If it pleases the king, let letters be given me to the governors beyond the River, that they may let me pass through until I come to Judah; ⁸ and a letter to Asaph the keeper of the king's forest, that he may give me timber to make beams for the gates of the citadel by the temple, for the wall of the city, and for the house that I shall enter into." The king granted my requests, because of the good hand of my God on me.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Luke 19:28-44 (WEB)

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²⁸ Having said these things, he went on ahead, going up to Jerusalem. ²⁹ It happened, when he drew near to Bethsphage and Bethany, at the mountain that is called Olivet, he sent two of his disciples, ³⁰ saying, "Go your way into the village on the other side, in which, as you enter, you will find a colt tied, whereon no man ever yet sat. Untie it, and bring it. ³¹ If anyone asks you, 'Why are you untying it?' say to him: 'The Lord needs it.'"

³² Those who were sent went away, and found things just as he had told them. ³³ As they were untying the colt, its owners said to them, "Why are you untying the colt?" ³⁴ They said, "The Lord needs it." ³⁵ They brought it to Jesus. They threw their cloaks on the colt, and set Jesus on them.

³⁶ As he went, they spread their cloaks in the way. ³⁷ As he was now getting near, at the descent of the Mount of Olives, the whole multitude of the disciples began to rejoice and praise God with a loud voice for all the mighty works which they had seen, ³⁸ saying, "Blessed is the King who comes in the name of the Lord! Peace in heaven, and glory in the highest!" ³⁹ Some of the Pharisees from the multitude said to him, "Teacher, rebuke your disciples!"

⁴⁰ He answered them, "I tell you that if these were silent, the stones would cry out." ⁴¹ When he drew near, he saw the city and wept over it, ⁴² saying, "If you, even you, had known today the things which belong to your peace! But now, they are hidden from your eyes. ⁴³ For the days will come on you, when your enemies will throw up a barricade against you, surround you, hem you in on every side,

⁴⁴ and will dash you and your children within you to the ground. They will not leave in you one stone on another, because you didn't know the time of your visitation."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Messianic-chronological reading: 69 sevens lead to the appearance or cutting off of Messiah; some calculations terminate near the triumphal entry or crucifixion in AD 33.
- Messianic-historical reading: the weeks culminate in Christ and the first-century destruction of Jerusalem, often without a future gap.
- Dispensational-futurist reading: the 69th week ends at Christ, while the 70th is separated and fulfilled in a future tribulation.
- Maccabean/historical-critical reading: key figures and desecration are associated primarily with Antiochus IV and the second-century BC crisis.

- Jewish interpretations have also connected the passage with Second Temple events, the destruction in AD 70, and varied messianic expectations.

The AD 33 Calculation: What It Assumes

Step	Claim or assumption
1	The “sevens” are interpreted as units of seven years, so 69 sevens equal 483 years.
2	The starting point is associated with Artaxerxes’ authorization to Nehemiah to rebuild Jerusalem, commonly dated by this model to Nisan in 444 BC.
3	The 483 years are converted into 173,880 days by using a schematic 360-day “prophetic year.”
4	Counting those days is said to terminate near the public presentation of Jesus in Jerusalem in AD 33; versions of the calculation identify March 29 or March 30 for the triumphal entry, with crucifixion shortly afterward.
5	Daniel 9:26, “Messiah shall be cut off,” is then connected with the crucifixion.

Why the result is debated

- The Persian decrees in Ezra-Nehemiah can be identified and dated in more than one way.
- The text does not explicitly state that each “seven” is a seven-year unit or that a 360-day year should be used.
- Chronologies of Jesus’ final week commonly favor AD 30 or AD 33, and the exact date of the triumphal entry is reconstructed rather than stated in the Gospels.
- Hebrew punctuation and the identity of the “anointed one,” “prince,” and covenant-maker are interpreted differently.
- Some readings place the primary horizon in the Antiochene crisis, some in the first century, and some divide fulfillment between Christ’s first coming and a future final week.

Balanced conclusion. *Daniel 9 can reasonably be presented as a major messianic text within Christian interpretation, and the AD 33 calculation is historically influential and striking. It should not be described as an indisputable prediction of the exact calendar date. The strongest claim is that a coherent set of assumptions places the culmination of the sixty-nine sevens in the period of Jesus’ public presentation and death.*

Selected interpretive history

- Early Jewish writings show that Daniel’s seventy weeks contributed to messianic expectation in some Second Temple circles [D3-D4].

- Most early Christian writers surveyed by J. Paul Tanner adopted some form of messianic interpretation, while disagreeing substantially about the details [D2].
- Harold W. Hoehner defended the influential 444 BC-to-AD 33 chronology [D1].
- Modern historical-critical interpreters commonly connect the passage's first horizon with Antiochus IV and the temple crisis, though many scholars also study its later typological and messianic reception [D2-D4].

Further references: Jeremiah 25:8-12; Jeremiah 29:10-14; Daniel 7:13-14; Daniel 8:9-14; Daniel 11:21-35; Matthew 24:15-22; Mark 13:14-20; Luke 21:20-24.

25. Types of Christ in the Old Testament

A type is a real person, institution, event, or pattern in the Old Testament that anticipates and is fulfilled more fully in Christ. Typology differs from arbitrary symbolism because it rests on recurring biblical patterns and, ideally, explicit New Testament connections. Major examples include Adam, Passover, exodus, manna, rock, Moses, Joshua, David, Solomon, priesthood, sacrifice, temple, Jonah, and the suffering righteous person.

Major types and their New Testament development

Type	Old Testament pattern	New Testament use	Christological significance
Adam	Genesis 1-3	Romans 5:12-21; 1 Corinthians 15:45-49	Representative head: disobedience and death are answered by Christ's obedience and life.
Isaac offered and received back	Genesis 22:1-14	Hebrews 11:17-19	Beloved son, sacrifice, substitutionary ram, and figurative reception from death.
Passover lamb	Exodus 12:1-14	John 1:29; 1 Corinthians 5:7	Deliverance from judgment through sacrificial blood.
Exodus and wilderness	Exodus 14-17	Matthew 2:15; 4:1-11; 1 Corinthians 10:1-6	Jesus recapitulates Israel and remains faithful in testing.
Manna	Exodus 16	John 6:30-35	Christ is the true bread from heaven who gives life.
Rock and water	Exodus 17:1-7	1 Corinthians 10:4	Paul explicitly associates the sustaining rock with Christ.
Bronze serpent	Numbers 21:4-9	John 3:14-16	The lifted sign of healing anticipates the lifted-up Son.
Moses	Deuteronomy 18:15-19	Acts 3:20-23; Hebrews 3:1-6	Prophet and mediator surpassed by the Son.

Type	Old Testament pattern	New Testament use	Christological significance
Joshua and rest	Joshua 1; 21	Hebrews 4:1-11	Joshua's land-rest points beyond itself to God's fuller rest.
Davidic king	2 Samuel 7; Psalms 2 and 110	Luke 1:32-33; Acts 2:29-36	The ideal anointed king reaches fulfillment in Jesus.
Priesthood and sacrifices	Leviticus 1-16	Hebrews 7-10	Repeated ministry anticipates Christ's once-for-all priestly sacrifice.
Temple	1 Kings 8	John 2:19-22; Ephesians 2:19-22	God's dwelling is concentrated in Christ and extended to his people by the Spirit.
Jonah	Jonah 1:17	Matthew 12:38-41	Jesus explicitly uses Jonah's descent and return as a sign of his death and resurrection.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - 1 Corinthians 5:7 (NASB 2020)*"Christ our Passover also has been sacrificed."***Primary core reading: Romans 5:12-19 (WEB)****WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN**

¹² Therefore, as sin entered into the world through one man, and death through sin; and so death passed to all men, because all sinned. ¹³ For until the law, sin was in the world; but sin is not charged when there is no law. ¹⁴ Nevertheless death reigned from Adam until Moses, even over those whose sins weren't like Adam's disobedience, who is a foreshadowing of him who was to come. ¹⁵ But the free gift isn't like the trespass. For if by the trespass of the one the many died, much more did the grace of God, and the gift by the grace of the one man, Jesus Christ, abound to the many.

¹⁶ The gift is not as through one who sinned: for the judgment came by one to condemnation, but the free gift came of many trespasses to justification. ¹⁷ For if by the trespass of the one, death reigned through the one; so much more will those who receive the abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness reign in life through the one, Jesus Christ. ¹⁸ So then as through one trespass, all men were condemned; even so through one act of righteousness, all men were justified to life. ¹⁹ For as through the one man's disobedience many were made sinners, even so through the obedience of the one, many will be made righteous.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 5:6-8 (WEB)

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⁶ Your boasting is not good. Don't you know that a little yeast leavens the whole lump? ⁷ Purge out the old yeast, that you may be a new lump, even as you are unleavened. For indeed Christ, our Passover, has been sacrificed in our place. ⁸ Therefore let us keep the feast, not with old yeast, neither with the yeast of malice and wickedness, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 10:1-6 (WEB)

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¹ Now I would not have you ignorant, brothers, that our fathers were all under the cloud, and all passed through the sea; ² and were all baptized into Moses in the cloud and in the sea; ³ and all ate the same spiritual food; ⁴ and all drank the same spiritual drink. For they drank of a spiritual rock that followed them, and the rock was Christ.

⁵ However with most of them, God was not well pleased, for they were overthrown in the wilderness. ⁶ Now these things were our examples, to the intent we should not lust after evil things, as they also lusted.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Hebrews 7:23-28 (WEB)

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²³ Many, indeed, have been made priests, because they are hindered from continuing by death. ²⁴ But he, because he lives forever, has his priesthood unchangeable. ²⁵ Therefore he is also able to save to the uttermost those who draw near to God through him, seeing that he lives forever to make intercession for them. ²⁶ For such a high priest was fitting for us: holy, guiltless, undefiled, separated from sinners, and made higher than the heavens;

²⁷ who doesn't need, like those high priests, to offer up sacrifices daily, first for his own sins, and then for the sins of the people. For he did this once for all, when he offered up himself. ²⁸ For the law appoints men as high priests who have weakness, but the word of the oath which came after the law appoints a Son forever who has been perfected.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Hebrews 9:11-15 (WEB)

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¹¹ But Christ having come as a high priest of the coming good things, through the greater and more perfect tabernacle, not made with hands, that is to say, not of this creation, ¹² nor yet through the blood of goats and calves, but through his own blood, entered in once for all into the Holy Place, having obtained eternal redemption. ¹³ For if the blood of goats and bulls, and the ashes of a heifer sprinkling those who have been defiled, sanctify to the cleanness of the flesh: ¹⁴ how much more will the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself without blemish to God, cleanse your conscience from dead works to serve the living God?

¹⁵ For this reason he is the mediator of a new covenant, since a death has occurred for the redemption of the transgressions that were under the first covenant, that those who have been called may receive the promise of the eternal inheritance.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: John 2:18-22 (WEB)

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¹⁸ The Jews therefore answered him, "What sign do you show us, seeing that you do these things?" ¹⁹ Jesus answered them, "Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up." ²⁰ The Jews therefore said, "It took forty-six years to build this temple! Will you raise it up in three days?" ²¹ But he spoke of the temple of his body.

²² When therefore he was raised from the dead, his disciples remembered that he said this, and they believed the Scripture, and the word which Jesus had said.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Adam: Christ is the representative head of a renewed humanity.
- Passover and sacrifice: Christ's death brings deliverance and covenant cleansing.
- Exodus and wilderness: Jesus leads a new exodus and remains faithful where Israel failed.
- Priest, temple, and king: offices and institutions converge in Christ.
- Jonah and Isaac: events of death-like descent and restored life become patterns used in christological interpretation.

Further references: Genesis 22:1-14; Exodus 12:1-14; Exodus 16:13-18; Numbers 21:4-9; 2 Samuel 7:12-16; Jonah 1:17; Matthew 12:38-41; John 3:14-16; John 6:30-35; Hebrews 3:1-6.

26. Eschatology: The Last Things

Biblical eschatology concerns the kingdom's consummation: Christ's return, resurrection, judgment, defeat of evil, salvation of God's people, and renewal of creation. Major Christian systems differ over the millennium, the timing of tribulation and rapture, the role of Israel, and how Revelation's symbols relate to history. All orthodox positions should preserve the same center: Jesus will return personally and victoriously, the dead will be raised, God will judge, and creation will be made new.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - 1 Thessalonians 4:16 (NASB 2020)

"The Lord Himself will descend from heaven with a shout."

Primary core reading: Matthew 24:29-44 (WEB)

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²⁹ But immediately after the oppression of those days, the sun will be darkened, the moon will not give its light, the stars will fall from the sky, and the powers of the heavens will be shaken; ³⁰ and then the sign of the Son of Man will appear in the sky. Then all the tribes of the earth will mourn, and they will see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of the sky with power and great glory. ³¹ He will send out his angels with a great sound of a trumpet, and they will gather together his chosen ones from the four winds, from one end of the sky to the other. ³² "Now from the fig tree learn this parable. When its branch has now become tender, and puts forth its leaves, you know that the summer is near.

³³ Even so you also, when you see all these things, know that it is near, even at the doors. ³⁴ Most certainly I tell you, this generation will not pass away, until all these things are accomplished. ³⁵ Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away. ³⁶ But no one knows of that day and hour, not even the angels of heaven, but my Father only.

³⁷ "As the days of Noah were, so will be the coming of the Son of Man. ³⁸ For as in those days which were before the flood they were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day that Noah entered into the ship, ³⁹ and they didn't know until the flood came, and took them all away, so will be the coming of the Son of Man.

⁴⁰ Then two men will be in the field: one will be taken and one will be left;

⁴¹ two women grinding at the mill, one will be taken and one will be left. ⁴² Watch therefore, for you don't know in what hour your Lord comes. ⁴³ But know this, that if the master of the house had known in what watch of the night the thief was coming, he would have watched, and would not have allowed his house to be broken into. ⁴⁴ Therefore also be ready, for in an hour that you don't expect, the Son of Man will come.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: 1 Thessalonians 4:13-18 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹³ But we don't want you to be ignorant, brothers, concerning those who have fallen asleep, so that you don't grieve like the rest, who have no hope. ¹⁴ For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so God will bring with him those who have fallen asleep in Jesus. ¹⁵ For this we tell you by the word of the Lord, that we who are alive, who are left to the coming of the Lord, will in no way precede those who have fallen asleep. ¹⁶ For the Lord himself will descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with God's trumpet. The dead in Christ will rise first,

¹⁷ then we who are alive, who are left, will be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air. So we will be with the Lord forever. ¹⁸ Therefore comfort one another with these words.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 2 Peter 3:8-14 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁸ But don't forget this one thing, beloved, that one day is with the Lord as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day. ⁹ The Lord is not slow concerning his promise, as some count slowness; but is patient with us, not wishing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance. ¹⁰ But the day of the Lord will come as a thief in the night; in which the heavens will pass away with a great noise, and the elements will be dissolved with fervent heat, and the earth and the works that are in it will be burned up. ¹¹ Therefore since all these things will be destroyed like this, what kind of people ought you to be in holy living and godliness,

¹² looking for and earnestly desiring the coming of the day of God, which will cause the burning heavens to be dissolved, and the elements will melt with fervent heat? ¹³ But, according to his promise, we look for new heavens and a new earth, in which righteousness dwells. ¹⁴ Therefore, beloved, seeing that you look for these things, be diligent to be found in peace, without blemish and blameless in his sight.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Revelation 20:1-15 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ I saw an angel coming down out of heaven, having the key of the abyss and a great chain in his hand. ² He seized the dragon, the old serpent, which is the devil and Satan, who deceives the whole inhabited earth, and bound him for a thousand years, ³ and cast him into the abyss, and shut it, and sealed it over him, that he should deceive the nations no more, until the thousand years were finished. After this, he must be freed for a short time. ⁴ I saw thrones, and they sat on them, and judgment was given to them. I saw the souls of those who had been beheaded for the testimony of Jesus, and for the word of God, and such as didn't worship the beast nor his image, and didn't receive the mark on their forehead and on their hand. They lived, and reigned with Christ for a thousand years.

⁵ The rest of the dead didn't live until the thousand years were finished. This is the first resurrection. ⁶ Blessed and holy is he who has part in the first resurrection. Over these, the second death has no power, but they will be priests of God and of Christ, and will reign with him one thousand years. ⁷ And after the thousand years, Satan will be released from his prison, ⁸ and he will come out to deceive the nations which are in the four corners of the earth, Gog and Magog, to gather them together to the war; the number of whom is as the sand of the sea.

⁹ They went up over the breadth of the earth, and surrounded the camp of the saints, and the beloved city. Fire came down out of heaven from God, and devoured them. ¹⁰ The devil who deceived them was thrown into the lake of fire and sulfur, where the beast and the false prophet are also. They will be tormented day and night forever and ever. ¹¹ I saw a great white throne, and him who sat on it, from whose face the earth and the heaven fled away. There was found no place for them. ¹² I saw the dead, the great and the small, standing before the throne, and they opened books. Another book was opened, which is the book of life. The dead were judged out of the things which were written in the books, according to their works.

¹³ The sea gave up the dead who were in it. Death and Hades gave up the dead who were in them. They were judged, each one according to his works. ¹⁴ Death and Hades were thrown into the lake of fire. This is the second death, the lake of fire. ¹⁵ If anyone was not found written in the book of life, he was cast into the lake of fire.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Revelation 21:1-8 (WEB)

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¹ I saw a new heaven and a new earth: for the first heaven and the first earth have passed away, and the sea is no more. ² I saw the holy city, New Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared like a bride adorned for her husband. ³ I heard a loud voice out of heaven saying, "Behold, God's dwelling is with people, and he will dwell with them, and they will be his people, and God himself will be with them as their God. ⁴ He will wipe away from them every tear from their eyes. Death will be no more; neither will there be mourning, nor crying, nor pain, any more. The first things have passed away."

⁵ He who sits on the throne said, "Behold, I am making all things new." He said, "Write, for these words of God are faithful and true." ⁶ He said to me, "It is done! I am the Alpha and the Omega, the Beginning and the End. I will give freely to him who is thirsty from the spring of the water of life. ⁷ He who overcomes, I will give him these things. I will be his God, and he will be my son. ⁸ But for the cowardly, unbelieving, sinners, abominable, murderers, sexually immoral, sorcerers, idolaters, and all liars, their part is in the lake that burns with fire and sulfur, which is the second death."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Premillennialism expects Christ's return before a millennial reign; historic and dispensational forms differ.
- Amillennialism reads the millennium symbolically as Christ's present heavenly reign and the church age.
- Postmillennialism expects the gospel's long historical triumph before Christ's return.
- Preterist, historicist, futurist, and idealist approaches offer different ways of locating apocalyptic visions.
- Eschatology is meant to produce hope, holiness, endurance, and mission, not date-setting.

Further references: Isaiah 65:17-25; Daniel 12:1-3; Matthew 25:31-46; Acts 1:9-11; 1 Corinthians 15:20-28; 2 Thessalonians 2:1-12; Titus 2:11-14; Revelation 22:6-21.

Pastoral caution. Jesus explicitly warns against confident date-setting. Eschatological systems should be evaluated by their fidelity to the whole canon and by whether they produce hope, holiness, endurance, and love.

27. Resurrection, Judgment, Heaven, and New Creation

Christian hope is bodily resurrection and renewed creation, not merely the escape of an immortal soul. Scripture also speaks of conscious presence with Christ after death, while directing final hope toward resurrection. Judgment reveals God's justice, exposes deeds and secrets, vindicates the oppressed, and results in life or exclusion. The biblical finale is a holy city in a renewed heaven and earth where God dwells with humanity.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Revelation 21:4 (NASB 2020)

"He will wipe away every tear from their eyes."

Primary core reading: John 5:24-29 (WEB)

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²⁴ "Most certainly I tell you, he who hears my word, and believes him who sent me, has eternal life, and doesn't come into judgment, but has passed out of death into life. ²⁵ Most certainly, I tell you, the hour comes, and now is, when the dead will hear the Son of God's voice; and those who hear will live. ²⁶ For as the Father has life in himself, even so he gave to the Son also to have life in himself. ²⁷ He also gave him authority to execute judgment, because he is a son of man.

²⁸ Don't marvel at this, for the hour comes, in which all that are in the tombs will hear his voice, ²⁹ and will come out; those who have done good, to the resurrection of life; and those who have done evil, to the resurrection of judgment.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 15:35-58 (WEB)

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³⁵ But someone will say, "How are the dead raised?" and, "With what kind of body do they come?" ³⁶ You foolish one, that which you yourself sow is not made alive unless it dies. ³⁷ That which you sow, you don't sow the body that will be, but a bare grain, maybe of wheat, or of some other kind. ³⁸ But God gives it a body even as it pleased him, and to each seed a body of its own.

³⁹ All flesh is not the same flesh, but there is one flesh of men, another flesh of animals, another of fish, and another of birds. ⁴⁰ There are also celestial bodies, and terrestrial bodies; but the glory of the celestial differs from that of the terrestrial. ⁴¹ There is one glory of the sun, another glory of the moon, and another glory of the stars; for one star differs from another star in glory. ⁴² So also is the resurrection of the dead. It is sown in corruption; it is raised in incorruption.

⁴³ It is sown in dishonor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power. ⁴⁴ It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. There is a natural body and there is also a spiritual body. ⁴⁵ So also it is written, "The first man, Adam, became a living soul." The last Adam became a life-giving spirit. ⁴⁶ However that which is spiritual isn't first, but that which is natural, then that which is spiritual.

⁴⁷ The first man is of the earth, made of dust. The second man is the Lord from heaven. ⁴⁸ As is the one made of dust, such are those who are also made of dust; and as is the heavenly, such are they also that are heavenly. ⁴⁹ As we have borne the image of those made of dust, let's also bear the image of the heavenly. ⁵⁰ Now I say this, brothers, that flesh and blood can't inherit the Kingdom of God; neither does corruption inherit incorruption.

⁵¹ Behold, I tell you a mystery. We will not all sleep, but we will all be changed, ⁵² in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound, and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we will be changed. ⁵³ For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and this mortal must put on immortality. ⁵⁴ But when this corruptible will have put on incorruption, and this mortal will have put on immortality, then what is written will happen: "Death is swallowed up in victory."

⁵⁵ "Death, where is your sting? Hades, where is your victory?" ⁵⁶ The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law. ⁵⁷ But thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ. ⁵⁸ Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the Lord's work, because you know that your labor is not in vain in the Lord.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 2 Corinthians 5:1-10 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ For we know that if the earthly house of our tent is dissolved, we have a building from God, a house not made with hands, eternal, in the heavens. ² For most certainly in this we groan, longing to be clothed with our habitation which is from heaven; ³ if so be that being clothed we will not be found naked. ⁴ For indeed we who are in this tent do groan, being burdened; not that we desire to be unclothed, but that we desire to be clothed, that what is mortal may be swallowed up by life.

⁵ Now he who made us for this very thing is God, who also gave to us the down payment of the Spirit. ⁶ Therefore, we are always confident and know that while we are at home in the body, we are absent from the Lord; ⁷ for we walk by faith, not by sight. ⁸ We are courageous, I say, and are willing rather to be absent from the body, and to be at home with the Lord.

⁹ Therefore also we make it our aim, whether at home or absent, to be well pleasing to him. ¹⁰ For we must all be revealed before the judgment seat of Christ; that each one may receive the things in the body, according to what he has done, whether good or bad.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Revelation 21:1-7 (WEB)

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¹ I saw a new heaven and a new earth: for the first heaven and the first earth have passed away, and the sea is no more. ² I saw the holy city, New Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared like a bride adorned for her husband. ³ I heard a loud voice out of heaven saying, "Behold, God's dwelling is with people, and he will dwell with them, and they will be his people, and God himself will be with them as their God. ⁴ He will wipe away from them every tear from their eyes. Death will be no more; neither will there be mourning, nor crying, nor pain, any more. The first things have passed away."

⁵ He who sits on the throne said, "Behold, I am making all things new." He said, "Write, for these words of God are faithful and true." ⁶ He said to me, "It is done! I am the Alpha and the Omega, the Beginning and the End. I will give freely to him who is thirsty from the spring of the water of life. ⁷ He who overcomes, I will give him these things. I will be his God, and he will be my son.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Revelation 22:1-5 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ He showed me a river of water of life, clear as crystal, proceeding out of the throne of God and of the Lamb, ² in the middle of its street. On this side of the river and on that was the tree of life, bearing twelve kinds of fruits, yielding its fruit every month. The leaves of the tree were for the healing of the nations. ³ There will be no curse any more. The throne of God and of the Lamb will be in it, and his servants serve him. ⁴ They will see his face, and his name will be on their foreheads.

⁵ There will be no night, and they need no lamp light; for the Lord God will illuminate them. They will reign forever and ever.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Jesus' resurrection is the pattern and guarantee of believers' resurrection.
- Final judgment is universal, personal, and righteous.
- The intermediate state should not replace resurrection as the final hope.
- New creation restores embodied, communal, worshipful life under God's presence.

Further references: Daniel 12:1-3; Matthew 25:31-46; Luke 23:39-43; John 11:21-27; Romans 8:18-25; Philippians 1:20-24; Philippians 3:20-21; 2 Peter 3:10-13.

28. Suffering, Lament, and Providence

Scripture refuses simple explanations for every instance of suffering. It includes suffering caused by sin, oppression, foolishness, persecution, natural frailty, and mysteries beyond human sight. Lament is faithful speech, not unbelief. Christian hope does not call evil good; it trusts that God can sustain, redeem, judge, and finally heal.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Romans 8:18 (NASB 2020)

"The sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory that is to be revealed."

Primary core reading: Job 1:20-22 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²⁰ Then Job arose, and tore his robe, and shaved his head, and fell down on the ground, and worshiped. ²¹ He said, "Naked I came out of my mother's womb, and naked shall I return there. Yahweh gave, and Yahweh has taken away. Blessed be the name of Yahweh."

²² In all this, Job did not sin, nor charge God with wrongdoing.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Psalm 13:1-6 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David. How long, Yahweh? Will you forget me forever? How long will you hide your face from me? ² How long shall I take counsel in my soul, having sorrow in my heart every day? How long shall my enemy triumph over me?

³ Behold, and answer me, Yahweh, my God. Give light to my eyes, lest I sleep in death; ⁴ Lest my enemy say, "I have prevailed against him;" Lest my adversaries rejoice when I fall.

⁵ But I trust in your loving kindness. My heart rejoices in your salvation. ⁶ I will sing to Yahweh, because he has been good to me.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Romans 8:18-39 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁸ For I consider that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which will be revealed toward us. ¹⁹ For the creation waits with eager expectation for the children of God to be revealed. ²⁰ For the creation was subjected to vanity, not of its own will, but because of him who subjected it, in hope ²¹ that the creation itself also will be delivered from the bondage of decay into the liberty of the glory of the children of God.

²² For we know that the whole creation groans and travails in pain together until now. ²³ Not only so, but ourselves also, who have the first fruits of the Spirit, even we ourselves groan within ourselves, waiting for adoption, the redemption of our body. ²⁴ For we were saved in hope, but hope that is seen is not hope. For who hopes for that which he sees? ²⁵ But if we hope for that which we don't see, we wait for it with patience.

²⁶ In the same way, the Spirit also helps our weaknesses, for we don't know how to pray as we ought. But the Spirit himself makes intercession for us with groanings which can't be uttered. ²⁷ He who searches the hearts knows what is on the Spirit's mind, because he makes intercession for the saints according to God. ²⁸ We know that all things work together for good for those who love God, to those who are called according to his purpose. ²⁹ For whom he foreknew, he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brothers.

³⁰ Whom he predestined, those he also called. Whom he called, those he also justified. Whom he justified, those he also glorified. ³¹ What then shall we say about these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? ³² He who didn't spare his own Son, but delivered him up for us all, how would he not also with him freely give us all things? ³³ Who could bring a charge against God's chosen ones? It is God who justifies.

³⁴ Who is he who condemns? It is Christ who died, yes rather, who was raised from the dead, who is at the right hand of God, who also makes intercession for us. ³⁵ Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Could oppression, or anguish, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? ³⁶ Even as it is written, "For your sake we are killed all day long. We were accounted as sheep for the slaughter." ³⁷ No, in all these things, we are more than conquerors through him who loved us.

³⁸ For I am persuaded, that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor things present, nor things to come, nor powers, ³⁹ nor height, nor depth, nor any other created thing, will be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 2 Corinthians 4:7-18 (WEB)

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⁷ But we have this treasure in clay vessels, that the exceeding greatness of the power may be of God, and not from ourselves. ⁸ We are pressed on every side, yet not crushed; perplexed, yet not to despair; ⁹ pursued, yet not forsaken; struck down, yet not destroyed; ¹⁰ always carrying in the body the putting to death of the Lord Jesus, that the life of Jesus may also be revealed in our body.

¹¹ For we who live are always delivered to death for Jesus' sake, that the life also of Jesus may be revealed in our mortal flesh. ¹² So then death works in us, but life in you. ¹³ But having the same spirit of faith, according to that which is written, "I believed, and therefore I spoke." We also believe, and therefore also we speak; ¹⁴ knowing that he who raised the Lord Jesus will raise us also with Jesus, and will present us with you.

¹⁵ For all things are for your sakes, that the grace, being multiplied through the many, may cause the thanksgiving to abound to the glory of God. ¹⁶ Therefore we don't faint, but though our outward man is decaying, yet our inward man is renewed day by day. ¹⁷ For our light affliction, which is for the moment, works for us more and more exceedingly an eternal weight of glory; ¹⁸ while we don't look at the things which are seen, but at the things which are not seen. For the things which are seen are temporal, but the things which are not seen are eternal.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Peter 4:12-19 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹² Beloved, don't be astonished at the fiery trial which has come upon you, to test you, as though a strange thing happened to you. ¹³ But because you are partakers of Christ's sufferings, rejoice; that at the revelation of his glory you also may rejoice with exceeding joy. ¹⁴ If you are insulted for the name of Christ, you are blessed; because the Spirit of glory and of God rests on you. On their part he is blasphemed, but on your part he is glorified. ¹⁵ For let none of you suffer as a murderer, or a thief, or an evil doer, or a meddler in other men's matters.

¹⁶ But if one of you suffers for being a Christian, let him not be ashamed; but let him glorify God in this matter. ¹⁷ For the time has come for judgment to begin with the household of God. If it begins first with us, what will happen to those who don't obey the Good News of God? ¹⁸ "If it is hard for the righteous to be saved, what will happen to the ungodly and the sinner?" ¹⁹ Therefore let them also who suffer according to the will of God in doing good entrust their souls to him, as to a faithful Creator.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Not all suffering is direct punishment for a particular sin.
- God welcomes honest lament and questions.
- The cross shows God entering suffering rather than observing it from a distance.
- Providence means evil cannot finally defeat God's purpose, not that every event is easy to explain.

Further references: Genesis 50:15-21; Psalm 22:1-5; Psalm 42:1-11; John 9:1-5; John 11:32-36; 2 Corinthians 1:3-7; Hebrews 4:14-16; James 1:2-5.

29. Compassion and Mercy

God's compassion is his tender movement toward the afflicted, while mercy is his generous relief of misery and withholding of deserved judgment. Jesus embodies divine compassion in teaching, healing, feeding, forgiving, and welcoming. Believers are commanded not merely to feel sympathy but to act as neighbors.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Micah 6:8 (NASB 2020)

"Do justice, to love kindness, and to walk humbly with your God."

Primary core reading: Exodus 34:5-7 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁵ Yahweh descended in the cloud, and stood with him there, and proclaimed the name of Yahweh. ⁶ Yahweh passed by before him, and proclaimed, "Yahweh! Yahweh, a merciful and gracious God, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness and truth, ⁷ keeping loving kindness for thousands, forgiving iniquity and disobedience and sin; and that will by no means clear the guilty, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children, and on the children's children, on the third and on the fourth generation."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Psalm 103:8-14 (WEB)

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⁸ Yahweh is merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness. ⁹ He will not always accuse; neither will he stay angry forever.

¹⁰ He has not dealt with us according to our sins, nor repaid us for our iniquities. ¹¹ For as the heavens are high above the earth, so great is his loving kindness toward those who fear him.

¹² As far as the east is from the west, so far has he removed our transgressions from us. ¹³ Like a father has compassion on his children, so Yahweh has compassion on those who fear him.

¹⁴ For he knows how we are made. He remembers that we are dust.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Luke 10:25-37 (WEB)

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²⁵ Behold, a certain lawyer stood up and tested him, saying, "Teacher, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?" ²⁶ He said to him, "What is written in the law? How do you read it?" ²⁷ He answered, "You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul, with all your strength, and with all your mind; and your neighbor as yourself." ²⁸ He said to him, "You have answered correctly. Do this, and you will live."

²⁹ But he, desiring to justify himself, asked Jesus, "Who is my neighbor?" ³⁰ Jesus answered, "A certain man was going down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and he fell among robbers, who both stripped him and beat him, and departed, leaving him half dead. ³¹ By chance a certain priest was going down that way. When he saw him, he passed by on the other side. ³² In the same way a Levite also, when he came to the place, and saw him, passed by on the other side.

³³ But a certain Samaritan, as he traveled, came where he was. When he saw him, he was moved with compassion, ³⁴ came to him, and bound up his wounds, pouring on oil and wine. He set him on his own animal, and brought him to an inn, and took care of him. ³⁵ On the next day, when he departed, he took out two denarii, and gave them to the host, and said to him, 'Take care of him. Whatever you spend beyond that, I will repay you when I return.' ³⁶ Now which of these three do you think seemed to be a neighbor to him who fell among the robbers?"

³⁷ He said, "He who showed mercy on him." Then Jesus said to him, "Go and do likewise."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Matthew 25:31-40 (WEB)

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³¹ "But when the Son of Man comes in his glory, and all the holy angels with him, then he will sit on the throne of his glory. ³² Before him all the nations will be gathered, and he will separate them one from another, as a shepherd separates the sheep from the goats. ³³ He will set the sheep on his right hand, but the goats on the left. ³⁴ Then the King will tell those on his right hand, 'Come, blessed of my Father, inherit the Kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world;

³⁵ for I was hungry, and you gave me food to eat. I was thirsty, and you gave me drink. I was a stranger, and you took me in. ³⁶ I was naked, and you clothed me. I was sick, and you visited me. I was in prison, and you came to me.' ³⁷ "Then the righteous will answer him, saying, 'Lord, when did we see you hungry, and feed you; or thirsty, and give you a drink? ³⁸ When did we see you as a stranger, and take you in; or naked, and clothe you?

³⁹ When did we see you sick, or in prison, and come to you?' ⁴⁰ "The King will answer them, 'Most certainly I tell you, inasmuch as you did it to one of the least of these my brothers, you did it to me.'

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: James 2:12-17 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹² So speak, and so do, as men who are to be judged by a law of freedom. ¹³ For judgment is without mercy to him who has shown no mercy. Mercy triumphs over judgment. ¹⁴ What good is it, my brothers, if a man says he has faith, but has no works? Can faith save him? ¹⁵ And if a brother or sister is naked and in lack of daily food,

¹⁶ and one of you tells them, "Go in peace, be warmed and filled;" and yet you didn't give them the things the body needs, what good is it? ¹⁷ Even so faith, if it has no works, is dead in itself.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Divine mercy is rooted in God's character.
- Compassion crosses social, ethnic, and moral boundaries.
- Mercy addresses bodily, relational, and spiritual need.
- Those who receive mercy are called to become merciful.

Further references: Deuteronomy 15:7-11; Isaiah 58:6-10; Hosea 6:6; Matthew 9:35-38; Matthew 18:23-35; Luke 6:27-36; Ephesians 4:31-32; 1 John 3:16-18.

30. Forgiveness and Reconciliation

Forgiveness releases personal vengeance and reflects God's pardon, while reconciliation seeks restored relationship where truth, repentance, justice, and safety permit. Scripture commands generous forgiveness but does not require pretending evil did not occur or removing all boundaries. God's forgiveness is costly, grounded in Christ's self-giving.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Ephesians 4:32 (NASB 2020)

"Be kind to one another, compassionate, forgiving each other, just as God in Christ also has forgiven you."

Primary core reading: Psalm 32:1-5 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ By David. A contemplative psalm. Blessed is he whose disobedience is forgiven, whose sin is covered. ² Blessed is the man to whom Yahweh doesn't impute iniquity, in whose spirit there is no deceit.

³ When I kept silence, my bones wasted away through my groaning all day long. ⁴ For day and night your hand was heavy on me. My strength was sapped in the heat of summer. Selah.

⁵ I acknowledged my sin to you. I didn't hide my iniquity. I said, I will confess my transgressions to Yahweh, and you forgave the iniquity of my sin. Selah.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Matthew 6:9-15 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁹ Pray like this: 'Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy. ¹⁰ Let your Kingdom come. Let your will be done, as in heaven, so on earth. ¹¹ Give us today our daily bread. ¹² Forgive us our debts, as we also forgive our debtors.

¹³ Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one. For yours is the Kingdom, the power, and the glory forever. Amen.' ¹⁴ "For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. ¹⁵ But if you don't forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Matthew 18:21-35 (WEB)

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²¹ Then Peter came and said to him, “Lord, how often shall my brother sin against me, and I forgive him? Until seven times?” ²² Jesus said to him, “I don’t tell you until seven times, but, until seventy times seven. ²³ Therefore the Kingdom of Heaven is like a certain king, who wanted to reconcile accounts with his servants. ²⁴ When he had begun to reconcile, one was brought to him who owed him ten thousand talents.

²⁵ But because he couldn’t pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, with his wife, his children, and all that he had, and payment to be made. ²⁶ The servant therefore fell down and kneeled before him, saying, ‘Lord, have patience with me, and I will repay you all!’ ²⁷ The lord of that servant, being moved with compassion, released him, and forgave him the debt. ²⁸ “But that servant went out, and found one of his fellow servants, who owed him one hundred denarii, and he grabbed him, and took him by the throat, saying, ‘Pay me what you owe!’

²⁹ “So his fellow servant fell down at his feet and begged him, saying, ‘Have patience with me, and I will repay you!’

³⁰ He would not, but went and cast him into prison, until he should pay back that which was due. ³¹ So when his fellow servants saw what was done, they were exceedingly sorry, and came and told to their lord all that was done.

³² Then his lord called him in, and said to him, ‘You wicked servant! I forgave you all that debt, because you begged me.

³³ Shouldn’t you also have had mercy on your fellow servant, even as I had mercy on you?’ ³⁴ His lord was angry, and delivered him to the tormentors, until he should pay all that was due to him. ³⁵ So my heavenly Father will also do to you, if you don’t each forgive your brother from your hearts for his misdeeds.”

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 2 Corinthians 5:17-21 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁷ Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old things have passed away. Behold, all things have become new. ¹⁸ But all things are of God, who reconciled us to himself through Jesus Christ, and gave to us the ministry of reconciliation; ¹⁹ namely, that God was in Christ reconciling the world to himself, not reckoning to them their trespasses, and having committed to us the word of reconciliation. ²⁰ We are therefore ambassadors on behalf of Christ, as though God were entreating by us: we beg you on behalf of Christ, be reconciled to God.

²¹ For him who knew no sin he made to be sin on our behalf; so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Colossians 3:12-15 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹² Put on therefore, as God’s chosen ones, holy and beloved, a heart of compassion, kindness, lowliness, humility, and perseverance; ¹³ bearing with one another, and forgiving each other, if any man has a complaint against any; even as Christ forgave you, so you also do. ¹⁴ Above all these things, walk in love, which is the bond of perfection. ¹⁵ And let the peace of God rule in your hearts, to which also you were called in one body; and be thankful.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Confession brings sin into the light.
- Forgiveness and accountability are not enemies.
- Reconciliation may require repentance, restitution, time, and wisdom.
- The church is entrusted with a ministry of reconciliation grounded in the cross.

Further references: Genesis 50:15-21; Proverbs 19:11; Luke 17:3-4; Luke 23:33-34; Romans 12:17-21; Ephesians 4:25-32; Philemon 1:8-18; 1 John 1:5-10.

31. Friendship and Community

Biblical friendship is covenantal loyalty, truth-telling, shared joy and grief, wise counsel, protection, and mutual sharpening. Scripture also warns that companions shape character. Christian friendship is enlarged by the church's call to bear burdens, practice hospitality, and form a community not based solely on natural affinity.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Proverbs 17:17 (NASB 2020)

"A friend loves at all times."

Primary core reading: 1 Samuel 18:1-4 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ It happened, when he had made an end of speaking to Saul, that the soul of Jonathan was knit with the soul of David, and Jonathan loved him as his own soul. ² Saul took him that day, and would let him go no more home to his father's house. ³ Then Jonathan and David made a covenant, because he loved him as his own soul. ⁴ Jonathan stripped himself of the robe that was on him, and gave it to David, and his clothing, even to his sword, and to his bow, and to his sash.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Proverbs 17:17 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁷ A friend loves at all times; and a brother is born for adversity.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Proverbs 27:5-10 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁵ Better is open rebuke than hidden love. ⁶ Faithful are the wounds of a friend; although the kisses of an enemy are profuse.

⁷ A full soul loathes a honeycomb; but to a hungry soul, every bitter thing is sweet. ⁸ As a bird that wanders from her nest, so is a man who wanders from his home.

⁹ Perfume and incense bring joy to the heart; so does earnest counsel from a man's friend. ¹⁰ Don't forsake your friend and your father's friend. Don't go to your brother's house in the day of your disaster: better is a neighbor who is near than a distant brother.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: John 15:12-17 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹² "This is my commandment, that you love one another, even as I have loved you. ¹³ Greater love has no one than this, that someone lay down his life for his friends. ¹⁴ You are my friends, if you do whatever I command you. ¹⁵ No longer do I call you servants, for the servant doesn't know what his lord does. But I have called you friends, for everything that I heard from my Father, I have made known to you.

¹⁶ You didn't choose me, but I chose you, and appointed you, that you should go and bear fruit, and that your fruit should remain; that whatever you will ask of the Father in my name, he may give it to you. ¹⁷ "I command these things to you, that you may love one another.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Galatians 6:1-2 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Brothers, even if a man is caught in some fault, you who are spiritual must restore such a one in a spirit of gentleness; looking to yourself so that you also aren't tempted. ² Bear one another's burdens, and so fulfill the law of Christ.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Faithful friends remain present in adversity.
- Love tells the truth without cruelty.
- Friendship includes mutuality, sacrifice, and boundaries.
- Jesus redefines greatness and friendship through self-giving love.

Further references: Ruth 1:16-17; Job 6:14; Proverbs 13:20; Proverbs 18:24; Ecclesiastes 4:9-12; Luke 10:38-42; Romans 12:9-16; Hebrews 10:24-25.

32. Marriage

Marriage is presented as a covenantal union of husband and wife involving companionship, sexual faithfulness, shared life, and a one-flesh bond. The Bible speaks from patriarchal cultures and includes difficult household texts; Christian interpretation must read them through Christ's self-giving lordship, mutual obligations, and the equal dignity of both spouses before God. Scripture also honors singleness as a genuine vocation.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Ephesians 5:25 (NASB 2020)

"Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ also loved the church and gave Himself up for her."

Primary core reading: Genesis 2:18-25 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁸ Yahweh God said, "It is not good that the man should be alone; I will make him a helper suitable for him." ¹⁹ Out of the ground Yahweh God formed every animal of the field, and every bird of the sky, and brought them to the man to see what he would call them. Whatever the man called every living creature, that was its name. ²⁰ The man gave names to all livestock, and to the birds of the sky, and to every animal of the field; but for man there was not found a helper suitable for him. ²¹ Yahweh God caused a deep sleep to fall on the man, and he slept; and he took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh in its place.

²² He made the rib, which Yahweh God had taken from the man, into a woman, and brought her to the man. ²³ The man said, "This is now bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh. She will be called 'woman,' because she was taken out of Man." ²⁴ Therefore a man will leave his father and his mother, and will join with his wife, and they will be one flesh. ²⁵ They were both naked, the man and his wife, and were not ashamed.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Matthew 19:3-9 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

³ Pharisees came to him, testing him, and saying, "Is it lawful for a man to divorce his wife for any reason?" ⁴ He answered, "Haven't you read that he who made them from the beginning made them male and female, ⁵ and said, 'For this cause a man shall leave his father and mother, and shall join to his wife; and the two shall become one flesh?' ⁶ So that they are no more two, but one flesh. What therefore God has joined together, don't let man tear apart."

⁷ They asked him, "Why then did Moses command us to give her a bill of divorce, and divorce her?" ⁸ He said to them, "Moses, because of the hardness of your hearts, allowed you to divorce your wives, but from the beginning it has not been so. ⁹ I tell you that whoever divorces his wife, except for sexual immorality, and marries another, commits adultery; and he who marries her when she is divorced commits adultery."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 7:1-16 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Now concerning the things about which you wrote to me: it is good for a man not to touch a woman. ² But, because of sexual immoralities, let each man have his own wife, and let each woman have her own husband. ³ Let the husband render to his wife the affection owed her, and likewise also the wife to her husband. ⁴ The wife doesn't have authority over her own body, but the husband. Likewise also the husband doesn't have authority over his own body, but the wife.

⁵ Don't deprive one another, unless it is by consent for a season, that you may give yourselves to fasting and prayer, and may be together again, that Satan doesn't tempt you because of your lack of self-control. ⁶ But this I say by way of concession, not of commandment. ⁷ Yet I wish that all men were like me. However each man has his own gift from God, one of this kind, and another of that kind. ⁸ But I say to the unmarried and to widows, it is good for them if they remain even as I am.

⁹ But if they don't have self-control, let them marry. For it's better to marry than to burn. ¹⁰ But to the married I command—not I, but the Lord—that the wife not leave her husband ¹¹ (but if she departs, let her remain unmarried, or else be reconciled to her husband), and that the husband not leave his wife. ¹² But to the rest I—not the Lord—say, if any brother has an unbelieving wife, and she is content to live with him, let him not leave her.

¹³ The woman who has an unbelieving husband, and he is content to live with her, let her not leave her husband. ¹⁴ For the unbelieving husband is sanctified in the wife, and the unbelieving wife is sanctified in the husband. Otherwise your children would be unclean, but now they are holy. ¹⁵ Yet if the unbeliever departs, let there be separation. The brother or the sister is not under bondage in such cases, but God has called us in peace. ¹⁶ For how do you know, wife, whether you will save your husband? Or how do you know, husband, whether you will save your wife?

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Ephesians 5:21-33 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²¹ subjecting yourselves one to another in the fear of Christ. ²² Wives, be subject to your own husbands, as to the Lord. ²³ For the husband is the head of the wife, and Christ also is the head of the assembly, being himself the savior of the body. ²⁴ But as the assembly is subject to Christ, so let the wives also be to their own husbands in everything.

²⁵ Husbands, love your wives, even as Christ also loved the assembly, and gave himself up for it; ²⁶ that he might sanctify it, having cleansed it by the washing of water with the word, ²⁷ that he might present the assembly to himself gloriously, not having spot or wrinkle or any such thing; but that it should be holy and without blemish. ²⁸ Even so husbands also ought to love their own wives as their own bodies. He who loves his own wife loves himself.

²⁹ For no man ever hated his own flesh; but nourishes and cherishes it, even as the Lord also does the assembly; ³⁰ because we are members of his body, of his flesh and bones. ³¹ "For this cause a man will leave his father and mother, and will be joined to his wife. The two will become one flesh." ³² This mystery is great, but I speak concerning Christ and of the assembly.

³³ Nevertheless each of you must also love his own wife even as himself; and let the wife see that she respects her husband.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Peter 3:1-7 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ In the same way, wives, be in subjection to your own husbands; so that, even if any don't obey the Word, they may be won by the behavior of their wives without a word; ² seeing your pure behavior in fear. ³ Let your beauty be not just the outward adorning of braiding the hair, and of wearing jewels of gold, or of putting on fine clothing; ⁴ but in the hidden person of the heart, in the incorruptible adornment of a gentle and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of God very precious.

⁵ For this is how the holy women before, who hoped in God also adorned themselves, being in subjection to their own husbands: ⁶ as Sarah obeyed Abraham, calling him lord, whose children you now are, if you do well, and are not put in fear by any terror. ⁷ You husbands, in the same way, live with your wives according to knowledge, giving honor to the woman, as to the weaker vessel, as being also joint heirs of the grace of life; that your prayers may not be hindered.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Marriage is covenant, not merely contract or emotion.
- Faithfulness, tenderness, truth, and mutual service protect the one-flesh union.
- Christlike headship cannot be used to excuse domination or abuse.
- Marriage is honored, and singleness is also honored as service to God.

Further references: Proverbs 5:15-20; Proverbs 31:10-31; Song of Solomon 8:6-7; Malachi 2:13-16; Matthew 22:23-30; 1 Corinthians 7:32-35; Colossians 3:18-19; Hebrews 13:4.

33. Family and Parenting

Families are primary settings for nurture, memory, discipline, provision, and faith formation, yet Scripture never makes the biological family absolute. Jesus creates a wider household of disciples and sometimes calls people to costly loyalty beyond family expectations. Parenting is stewardship: children are persons to be loved and guided, not possessions to control.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Ephesians 6:4 (NASB 2020)

“Bring them up in the discipline and instruction of the Lord.”

Primary core reading: Deuteronomy 6:4-9 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴ Hear, Israel: Yahweh is our God; Yahweh is one: ⁵ and you shall love Yahweh your God with all your heart, and with all your soul, and with all your might. ⁶ These words, which I command you this day, shall be on your heart; ⁷ and you shall teach them diligently to your children, and shall talk of them when you sit in your house, and when you walk by the way, and when you lie down, and when you rise up.

⁸ You shall bind them for a sign on your hand, and they shall be for symbols between your eyes. ⁹ You shall write them on the door posts of your house, and on your gates.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Psalm 127:1-5 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ A Song of Ascents. By Solomon. Unless Yahweh builds the house, they labor in vain who build it. Unless Yahweh watches over the city, the watchman guards it in vain. ² It is vain for you to rise up early, to stay up late, eating the bread of toil; for he gives sleep to his loved ones.

³ Behold, children are a heritage of Yahweh. The fruit of the womb is his reward. ⁴ As arrows in the hand of a mighty man, so are the children of youth.

⁵ Happy is the man who has his quiver full of them. They won't be disappointed when they speak with their enemies in the gate.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Proverbs 22:6 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁶ Train up a child in the way he should go, and when he is old he will not depart from it.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Ephesians 6:1-4 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is right. ² “Honor your father and mother,” which is the first commandment with a promise: ³ “that it may be well with you, and you may live long on the earth.” ⁴ You fathers, don't provoke your children to wrath, but nurture them in the discipline and instruction of the Lord.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Colossians 3:20-21 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²⁰ Children, obey your parents in all things, for this pleases the Lord. ²¹ Fathers, don't provoke your children, so that they won't be discouraged.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Faith formation happens through repeated teaching and embodied example.
- Discipline should aim at wisdom and restoration, never humiliation or harm.
- Parents are warned not to provoke or crush their children.
- The church bears responsibility for widows, orphans, singles, and those whose natural families fail them.

Further references: Genesis 18:17-19; Joshua 24:14-15; Proverbs 1:7-9; Proverbs 13:24; Mark 3:31-35; Mark 10:13-16; 1 Timothy 5:3-8; 2 Timothy 1:3-5.

34. Work, Money, and Stewardship

Work begins as part of humanity's created vocation, though toil is intensified by the fall. Money is a tool and a spiritual test: Scripture warns against greed, exploitation, anxiety, and hoarding while commending diligence, contentment, generosity, planning, and care for dependents. Stewardship recognizes that possessions ultimately belong to God.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Colossians 3:23 (NASB 2020)

"Whatever you do, do your work heartily, as for the Lord and not for people."

Primary core reading: Genesis 2:15-17 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁵ Yahweh God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and to keep it. ¹⁶ Yahweh God commanded the man, saying, "Of every tree of the garden you may freely eat; ¹⁷ but of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, you shall not eat of it; for in the day that you eat of it you will surely die."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Proverbs 6:6-11 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁶ Go to the ant, you sluggard. Consider her ways, and be wise; ⁷ which having no chief, overseer, or ruler, ⁸ provides her bread in the summer, and gathers her food in the harvest. ⁹ How long will you sleep, sluggard? When will you arise out of your sleep?

¹⁰ A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep: ¹¹ so your poverty will come as a robber, and your scarcity as an armed man.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Matthew 6:19-34 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁹ “Don’t lay up treasures for yourselves on the earth, where moth and rust consume, and where thieves break through and steal; ²⁰ but lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust consume, and where thieves don’t break through and steal; ²¹ for where your treasure is, there your heart will be also. ²² “The lamp of the body is the eye. If therefore your eye is sound, your whole body will be full of light.

²³ But if your eye is evil, your whole body will be full of darkness. If therefore the light that is in you is darkness, how great is the darkness! ²⁴ “No one can serve two masters, for either he will hate the one and love the other; or else he will be devoted to one and despise the other. You can’t serve both God and Mammon. ²⁵ Therefore, I tell you, don’t be anxious for your life: what you will eat, or what you will drink; nor yet for your body, what you will wear. Isn’t life more than food, and the body more than clothing? ²⁶ See the birds of the sky, that they don’t sow, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns. Your heavenly Father feeds them. Aren’t you of much more value than they?

²⁷ “Which of you, by being anxious, can add one moment to his lifespan? ²⁸ Why are you anxious about clothing? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow. They don’t toil, neither do they spin, ²⁹ yet I tell you that even Solomon in all his glory was not dressed like one of these. ³⁰ But if God so clothes the grass of the field, which today exists, and tomorrow is thrown into the oven, won’t he much more clothe you, you of little faith?

³¹ “Therefore don’t be anxious, saying, ‘What will we eat?’, ‘What will we drink?’ or, ‘With what will we be clothed?’

³² For the Gentiles seek after all these things; for your heavenly Father knows that you need all these things. ³³ But seek first God’s Kingdom, and his righteousness; and all these things will be given to you as well. ³⁴ Therefore don’t be anxious for tomorrow, for tomorrow will be anxious for itself. Each day’s own evil is sufficient.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Timothy 6:6-19 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁶ But godliness with contentment is great gain. ⁷ For we brought nothing into the world, and we certainly can’t carry anything out. ⁸ But having food and clothing, we will be content with that. ⁹ But those who are determined to be rich fall into a temptation and a snare and many foolish and harmful lusts, such as drown men in ruin and destruction.

¹⁰ For the love of money is a root of all kinds of evil. Some have been led astray from the faith in their greed, and have pierced themselves through with many sorrows. ¹¹ But you, man of God, flee these things, and follow after righteousness, godliness, faith, love, patience, and gentleness. ¹² Fight the good fight of faith. Lay hold of the eternal life to which you were called, and you confessed the good confession in the sight of many witnesses. ¹³ I command you before God, who gives life to all things, and before Christ Jesus, who before Pontius Pilate testified the good confession,

¹⁴ that you keep the commandment without spot, blameless, until the appearing of our Lord Jesus Christ; ¹⁵ which in its own times he will show, who is the blessed and only Ruler, the King of kings, and Lord of lords; ¹⁶ who alone has immortality, dwelling in unapproachable light; whom no man has seen, nor can see: to whom be honor and eternal power. Amen. ¹⁷ Charge those who are rich in this present world that they not be haughty, nor have their hope set on the uncertainty of riches, but on the living God, who richly provides us with everything to enjoy;

¹⁸ that they do good, that they be rich in good works, that they be ready to distribute, willing to communicate; ¹⁹ laying up in store for themselves a good foundation against the time to come, that they may lay hold of eternal life.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Colossians 3:22-24 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²² Servants, obey in all things those who are your masters according to the flesh, not just when they are looking, as men pleasers, but in singleness of heart, fearing God. ²³ And whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord, and not for men, ²⁴ knowing that from the Lord you will receive the reward of the inheritance; for you serve the Lord Christ.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Work can serve creation and neighbor, but it must not become an idol.
- Wealth creates responsibility and danger.
- Generosity is voluntary, cheerful, wise, and attentive to real need.
- Rest is a theological practice that resists reducing people to productivity.

Further references: Exodus 20:8-11; Deuteronomy 8:11-18; Proverbs 11:24-28; Ecclesiastes 5:10-20; Luke 12:13-21; Luke 16:10-13; 2 Corinthians 8:9-15; 2 Thessalonians 3:6-13.

35. Justice, the Poor, and the Vulnerable

Biblical justice is right order expressed through impartial judgment, honest economics, protection of the vulnerable, punishment of wrongdoing, and restoration where possible. The prophets repeatedly condemn worship divorced from justice. Care for the poor, immigrant, widow, orphan, prisoner, and oppressed is not an optional appendix to faith.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Isaiah 1:17 (NASB 2020)

“Learn to do good; seek justice, rebuke the oppressor, obtain justice for the orphan, plead for the widow’s case.”

Primary core reading: Deuteronomy 10:17-19 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁷ For Yahweh your God, he is God of gods, and Lord of lords, the great God, the mighty, and the awesome, who doesn’t respect persons, nor takes reward. ¹⁸ He does execute justice for the fatherless and widow, and loves the foreigner, in giving him food and clothing. ¹⁹ Therefore love the foreigner; for you were foreigners in the land of Egypt.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Isaiah 1:10-20 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁰ Hear the word of Yahweh, you rulers of Sodom! Listen to the law of our God, you people of Gomorrah! ¹¹ “What are the multitude of your sacrifices to me?,” says Yahweh. “I have had enough of the burnt offerings of rams, and the fat of fed animals. I don’t delight in the blood of bulls, or of lambs, or of male goats.

¹² When you come to appear before me, who has required this at your hand, to trample my courts? ¹³ Bring no more vain offerings. Incense is an abomination to me; new moons, Sabbaths, and convocations: I can’t bear with evil assemblies.

¹⁴ My soul hates your New Moons and your appointed feasts. They are a burden to me. I am weary of bearing them.

¹⁵ When you spread forth your hands, I will hide my eyes from you. Yes, when you make many prayers, I will not hear. Your hands are full of blood.

¹⁶ Wash yourselves, make yourself clean. Put away the evil of your doings from before my eyes. Cease to do evil. ¹⁷ Learn to do well. Seek justice. Relieve the oppressed. Judge the fatherless. Plead for the widow.”

¹⁸ “Come now, and let us reason together,” says Yahweh: “Though your sins be as scarlet, they shall be as white as snow. Though they be red like crimson, they shall be as wool. ¹⁹ If you are willing and obedient, you shall eat the good of the land;

²⁰ but if you refuse and rebel, you shall be devoured with the sword; for the mouth of Yahweh has spoken it.”

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Micah 6:6-8 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁶ How shall I come before Yahweh, and bow myself before the exalted God? Shall I come before him with burnt offerings, with calves a year old? ⁷ Will Yahweh be pleased with thousands of rams? With tens of thousands of rivers of oil? Shall I give my firstborn for my disobedience? The fruit of my body for the sin of my soul? ⁸ He has shown you, O man, what is good. What does Yahweh require of you, but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God?

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Luke 4:16-21 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁶ He came to Nazareth, where he had been brought up. He entered, as was his custom, into the synagogue on the Sabbath day, and stood up to read. ¹⁷ The book of the prophet Isaiah was handed to him. He opened the book, and found the place where it was written, ¹⁸ “The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent me to heal the brokenhearted, to proclaim release to the captives, recovering of sight to the blind, to deliver those who are crushed, ¹⁹ and to proclaim the acceptable year of the Lord.”

²⁰ He closed the book, gave it back to the attendant, and sat down. The eyes of all in the synagogue were fastened on him. ²¹ He began to tell them, “Today, this Scripture has been fulfilled in your hearing.”

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: James 1:26-27 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²⁶ If anyone among you thinks himself to be religious while he doesn’t bridle his tongue, but deceives his heart, this man’s religion is worthless. ²⁷ Pure religion and undefiled before our God and Father is this: to visit the fatherless and widows in their affliction, and to keep oneself unstained by the world.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- God shows no partiality and condemns corrupt scales and courts.
- Charity relieves immediate suffering; justice also confronts practices that produce exploitation.
- The vulnerable must be treated as neighbors and image-bearers, not projects.
- Righteousness and worship are inseparable.

Further references: Leviticus 19:9-18; Deuteronomy 24:17-22; Psalm 82:1-4; Proverbs 31:8-9; Isaiah 58:6-12; Amos 5:21-24; Matthew 23:23; James 2:1-9.

36. Wisdom and Speech

Biblical wisdom is skill in faithful living under the fear of the LORD. It attends to creation, consequence, character, timing, teachability, and the limits of human knowledge. Speech reveals the heart and can heal, guide, deceive, flatter, inflame, or destroy. Wisdom literature gives general patterns, not mechanical guarantees.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Proverbs 15:1 (NASB 2020)

“A gentle answer turns away wrath.”

Primary core reading: Proverbs 1:1-7 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ The proverbs of Solomon, the son of David, king of Israel: ² to know wisdom and instruction; to discern the words of understanding;

³ to receive instruction in wise dealing, in righteousness, justice, and equity; ⁴ to give prudence to the simple, knowledge and discretion to the young man:

⁵ that the wise man may hear, and increase in learning; that the man of understanding may attain to sound counsel: ⁶ to understand a proverb, and parables, the words and riddles of the wise.

⁷ The fear of Yahweh is the beginning of knowledge; but the foolish despise wisdom and instruction.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Proverbs 3:1-12 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ My son, don't forget my teaching; but let your heart keep my commandments: ² for length of days, and years of life, and peace, will they add to you.

³ Don't let kindness and truth forsake you. Bind them around your neck. Write them on the tablet of your heart. ⁴ So you will find favor, and good understanding in the sight of God and man.

⁵ Trust in Yahweh with all your heart, and don't lean on your own understanding. ⁶ In all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make your paths straight.

⁷ Don't be wise in your own eyes. Fear Yahweh, and depart from evil. ⁸ It will be health to your body, and nourishment to your bones.

⁹ Honor Yahweh with your substance, with the first fruits of all your increase: ¹⁰ so your barns will be filled with plenty, and your vats will overflow with new wine.

¹¹ My son, don't despise Yahweh's discipline, neither be weary of his reproof: ¹² for whom Yahweh loves, he reproves; even as a father reproves the son in whom he delights.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Proverbs 15:1-4 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger. ² The tongue of the wise commends knowledge, but the mouth of fools gush out folly.

³ Yahweh's eyes are everywhere, keeping watch on the evil and the good. ⁴ A gentle tongue is a tree of life, but deceit in it crushes the spirit.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: James 1:19-27 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁹ So, then, my beloved brothers, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, and slow to anger; ²⁰ for the anger of man doesn't produce the righteousness of God. ²¹ Therefore, putting away all filthiness and overflowing of wickedness, receive with humility the implanted word, which is able to save your souls. ²² But be doers of the word, and not only hearers, deluding your own selves.

²³ For if anyone is a hearer of the word and not a doer, he is like a man looking at his natural face in a mirror; ²⁴ for he sees himself, and goes away, and immediately forgets what kind of man he was. ²⁵ But he who looks into the perfect law of freedom, and continues, not being a hearer who forgets, but a doer of the work, this man will be blessed in what he does. ²⁶ If anyone among you thinks himself to be religious while he doesn't bridle his tongue, but deceives his heart, this man's religion is worthless.

²⁷ Pure religion and undefiled before our God and Father is this: to visit the fatherless and widows in their affliction, and to keep oneself unstained by the world.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: James 3:1-12 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Let not many of you be teachers, my brothers, knowing that we will receive heavier judgment. ² For in many things we all stumble. If anyone doesn't stumble in word, the same is a perfect man, able to bridle the whole body also. ³ Indeed, we put bits into the horses' mouths so that they may obey us, and we guide their whole body. ⁴ Behold, the ships also, though they are so big and are driven by fierce winds, are yet guided by a very small rudder, wherever the pilot desires.

⁵ So the tongue is also a little member, and boasts great things. See how a small fire can spread to a large forest! ⁶ And the tongue is a fire. The world of iniquity among our members is the tongue, which defiles the whole body, and sets on fire the course of nature, and is set on fire by Gehenna. ⁷ For every kind of animal, bird, creeping thing, and thing in the sea, is tamed, and has been tamed by mankind. ⁸ But nobody can tame the tongue. It is a restless evil, full of deadly poison.

⁹ With it we bless our God and Father, and with it we curse men, who are made in the image of God. ¹⁰ Out of the same mouth comes forth blessing and cursing. My brothers, these things ought not to be so. ¹¹ Does a spring send out from the same opening fresh and bitter water? ¹² Can a fig tree, my brothers, yield olives, or a vine figs? Thus no spring yields both salt water and fresh water.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom.
- Wise people remain teachable and slow to speak.
- Truth must be joined to timing, gentleness, and love.
- Proverbs describe how life ordinarily works, while Job and Ecclesiastes expose simplistic formulas.

Further references: Job 28:12-28; Psalm 1:1-6; Proverbs 10:19-21; Proverbs 12:17-22; Ecclesiastes 3:1-8; Matthew 12:33-37; Ephesians 4:25-29; Colossians 4:5-6.

37. Temptation, Sexual Holiness, and Self-Control

Temptation appeals to disordered desire, distrust, pride, fear, or appetite. Scripture distinguishes temptation from the act of sin and points to vigilance, flight, confession, renewed thought, embodied discipline, and communal help. Sexual holiness is framed not merely by prohibition but by covenant faithfulness, the body's dignity, and love of neighbor.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - 1 Corinthians 6:18 (NASB 2020)

"Flee sexual immorality."

Primary core reading: Matthew 4:1-11 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Then Jesus was led up by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil. ² When he had fasted forty days and forty nights, he was hungry afterward. ³ The tempter came and said to him, "If you are the Son of God, command that these stones become bread." ⁴ But he answered, "It is written, 'Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceeds out of the mouth of God.'"

⁵ Then the devil took him into the holy city. He set him on the pinnacle of the temple, ⁶ and said to him, "If you are the Son of God, throw yourself down, for it is written, 'He will put his angels in charge of you.' and, 'On their hands they will bear you up, so that you don't dash your foot against a stone.'" ⁷ Jesus said to him, "Again, it is written, 'You shall not test the Lord, your God.'" ⁸ Again, the devil took him to an exceedingly high mountain, and showed him all the kingdoms of the world, and their glory.

⁹ He said to him, "I will give you all of these things, if you will fall down and worship me." ¹⁰ Then Jesus said to him, "Get behind me, Satan! For it is written, 'You shall worship the Lord your God, and you shall serve him only.'" ¹¹ Then the devil left him, and behold, angels came and served him.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 6:12-20 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹² "All things are lawful for me," but not all things are expedient. "All things are lawful for me," but I will not be brought under the power of anything. ¹³ "Foods for the belly, and the belly for foods," but God will bring to nothing both it and them. But the body is not for sexual immorality, but for the Lord; and the Lord for the body. ¹⁴ Now God raised up the Lord, and will also raise us up by his power. ¹⁵ Don't you know that your bodies are members of Christ? Shall I then take the members of Christ, and make them members of a prostitute? May it never be!

¹⁶ Or don't you know that he who is joined to a prostitute is one body? For, "The two," says he, "will become one flesh." ¹⁷ But he who is joined to the Lord is one spirit. ¹⁸ Flee sexual immorality! "Every sin that a man does is outside the body," but he who commits sexual immorality sins against his own body. ¹⁹ Or don't you know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit which is in you, which you have from God? You are not your own,

²⁰ for you were bought with a price. Therefore glorify God in your body and in your spirit, which are God's.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 10:12-14 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹² Therefore let him who thinks he stands be careful that he doesn't fall. ¹³ No temptation has taken you except what is common to man. God is faithful, who will not allow you to be tempted above what you are able, but will with the temptation also make the way of escape, that you may be able to endure it. ¹⁴ Therefore, my beloved, flee from idolatry.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: James 1:12-18 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹² Blessed is the man who endures temptation, for when he has been approved, he will receive the crown of life, which the Lord promised to those who love him. ¹³ Let no man say when he is tempted, "I am tempted by God," for God can't be tempted by evil, and he himself tempts no one. ¹⁴ But each one is tempted, when he is drawn away by his own lust, and enticed. ¹⁵ Then the lust, when it has conceived, bears sin; and the sin, when it is full grown, brings forth death.

¹⁶ Don't be deceived, my beloved brothers. ¹⁷ Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights, with whom can be no variation, nor turning shadow. ¹⁸ Of his own will he brought us forth by the word of truth, that we should be a kind of first fruits of his creatures.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 2 Timothy 2:19-22 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁹ However God's firm foundation stands, having this seal, "The Lord knows those who are his," and, "Let every one who names the name of the Lord depart from unrighteousness." ²⁰ Now in a large house there are not only vessels of gold and of silver, but also of wood and of clay. Some are for honor, and some for dishonor. ²¹ If anyone therefore purges himself from these, he will be a vessel for honor, sanctified, and suitable for the master's use, prepared for every good work. ²² Flee from youthful lusts; but pursue righteousness, faith, love, and peace with those who call on the Lord out of a pure heart.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- God is faithful and provides a way to endure temptation.
- Some temptations are resisted by standing; others by fleeing.
- Secrecy strengthens bondage; confession and wise accountability bring sin into the light.
- Self-control is fruit of the Spirit, not mere willpower.

Further references: Genesis 39:6-12; Psalm 119:9-11; Proverbs 5:1-14; Matthew 5:27-30; Romans 13:11-14; Galatians 5:16-24; 1 Thessalonians 4:3-8; 1 John 2:15-17.

38. Mission, Evangelism, and Witness

God's mission runs from the promise that all nations will be blessed through Abraham to the multinational worship of Revelation. The church witnesses by proclaiming Christ, making disciples, embodying reconciliation, defending hope with gentleness, and serving neighbors. Conversion is God's work, so faithful witness rejects manipulation.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Matthew 28:19-20 (NASB 2020)

"Make disciples of all the nations ... teaching them to follow all that I commanded you."

Primary core reading: Genesis 12:1-3 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Now Yahweh said to Abram, "Get out of your country, and from your relatives, and from your father's house, to the land that I will show you. ² I will make of you a great nation. I will bless you and make your name great. You will be a blessing. ³ I will bless those who bless you, and I will curse him who curses you. All of the families of the earth will be blessed in you."

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Matthew 28:16-20 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁶ But the eleven disciples went into Galilee, to the mountain where Jesus had sent them. ¹⁷ When they saw him, they bowed down to him, but some doubted. ¹⁸ Jesus came to them and spoke to them, saying, "All authority has been given to me in heaven and on earth. ¹⁹ Go, and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit,

²⁰ teaching them to observe all things that I commanded you. Behold, I am with you always, even to the end of the age." Amen.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Acts 1:6-8 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁶ Therefore, when they had come together, they asked him, "Lord, are you now restoring the kingdom to Israel?" ⁷ He said to them, "It isn't for you to know times or seasons which the Father has set within his own authority. ⁸ But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you. You will be witnesses to me in Jerusalem, in all Judea and Samaria, and to the uttermost parts of the earth."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Romans 10:8-17 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁸ But what does it say? “The word is near you, in your mouth, and in your heart;” that is, the word of faith, which we preach: ⁹ that if you will confess with your mouth that Jesus is Lord, and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved. ¹⁰ For with the heart, one believes unto righteousness; and with the mouth confession is made unto salvation. ¹¹ For the Scripture says, “Whoever believes in him will not be disappointed.”

¹² For there is no distinction between Jew and Greek; for the same Lord is Lord of all, and is rich to all who call on him. ¹³ For, “Whoever will call on the name of the Lord will be saved.” ¹⁴ How then will they call on him in whom they have not believed? How will they believe in him whom they have not heard? How will they hear without a preacher? ¹⁵ And how will they preach unless they are sent? As it is written: “How beautiful are the feet of those who preach the Good News of peace, who bring glad tidings of good things!”

¹⁶ But they didn’t all listen to the glad news. For Isaiah says, “Lord, who has believed our report?” ¹⁷ So faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 2 Corinthians 5:17-21 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁷ Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old things have passed away. Behold, all things have become new. ¹⁸ But all things are of God, who reconciled us to himself through Jesus Christ, and gave to us the ministry of reconciliation; ¹⁹ namely, that God was in Christ reconciling the world to himself, not reckoning to them their trespasses, and having committed to us the word of reconciliation. ²⁰ We are therefore ambassadors on behalf of Christ, as though God were entreating by us: we beg you on behalf of Christ, be reconciled to God.

²¹ For him who knew no sin he made to be sin on our behalf; so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Mission begins in God's purpose before it becomes the church's task.
- The gospel announces Jesus' lordship, death, resurrection, forgiveness, and kingdom.
- Witness includes words, character, community, mercy, and willingness to suffer.
- The goal is discipleship, not merely decisions or statistics.

Further references: Isaiah 49:5-6; Matthew 5:13-16; Luke 24:44-49; Acts 17:22-31; 1 Corinthians 9:19-23; Colossians 4:2-6; 1 Peter 3:13-16; Revelation 7:9-12.

39. Leadership, Service, and Authority

Biblical authority is accountable stewardship under God's authority. Israel's kings, prophets, priests, elders, and New Testament overseers are judged by faithfulness, justice, truth, and care for the weak. Jesus overturns status competition by defining greatness through service and self-giving.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Mark 10:45 (NASB 2020)

"The Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve."

Primary core reading: Deuteronomy 17:14-20 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁴ When you have come to the land which Yahweh your God gives you, and shall possess it, and shall dwell therein, and shall say, "I will set a king over me, like all the nations that are around me;" ¹⁵ you shall surely set him king over yourselves, whom Yahweh your God shall choose: one from among your brothers you shall set king over you; you may not put a foreigner over you, who is not your brother. ¹⁶ Only he shall not multiply horses to himself, nor cause the people to return to Egypt, to the end that he may multiply horses; because Yahweh has said to you, "You shall not go back that way again." ¹⁷ Neither shall he multiply wives to himself, that his heart not turn away: neither shall he greatly multiply to himself silver and gold.

¹⁸ It shall be, when he sits on the throne of his kingdom, that he shall write him a copy of this law in a book, out of that which is before the priests the Levites: ¹⁹ and it shall be with him, and he shall read therein all the days of his life; that he may learn to fear Yahweh his God, to keep all the words of this law and these statutes, to do them; ²⁰ that his heart not be lifted up above his brothers, and that he not turn aside from the commandment, to the right hand, or to the left: to the end that he may prolong his days in his kingdom, he and his children, in the midst of Israel.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Ezekiel 34:1-16 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ The word of Yahweh came to me, saying, ² Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel, prophesy, and tell them, even to the shepherds, Thus says the Lord Yahweh: Woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves! Shouldn't the shepherds feed the sheep? ³ You eat the fat, and you clothe yourself with the wool, you kill the fatlings; but you don't feed the sheep. ⁴ You haven't strengthened the diseased, neither have you healed that which was sick, neither have you bound up that which was broken, neither have you brought back that which was driven away, neither have you sought that which was lost; but with force and with rigor you have ruled over them.

⁵ They were scattered, because there was no shepherd; and they became food to all the animals of the field, and were scattered. ⁶ My sheep wandered through all the mountains, and on every high hill: yes, my sheep were scattered on all the surface of the earth; and there was none who searched or sought. ⁷ Therefore, you shepherds, hear the word of Yahweh: ⁸ As I live, says the Lord Yahweh, surely because my sheep became a prey, and my sheep became food to all the animals of the field, because there was no shepherd, neither did my shepherds search for my sheep, but the shepherds fed themselves, and didn't feed my sheep;

⁹ therefore, you shepherds, hear the word of Yahweh: ¹⁰ Thus says the Lord Yahweh: Behold, I am against the shepherds; and I will require my sheep at their hand, and cause them to cease from feeding the sheep; neither shall the shepherds feed themselves any more; and I will deliver my sheep from their mouth, that they may not be food for them. ¹¹ For thus says the Lord Yahweh: Behold, I myself, even I, will search for my sheep, and will seek them out. ¹² As a shepherd seeks out his flock in the day that he is among his sheep that are scattered abroad, so will I seek out my sheep; and I will deliver them out of all places where they have been scattered in the cloudy and dark day.

¹³ I will bring them out from the peoples, and gather them from the countries, and will bring them into their own land; and I will feed them on the mountains of Israel, by the watercourses, and in all the inhabited places of the country. ¹⁴ I will feed them with good pasture; and on the mountains of the height of Israel shall their fold be: there shall they lie down in a good fold; and on fat pasture shall they feed on the mountains of Israel. ¹⁵ I myself will be the shepherd of my sheep, and I will cause them to lie down, says the Lord Yahweh. ¹⁶ I will seek that which was lost, and will bring back that which was driven away, and will bind up that which was broken, and will strengthen that which was sick: but the fat and the strong I will destroy; I will feed them in justice.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Mark 10:35-45 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

³⁵ James and John, the sons of Zebedee, came near to him, saying, "Teacher, we want you to do for us whatever we will ask." ³⁶ He said to them, "What do you want me to do for you?" ³⁷ They said to him, "Grant to us that we may sit, one at your right hand, and one at your left hand, in your glory." ³⁸ But Jesus said to them, "You don't know what you are asking. Are you able to drink the cup that I drink, and to be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with?"

³⁹ They said to him, "We are able." Jesus said to them, "You shall indeed drink the cup that I drink, and you shall be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with; ⁴⁰ but to sit at my right hand and at my left hand is not mine to give, but for whom it has been prepared." ⁴¹ When the ten heard it, they began to be indignant towards James and John. ⁴² Jesus summoned them, and said to them, "You know that they who are recognized as rulers over the nations lord it over them, and their great ones exercise authority over them.

⁴³ But it shall not be so among you, but whoever wants to become great among you shall be your servant. ⁴⁴ Whoever of you wants to become first among you, shall be bondservant of all. ⁴⁵ For the Son of Man also came not to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: John 13:1-17 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Now before the feast of the Passover, Jesus, knowing that his time had come that he would depart from this world to the Father, having loved his own who were in the world, he loved them to the end. ² During supper, the devil having already put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, to betray him, ³ Jesus, knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands, and that he came forth from God, and was going to God, ⁴ arose from supper, and laid aside his outer garments. He took a towel, and wrapped a towel around his waist.

⁵ Then he poured water into the basin, and began to wash the disciples' feet, and to wipe them with the towel that was wrapped around him. ⁶ Then he came to Simon Peter. He said to him, "Lord, do you wash my feet?" ⁷ Jesus answered him, "You don't know what I am doing now, but you will understand later." ⁸ Peter said to him, "You will never wash my feet!" Jesus answered him, "If I don't wash you, you have no part with me."

⁹ Simon Peter said to him, "Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head!" ¹⁰ Jesus said to him, "Someone who has bathed only needs to have his feet washed, but is completely clean. You are clean, but not all of you." ¹¹ For he knew him who would betray him, therefore he said, "You are not all clean." ¹² So when he had washed their feet, put his outer garment back on, and sat down again, he said to them, "Do you know what I have done to you?"

¹³ You call me, 'Teacher' and 'Lord.' You say so correctly, for so I am. ¹⁴ If I then, the Lord and the Teacher, have washed your feet, you also ought to wash one another's feet. ¹⁵ For I have given you an example, that you also should do as I have done to you. ¹⁶ Most certainly I tell you, a servant is not greater than his lord, neither one who is sent greater than he who sent him.

¹⁷ If you know these things, blessed are you if you do them.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Peter 5:1-5 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ I exhort the elders among you, as a fellow elder, and a witness of the sufferings of Christ, and who will also share in the glory that will be revealed. ² Shepherd the flock of God which is among you, exercising the oversight, not under compulsion, but voluntarily, not for dishonest gain, but willingly; ³ neither as lording it over those entrusted to you, but making yourselves examples to the flock. ⁴ When the chief Shepherd is revealed, you will receive the crown of glory that doesn't fade away.

⁵ Likewise, you younger ones, be subject to the elder. Yes, all of you clothe yourselves with humility, to subject yourselves to one another; for "God resists the proud, but gives grace to the humble."

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Leaders remain under the word of God.
- Shepherd imagery emphasizes protection, provision, guidance, and accountability.
- Abuse of power is a theological offense, not merely a management failure.
- Christian leadership equips others rather than gathering dependence around itself.

Further references: Exodus 18:13-26; 2 Samuel 23:1-4; Proverbs 29:2; Matthew 20:20-28; Acts 20:17-35; 1 Timothy 3:1-13; Titus 1:5-9; Hebrews 13:7-17.

40. Peace, Anxiety, and Hope

Biblical peace is more than calm feeling; it is wholeness under God's reconciling rule. Anxiety is met not by shame but by prayer, remembrance, community, wise action, and trust in the Father's care. Hope is confident expectation rooted in God's promise and Christ's resurrection, capable of coexisting with grief.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Philippians 4:6 (NASB 2020)

"Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything by prayer and pleading with thanksgiving let your requests be made known to God."

Primary core reading: Psalm 46:1-11 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ For the Chief Musician. By the sons of Korah. According to Alamothe. God is our refuge and strength, a very present help in trouble. ² Therefore we won't be afraid, though the earth changes, though the mountains are shaken into the heart of the seas;

³ though its waters roar and are troubled, though the mountains tremble with their swelling. Selah. ⁴ There is a river, the streams of which make the city of God glad, the holy place of the tents of the Most High.

⁵ God is in her midst. She shall not be moved. God will help her at dawn. ⁶ The nations raged. The kingdoms were moved. He lifted his voice, and the earth melted.

⁷ Yahweh of Armies is with us. The God of Jacob is our refuge. Selah. ⁸ Come, see Yahweh's works, what desolations he has made in the earth.

⁹ He makes wars cease to the end of the earth. He breaks the bow, and shatters the spear. He burns the chariots in the fire. ¹⁰ "Be still, and know that I am God. I will be exalted among the nations. I will be exalted in the earth."

¹¹ Yahweh of Armies is with us. The God of Jacob is our refuge. Selah.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Matthew 6:25-34 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²⁵ Therefore, I tell you, don't be anxious for your life: what you will eat, or what you will drink; nor yet for your body, what you will wear. Isn't life more than food, and the body more than clothing? ²⁶ See the birds of the sky, that they don't sow, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns. Your heavenly Father feeds them. Aren't you of much more value than they? ²⁷ "Which of you, by being anxious, can add one moment to his lifespan?" ²⁸ Why are you anxious about clothing? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow. They don't toil, neither do they spin,

²⁹ yet I tell you that even Solomon in all his glory was not dressed like one of these. ³⁰ But if God so clothes the grass of the field, which today exists, and tomorrow is thrown into the oven, won't he much more clothe you, you of little faith? ³¹ "Therefore don't be anxious, saying, 'What will we eat?', 'What will we drink?' or, 'With what will we be clothed?'" ³² For the Gentiles seek after all these things; for your heavenly Father knows that you need all these things.

³³ But seek first God's Kingdom, and his righteousness; and all these things will be given to you as well. ³⁴ Therefore don't be anxious for tomorrow, for tomorrow will be anxious for itself. Each day's own evil is sufficient.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: John 14:25-29 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

²⁵ I have said these things to you, while still living with you. ²⁶ But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, he will teach you all things, and will remind you of all that I said to you. ²⁷ Peace I leave with you. My peace I give to you; not as the world gives, give I to you. Don't let your heart be troubled, neither let it be fearful. ²⁸ You heard how I told you, 'I go away, and I come to you.' If you loved me, you would have rejoiced, because I said 'I am going to my Father;' for the Father is greater than I.

²⁹ Now I have told you before it happens so that, when it happens, you may believe.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Philippians 4:4-9 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴ Rejoice in the Lord always! Again I will say, "Rejoice!" ⁵ Let your gentleness be known to all men. The Lord is at hand. ⁶ In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. ⁷ And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your thoughts in Christ Jesus.

⁸ Finally, brothers, whatever things are true, whatever things are honorable, whatever things are just, whatever things are pure, whatever things are lovely, whatever things are of good report; if there is any virtue, and if there is any praise, think about these things. ⁹ The things which you learned, received, heard, and saw in me: do these things, and the God of peace will be with you.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Peter 1:3-9 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

³ Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who according to his great mercy became our father again to a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead, ⁴ to an incorruptible and undefiled inheritance that doesn't fade away, reserved in Heaven for you, ⁵ who by the power of God are guarded through faith for a salvation ready to be revealed in the last time. ⁶ Wherein you greatly rejoice, though now for a little while, if need be, you have been put to grief in various trials,

⁷ that the proof of your faith, which is more precious than gold that perishes even though it is tested by fire, may be found to result in praise, glory, and honor at the revelation of Jesus Christ— ⁸ whom not having known you love; in whom, though now you don't see him, yet believing, you rejoice greatly with joy unspeakable and full of glory— ⁹ receiving the result of your faith, the salvation of your souls.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Peace is received from Christ and practiced through peacemaking.
- Prayer redirects anxiety toward God's presence and provision.
- Hope does not deny loss; it looks through loss toward resurrection.
- The church should pair spiritual encouragement with practical care and, when needed, professional help.

Further references: Isaiah 26:1-4; Isaiah 40:28-31; John 16:33; Romans 5:1-5; Romans 15:13; 1 Thessalonians 4:13-18; Hebrews 6:17-20; Revelation 21:1-5.

41. Love

Love is central because it reflects God's character and fulfills the law. Biblical love is not reduced to affection: it seeks the true good of another, acts with patience and truth, protects the vulnerable, forgives, gives, and sometimes confronts. The cross defines love's shape, and the Spirit enables love of God, neighbor, enemy, and fellow believer.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - 1 Corinthians 13:13 (NASB 2020)

"Now faith, hope, and love remain, these three; but the greatest of these is love."

Primary core reading: Deuteronomy 6:4-5 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴ Hear, Israel: Yahweh is our God; Yahweh is one: ⁵ and you shall love Yahweh your God with all your heart, and with all your soul, and with all your might.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Leviticus 19:17-18 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁷ "You shall not hate your brother in your heart. You shall surely rebuke your neighbor, and not bear sin because of him. ¹⁸ "You shall not take vengeance, nor bear any grudge against the children of your people; but you shall love your neighbor as yourself. I am Yahweh.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Matthew 5:43-48 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁴³ "You have heard that it was said, 'You shall love your neighbor, and hate your enemy.' ⁴⁴ But I tell you, love your enemies, bless those who curse you, do good to those who hate you, and pray for those who mistreat you and persecute you, ⁴⁵ that you may be children of your Father who is in heaven. For he makes his sun to rise on the evil and the good, and sends rain on the just and the unjust. ⁴⁶ For if you love those who love you, what reward do you have? Don't even the tax collectors do the same?

⁴⁷ If you only greet your friends, what more do you do than others? Don't even the tax collectors do the same? ⁴⁸ Therefore you shall be perfect, just as your Father in heaven is perfect.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 Corinthians 13:1-13 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ If I speak with the languages of men and of angels, but don't have love, I have become sounding brass, or a clanging cymbal. ² If I have the gift of prophecy, and know all mysteries and all knowledge; and if I have all faith, so as to remove mountains, but don't have love, I am nothing. ³ If I dole out all my goods to feed the poor, and if I give my body to be burned, but don't have love, it profits me nothing. ⁴ Love is patient and is kind; love doesn't envy. Love doesn't brag, is not proud,

⁵ doesn't behave itself inappropriately, doesn't seek its own way, is not provoked, takes no account of evil; ⁶ doesn't rejoice in unrighteousness, but rejoices with the truth; ⁷ bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things. ⁸ Love never fails. But where there are prophecies, they will be done away with. Where there are various languages, they will cease. Where there is knowledge, it will be done away with.

⁹ For we know in part, and we prophesy in part; ¹⁰ but when that which is complete has come, then that which is partial will be done away with. ¹¹ When I was a child, I spoke as a child, I felt as a child, I thought as a child. Now that I have become a man, I have put away childish things. ¹² For now we see in a mirror, dimly, but then face to face. Now I know in part, but then I will know fully, even as I was also fully known.

¹³ But now faith, hope, and love remain—these three. The greatest of these is love.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: 1 John 4:7-21 (WEB)

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⁷ Beloved, let us love one another, for love is of God; and everyone who loves is born of God, and knows God. ⁸ He who doesn't love doesn't know God, for God is love. ⁹ By this God's love was revealed in us, that God has sent his one and only Son into the world that we might live through him. ¹⁰ In this is love, not that we loved God, but that he loved us, and sent his Son as the atoning sacrifice for our sins.

¹¹ Beloved, if God loved us in this way, we also ought to love one another. ¹² No one has seen God at any time. If we love one another, God remains in us, and his love has been perfected in us. ¹³ By this we know that we remain in him and he in us, because he has given us of his Spirit. ¹⁴ We have seen and testify that the Father has sent the Son as the Savior of the world.

¹⁵ Whoever confesses that Jesus is the Son of God, God remains in him, and he in God. ¹⁶ We know and have believed the love which God has for us. God is love, and he who remains in love remains in God, and God remains in him. ¹⁷ In this love has been made perfect among us, that we may have boldness in the day of judgment, because as he is, even so are we in this world. ¹⁸ There is no fear in love; but perfect love casts out fear, because fear has punishment. He who fears is not made perfect in love.

¹⁹ We love him, because he first loved us. ²⁰ If a man says, "I love God," and hates his brother, he is a liar; for he who doesn't love his brother whom he has seen, how can he love God whom he has not seen? ²¹ This commandment we have from him, that he who loves God should also love his brother.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Love of God and neighbor summarizes the law.
- Love rejoices with truth and is not permissive toward abuse or deception.
- Enemy-love rejects vengeance while seeking justice and repentance.
- Christian love is learned by receiving God's prior love in Christ.

Further references: John 3:16-17; John 13:34-35; John 15:9-13; Romans 5:6-8; Romans 12:9-21; Galatians 5:13-14; Ephesians 5:1-2; Colossians 3:12-14.

42. Perseverance and Endurance

Perseverance is continued faithfulness through trial, delay, temptation, and ordinary time. Some traditions emphasize God's preservation of all true believers; others emphasize conditional warnings and the necessity of continuing in faith. Scripture itself places promises and warnings side by side so that confidence produces vigilance rather than presumption.

NASB 2020 Anchor and WEB Core Readings

Modern translation anchor - Hebrews 12:1 (NASB 2020)

"Let's run with endurance the race that lies before us."

Primary core reading: Matthew 24:9-14 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

⁹ Then they will deliver you up to oppression, and will kill you. You will be hated by all of the nations for my name's sake. ¹⁰ Then many will stumble, and will deliver up one another, and will hate one another. ¹¹ Many false prophets will arise, and will lead many astray. ¹² Because iniquity will be multiplied, the love of many will grow cold.

¹³ But he who endures to the end, the same will be saved. ¹⁴ This Good News of the Kingdom will be preached in the whole world for a testimony to all the nations, and then the end will come.

The NASB 2020 anchor quotation is retained above. The complete core passage is supplied from the WEB; compare it in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition when desired.

Core reading: Romans 5:1-5 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Being therefore justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ; ² through whom we also have our access by faith into this grace in which we stand. We rejoice in hope of the glory of God. ³ Not only this, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, knowing that suffering works perseverance; ⁴ and perseverance, proven character; and proven character, hope:

⁵ and hope doesn't disappoint us, because God's love has been poured out into our hearts through the Holy Spirit who was given to us.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Hebrews 10:19-39 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹⁹ Having therefore, brothers, boldness to enter into the holy place by the blood of Jesus, ²⁰ by the way which he dedicated for us, a new and living way, through the veil, that is to say, his flesh; ²¹ and having a great priest over the house of God, ²² let's draw near with a true heart in fullness of faith, having our hearts sprinkled from an evil conscience, and having our body washed with pure water,

²³ let us hold fast the confession of our hope without wavering; for he who promised is faithful. ²⁴ Let us consider how to provoke one another to love and good works, ²⁵ not forsaking our own assembling together, as the custom of some is, but exhorting one another; and so much the more, as you see the Day approaching. ²⁶ For if we sin willfully after we have received the knowledge of the truth, there remains no more a sacrifice for sins,

²⁷ but a certain fearful expectation of judgment, and a fierceness of fire which will devour the adversaries. ²⁸ A man who disregards Moses' law dies without compassion on the word of two or three witnesses. ²⁹ How much worse punishment, do you think, will he be judged worthy of, who has trodden under foot the Son of God, and has counted the blood of the covenant with which he was sanctified an unholy thing, and has insulted the Spirit of grace? ³⁰ For we know him who said, "Vengeance belongs to me," says the Lord, "I will repay." Again, "The Lord will judge his people."

³¹ It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God. ³² But remember the former days, in which, after you were enlightened, you endured a great struggle with sufferings; ³³ partly, being exposed to both reproaches and oppressions; and partly, becoming partakers with those who were treated so. ³⁴ For you both had compassion on me in my chains, and joyfully accepted the plundering of your possessions, knowing that you have for yourselves a better possession and an enduring one in the heavens.

³⁵ Therefore don't throw away your boldness, which has a great reward. ³⁶ For you need endurance so that, having done the will of God, you may receive the promise. ³⁷ "In a very little while, he who comes will come, and will not wait. ³⁸ But the righteous will live by faith. If he shrinks back, my soul has no pleasure in him."

³⁹ But we are not of those who shrink back to destruction, but of those who have faith to the saving of the soul.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: Hebrews 12:1-3 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

¹ Therefore let us also, seeing we are surrounded by so great a cloud of witnesses, lay aside every weight and the sin which so easily entangles us, and let us run with patience the race that is set before us, ² looking to Jesus, the author and perfecter of faith, who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising its shame, and has sat down at the right hand of the throne of God. ³ For consider him who has endured such contradiction of sinners against himself, that you don't grow weary, fainting in your souls.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Core reading: James 1:2-12 (WEB)

WORLD ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB) - PUBLIC DOMAIN

² Count it all joy, my brothers, when you fall into various temptations, ³ knowing that the testing of your faith produces endurance. ⁴ Let endurance have its perfect work, that you may be perfect and complete, lacking in nothing. ⁵ But if any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask of God, who gives to all liberally and without reproach; and it will be given to him.

⁶ But let him ask in faith, without any doubting, for he who doubts is like a wave of the sea, driven by the wind and tossed. ⁷ For let that man not think that he will receive anything from the Lord. ⁸ He is a double-minded man, unstable in all his ways. ⁹ But let the brother in humble circumstances glory in his high position;

¹⁰ and the rich, in that he is made humble, because like the flower in the grass, he will pass away. ¹¹ For the sun arises with the scorching wind, and withers the grass, and the flower in it falls, and the beauty of its appearance perishes. So also will the rich man fade away in his pursuits. ¹² Blessed is the man who endures temptation, for when he has been approved, he will receive the crown of life, which the Lord promised to those who love him.

Complete passage quoted from the WEB. For translation comparison, consult the same reference in a licensed NASB 2020, NIV, or ESV edition.

Thematic Synthesis

- Endurance is sustained by hope, community, discipline, and the example of Christ.
- Warnings are pastoral means that call believers to remain awake.
- God's faithfulness is the deepest ground of confidence.
- Perseverance often consists in repeated small acts of obedience rather than dramatic heroism.

Further references: Psalm 73:21-28; John 10:27-30; Romans 8:28-39; 1 Corinthians 10:12-13; Philippians 1:6; 2 Timothy 4:6-8; 1 Peter 1:3-9; Revelation 14:12.

Index of NASB Anchors and WEB Scripture Readings

Genesis: Genesis 1:26-28; Genesis 2:15-17; Genesis 2:18-25; Genesis 3:1-15; Genesis 3:1-19; Genesis 3:14-15; Genesis 12:1-3; Genesis 16:7-14; Genesis 22:9-18

Exodus: Exodus 3:1-6; Exodus 20:1-17; Exodus 34:5-7; Exodus 34:5-8

Leviticus: Leviticus 19:17-18

Deuteronomy: Deuteronomy 6:4-5; Deuteronomy 6:4-9; Deuteronomy 10:17-19; Deuteronomy 17:14-20; Deuteronomy 18:15-19

Judges: Judges 6:11-24; Judges 13:15-22

1 Samuel: 1 Samuel 18:1-4

2 Samuel: 2 Samuel 7:8-16

Nehemiah: Nehemiah 2:1-8

Job: Job 1:6-12; Job 1:20-22

Psalms: Psalm 13:1-6; Psalm 19:7-11; Psalm 32:1-5; Psalm 46:1-11; Psalm 63:1-8; Psalm 103:8-14; Psalm 103:19-22; Psalm 119:105-112; Psalm 127:1-5

Proverbs: Proverbs 1:1-7; Proverbs 3:1-12; Proverbs 6:6-11; Proverbs 15:1-4; Proverbs 17:17; Proverbs 22:6; Proverbs 27:5-10

Isaiah: Isaiah 1:10-20; Isaiah 9:6-7; Isaiah 40:25-31; Isaiah 52:13-15; Isaiah 53:1-12

Jeremiah: Jeremiah 31:31-34

Ezekiel: Ezekiel 34:1-16; Ezekiel 36:25-27

Daniel: Daniel 9:1-3; Daniel 9:20-27; Daniel 10:10-14

Micah: Micah 5:2-5; Micah 6:6-8

Zechariah: Zechariah 9:9-10

Matthew: Matthew 3:13-17; Matthew 4:1-11; Matthew 5:13-16; Matthew 5:17-20; Matthew 5:43-48; Matthew 6:5-15; Matthew 6:9-15; Matthew 6:19-34; Matthew 6:25-34; Matthew 16:13-19; Matthew 18:21-35; Matthew 19:3-9; Matthew 24:9-14; Matthew 24:29-44; Matthew 25:31-40; Matthew 28:16-20; Matthew 28:18-20

Mark: Mark 1:14-15; Mark 1:21-28; Mark 5:1-20; Mark 10:35-45

Luke: Luke 1:26-38; Luke 4:16-21; Luke 10:25-37; Luke 11:14-23; Luke 18:1-8; Luke 18:9-14; Luke 19:28-44; Luke 22:14-20

John: John 1:1-3; John 1:1-18; John 2:18-22; John 3:14-21; John 5:24-29; John 12:27-33; John 13:1-17; John 14:15-17; John 14:25-29; John 15:12-17; John 16:7-15

Acts: Acts 1:4-8; Acts 1:6-8; Acts 2:37-41; Acts 2:41-47; Acts 16:16-18

Romans: Romans 3:9-26; Romans 3:21-28; Romans 3:23-28; Romans 4:16-25; Romans 5:1-5; Romans 5:1-11; Romans 5:12-19; Romans 5:15-21; Romans 6:1-14; Romans 7:7-13; Romans 8:1-17; Romans 8:18-39; Romans 10:8-17; Romans 12:1-2; Romans 12:3-8

1 Corinthians: 1 Corinthians 5:6-8; 1 Corinthians 6:12-20; 1 Corinthians 7:1-16; 1 Corinthians 10:1-6; 1 Corinthians 10:12-14; 1 Corinthians 12:4-13; 1 Corinthians 12:12-27; 1 Corinthians 13:1-13; 1 Corinthians 15:1-8; 1 Corinthians 15:35-58

2 Corinthians: 2 Corinthians 4:7-18; 2 Corinthians 5:1-10; 2 Corinthians 5:17-21; 2 Corinthians 10:3-6; 2 Corinthians 13:14

Galatians: Galatians 3:19-29; Galatians 4:4-7; Galatians 5:16-25; Galatians 6:1-2

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2 Peter: 2 Peter 3:8-14

1 John: 1 John 4:7-10; 1 John 4:7-21; 1 John 5:9-13

Revelation: Revelation 4:8-11; Revelation 12:7-12; Revelation 20:1-15; Revelation 21:1-7; Revelation 21:1-8; Revelation 22:1-5; Revelation 22:8-9; Revelation 22:10-14

Sources and Selected Bibliography

Biblical texts and translation use

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[B2] World English Bible (WEB), classic American-English edition. Complete core passages are quoted from this public-domain translation. The WEB uses "Yahweh" for the divine name in the Old Testament.

[B3] The NIV and ESV are named as recommended comparison translations. Their extended text is not reproduced; consult an authorized Bible, app, or publisher edition for full comparison.

Daniel 9 and messianic chronology

- [D1] Harold W. Hoehner, "Chronological Aspects of the Life of Christ, Part VI: Daniel's Seventy Weeks and New Testament Chronology," *Bibliotheca Sacra* 132, no. 525 (1975): 47-65.
- [D2] J. Paul Tanner, "Is Daniel's Seventy-Weeks Prophecy Messianic? Part 1," *Bibliotheca Sacra* 166 (April-June 2009): 181-200.
- [D3] David R. Ulrich, "How Early Judaism Read Daniel 9:24-27," *Old Testament Essays* 27, no. 3 (2014): 1062-1083.
- [D4] David J. Hamstra, "The Seventy-Weeks Prophecy of Daniel 9:24-27 and First-Century AD Jewish Messianic Expectation," *Andrews University Seminary Student Journal* 4, no. 1 (2020), article 4.
- [D5] John J. Collins, *Daniel: A Commentary on the Book of Daniel*. Hermeneia. Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 1993. Representative of a major historical-critical approach.

Angel of the LORD and biblical theology

- [A1] "Identifying the Angel of the Lord in the Book of Judges," *Biblical Research* 20, no. 1 (2010): 1-18. Discusses grammar, agency, and ancient messenger conventions.
- [A2] BibleProject, "Who Is the Angel of the Lord?" August 9, 2019. A popular biblical-theology presentation of the divine messenger pattern and its christological trajectory.

General study aids

- [G1] G. K. Beale and D. A. Carson, eds., *Commentary on the New Testament Use of the Old Testament*. Grand Rapids: Baker Academic, 2007.
- [G2] Richard B. Hays, *Echoes of Scripture in the Gospels*. Waco: Baylor University Press, 2016.
- [G3] *Dictionary of Biblical Imagery*, ed. Leland Ryken, James C. Wilhoit, and Tremper Longman III. Downers Grove: InterVarsity Press, 1998.
- [G4] The reader should consult multiple commentaries representing different traditions when forming conclusions on disputed texts.

Closing Exhortation

Acts 17:11 (NASB 2020 excerpt)

"Examining the Scriptures daily to see whether these things were so."

Use this guide as a map, not a substitute for the terrain. Return repeatedly to whole books of Scripture, read with the church across time, test claims carefully, and let knowledge mature into worship, love, courage, mercy, and obedience.